Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries

OPEC Monthly Oil Market Report

11 November 2026

Feature article:
Recent Global Oil Inventory Developments

Oil market highlights	iii
Feature article	v
Crude oil price movements	1
Commodity markets	6
World economy	11
World oil demand	32
World oil supply	44
Product markets and refinery operations	56
Tanker market	62
Crude and refined products trade	65
Commercial stock movements	70
Balance of supply and demand	75

OPEC Monthly Oil Market Report

OPEC App

Android iOS

Disclaimer

The data, analysis and any other information (the "information") contained in the Monthly Oil Market Report (the "MOMR") is for informational purposes only and is neither intended as a substitute for advice from business, finance, investment consultant or other professional; nor is it meant to be a benchmark or input data to a benchmark of any kind. Whilst reasonable efforts have been made to ensure the accuracy of the information contained in the MOMR, the OPEC Secretariat makes no warranties or representations as to its accuracy, relevance or comprehensiveness, and assumes no liability or responsibility for any inaccuracy, error or omission, or for any loss or damage arising in connection with or attributable to any action or decision taken as a result of using or relying on the information in the MOMR. The views expressed in the MOMR are those of the OPEC Secretariat and do not necessarily reflect the views of its governing bodies or Member Countries. The designation of geographical entities in the MOMR, and the use and presentation of data and other materials, do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of OPEC and/or its Member Countries concerning the legal status of any country, territory or area, or of its authorities, or concerning the exploration, exploitation, refining, marketing and utilization of its petroleum or other energy resources.

Full reproduction, copying or transmission of the MOMR is not permitted in any form or by any means by third parties without the OPEC Secretariat's written permission, however, the information contained therein may be used and/or reproduced for educational and other non-commercial purposes without the OPEC Secretariat's prior written permission, provided that it is fully acknowledged as the copyright holder. The MOMR may contain references to material(s) from third parties, whose copyright must be acknowledged by obtaining necessary authorization from the copyright owner(s). The OPEC Secretariat or its governing bodies shall not be liable or responsible for any unauthorized use of any third party material(s). All rights of the MOMR shall be reserved to the OPEC Secretariat, as applicable, including every exclusive economic right, in full or per excerpts, with special reference but without limitation, to the right to publish it by press and/or by any communications medium whatsoever; translate, include in a data base, make changes, transform and process for any kind of use, including radio, television or cinema adaptations, as well as a sound–video recording, audio–visual screenplays and electronic processing of any kind and nature whatsoever.

Acknowledgements

Secretary General
HE Haitham Al Ghais

Director, Research Division
Dr. Ayed S. Al-Qahtani

Head, Petroleum Studies Department
Behrooz Baikalizadeh

Main contributors

Crude oil price movements
Yacine Sariahmed

Commodity markets
Angel Edjang Memba

World economy
Dr. Joerg Spitzy

World oil demand
Dr. Sulaiman Saad

World oil supply
Dr. Ali Akbar Dehghan

Product markets and refinery operations
Yacine Sariahmed

Tanker markets
Douglas Linton

Crude and refined products trade
Douglas Linton

Stock movements
Dr. Mohannad Al-Suwaidan

Other contributors

Huda Almwasawy; Mhammed Mouraia; Dr. Asmaa Yaseen; Dr. Pantelis Christodoulides; Klaus Stoeger; Viveca Hameder; Dr. Mohammad Sattar; Mihni Mihnev; Dr. Justinas Pelenis; Dr. Mansi Ghodsi; Hataichanok Leimlehner

Editorial, Design, and Production Team

James Griffin; Mathew Quinn; Maureen MacNeill; Richard Murphy; Catherine Brannigan Conway; Carola Bayer; Andrea Birnbach; Soojung Jung; Boris Kudashev

Oil Market Highlights

Crude Oil Price Movements

In October, the OPEC Reference Basket (ORB) value increased by $1.53/b, m-o-m, to average $112.12/b. The ICE Brent front-month contract increased by $6.32/b, m-o-m, to average $108.34/b in October. The NYMEX WTI front-month contract increased by $1.25/b, m-o-m, to average $96.94/b. In contrast, the GME Oman front-month contract dropped by $3.24/b, m-o-m, to average $111.29/b. The forward curves of the three major crude futures benchmarks – ICE Brent, NYMEX WTI and GME Oman – remained in backwardation in October, while prompt market structures flattened slightly amid improving crude availability. Hedge funds and other money managers increased their combined bullish positions in ICE Brent and NYMEX WTI futures and options contracts in October, although positioning diverged between the two contracts. The increase in net long positions was driven by short covering and fresh long buying concentrated entirely in the ICE Brent contract.

World Economy

Global economic growth forecast is revised slightly up to 3.1% for 2026, while the 2027 forecast remains unchanged at 3.2%. US economic growth forecasts are revised up to 2.3% for 2026 and 2.1% for 2027. In the Eurozone, economic growth forecasts are revised up to 1% in 2026 and 1.1% in 2027. Japan's economic growth forecast for 2026 is revised up to 0.8% but remains unchanged at 0.8% for 2027. China's economic growth forecasts remain unchanged at 4.6% for 2026 and 4.5% for 2027. India's economic growth forecasts are revised up to 7.3% for 2026 and 6.8% for 2027. Brazil's economic growth forecast remains unchanged at 2% for 2026, while the 2027 forecast is revised slightly down to 2.1%. Russia's economic growth forecast is revised slightly to 1% for 2026, but the 2027 forecast remains unchanged at 1.5%.

World Oil Demand

Global oil demand is forecast to grow by 0.2 mb/d in 2026, y-o-y, unchanged from last month's assessment. The OECD oil demand is forecast to ease by about 0.2 mb/d, while the non-OECD oil demand is forecast to grow by about 0.4 mb/d. Global oil demand in 2027 is forecast to grow by about 2.6 mb/d, y-o-y, unchanged from last month's assessment. The OECD oil demand is forecast to grow by about 0.5 mb/d, while the non-OECD oil demand is forecast to grow by about 2 mb/d.

World Oil Supply

Non-DoC liquids production (i.e., liquids production from countries not participating in the Declaration of Cooperation) is forecast to grow by about 0.6 mb/d, y-o-y, in 2026, unchanged from last month's assessment. The main drivers of liquids production growth are expected to be Brazil, the US, Canada, and Argentina. In 2027, non-DoC liquids production is forecast to grow by about 0.6 mb/d, also unchanged from last month's assessment. This growth will mainly be driven by Qatar, Canada, Brazil, and Argentina. Natural gas liquids (NGLs) and non-conventional liquids from countries participating in the DoC are expected to increase by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 8.7 mb/d in 2026. Further growth of about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, is forecast for 2027, to average about 8.9 mb/d. In October, crude oil production by countries participating in the DoC increased by 2.04 mb/d, m-o-m, to average about 41.23 mb/d, according to available secondary sources.

Product Markets and Refining Operations

Refining margins dropped across the main trading hubs in October. On the US Gulf Coast (USGC), margins retreated from the high levels registered in September, as losses in gasoline and gasoil outweighed improvements in jet/kerosene and fuel oil crack spreads. In Rotterdam, margins recorded the largest decline, mainly reflecting weaker gasoline and gasoil cracks, while jet/kerosene continued to provide support. In Singapore, reported refining margins against Oman remained negative and declined further, although most product crack spreads against Dubai improved.

Tanker Market

Dirty tanker spot freight rates surged in October, with record VLCC rates driving Suezmax and Aframax rates higher. The return of disrupted volumes, ongoing trade dislocations, export inefficiencies and longer voyages kept tanker availability constrained. VLCC rates stood at more than ten times their levels from a year ago. On the Middle East-to-East route, VLCC spot freight rates rose by 26%, m-o-m, in October, while rates on the West Africa-to-East route increased by 56%, m-o-m, building on sharply higher gains from the month before. Suezmax spot freight rates experienced the largest increase, m-o-m, of the three major vessel classes. On the USGC-to-Europe route, Suezmax rates rose by 139%, m-o-m. Compared to the same period last year, spot freight rates were seven times higher. Aframax rates rose further in October, although to a lesser degree than the larger classes. On the Intra-Med route, Aframax spot freight rates gained 67%, m-o-m, more than four times higher than their levels a year ago. The clean tanker market began to see some pressure from the high rates on the crude transport side. On average, clean rates rose 51%, m-o-m, with West of Suez rates catching to the gains seen last month in the East of Suez.

Crude and Refined Product Trade

US crude imports followed seasonal patterns, declining in October to average 6.1 mb/d. US crude exports began to pick up, averaging 4.3 mb/d, on higher flows to Japan. Product exports declined from high levels on lower outflows of distillate fuel oil. Preliminary estimates for September show crude imports into OECD Europe fell back to the five-year range due to decreased flows via the Suez, while crude exports remained steady. Product imports continued to be soft, well below the five-year range, despite a strong jump in diesel inflows. Japan's crude imports fell sharply, amid renewed trade flow disruptions in September, averaging 1.9 mb/d compared with 2.5 mb/d the month before. Product exports declined despite a jump in gasoil exports but were still close to the five-year average. In China, crude imports averaged 9.1 mb/d in September, slightly higher m-o-m. Product exports surged, boosted by strong diesel and fuel oil exports. Regional tightness in these products and fresh export quotas supported higher outflows. Crude imports into India set a new record high in September at 5.4 mb/d as refiners enjoyed strong domestic and international demand for their products. Product exports improved, with higher outflows of diesel and other products leading gains.

Commercial Stock Movements

Preliminary September 2026 data show that OECD commercial oil inventories decreased by 14.6 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 2,811 mb. At this level, OECD commercial stocks were 57.3 mb lower, y-o-y, 4.5 mb above the latest five-year average, and 156.2 mb below the 2015–2019 average. Within the components, crude stocks increased by 0.1 mb, while product stocks decreased by 14.7 mb, m-o-m. OECD commercial crude oil stocks stood at 1,353 mb. This was 23.8 mb higher, y-o-y, 29.7 mb above the latest five-year average and 82.1 mb below the 2015–2019 average. OECD total product stocks stood at 1,458 mb in September. This was 81.1 mb lower, y-o-y, 25.2 mb below the latest five-year average and 74.1 mb below the 2015–2019 average. In terms of days of forward cover, OECD commercial stocks decreased in September by 0.3 days, m-o-m, to 60.3 days. This was 1.4 days lower, y-o-y, 0.2 days below the latest five-year average, and 2.1 days below the 2015–2019 average.

Balance of Supply and Demand

The demand for DoC crude in 2026 (i.e., crude from countries participating in the DoC) remains unchanged from last month's assessment at 42.1 mb/d, 0.6 mb/d lower, y-o-y. The demand for DoC crude in 2027 also remains unchanged from last month's assessment at 43.9 mb/d, which is about 1.8 mb/d higher, y-o-y.

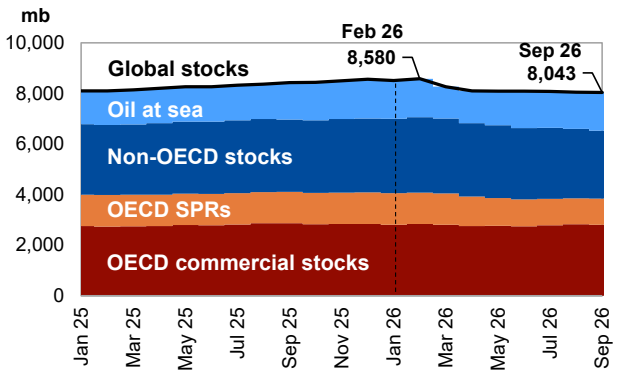
Feature Article

Recent Global Oil Inventory Developments

Global oil inventories are divided into three major components: OECD inventories, non-OECD inventories and oil-at-sea. OECD inventories cover commercial oil inventories and Strategic Petroleum Reserves (SPRs), with data coming from national government reports. Oil-at-sea includes floating storage and oil in transit, which serve as key operational links between exporting and importing countries. Non-OECD inventories include both commercial storage and SPRs and have grown in significance especially over the last decade and particularly with China's expanding storage capacity.

In 2026, global oil inventories peaked in February at 8,580 mb. Since then, they have fallen on the back of supply disruptions impacting global oil markets. By end of September 2026, the latest available monthly data reflected that global oil inventories were down by 537 mb to 8,043 mb, from the February peak. The largest contributor to this decline was non-OECD stocks, which dropped by 294 mb over this period, followed by OECD SPRs, which actually dropped by 218 mb. OECD commercial oil stocks overall stood only 24 mb below February 2026 levels, while oil at sea returned to February levels in September.

Graph 1: Global oil inventory stocks

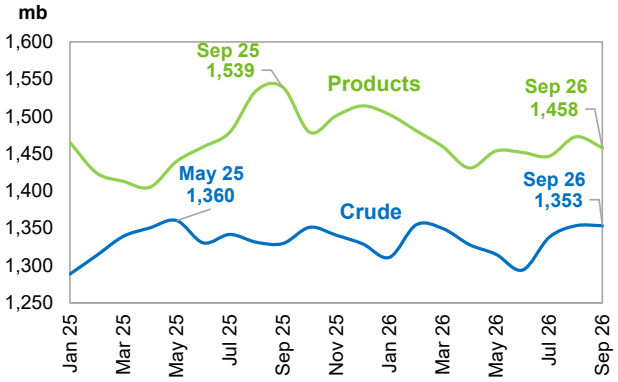


Sources: Argus Media, Energy Intelligence, EIA, OilX, IEA, METI and OPEC.

The draw in OECD SPRs began in March 2026 with the IEA-coordinated release of an announced 426 mb. Most of this release has been concentrated in the US and Japan. In OECD Europe, the emergency stock release was largely implemented through reductions in mandatory industry stockholding requirements. This makes previously obligated inventory available for use, but does not necessarily translate into actual stock draws. With this distinction, the OECD SPR release from March through September 2026 stood at 218 mb. Of this, 133 mb came from the US, 79 mb from OECD Asia Pacific and the remaining 6 mb from OECD Europe. Around 65% of the OECD SPR releases came in April and May, with a decelerating trend in the naming period.

OECD commercial oil stocks have observed a fluctuating pattern since the start of the year. Cumulatively, there has been a decline of 24 mb from the February peak with the level now standing at 2,811 mb. Of this, 23 mb came from a decline in product stocks and only 1 mb from a decline in crude stocks. The slower decline in crude stocks was partially driven by the steeper decline in crude SPR stocks, that decelerated the decline in commercial stocks. In the OECD regions, OECD Americas commercial oil stocks drew 24 mb from February to September 2026, of which 18 mb came from crude and 6 mb from products. In OECD Europe, commercial oil stocks fell 20 mb from February to September 2026, of which only 1 mb came from crude oil stocks and the remainder from product stocks. However, in OECD Asia Pacific, commercial oil stocks increased 20 mb between February and September 2026, of which 19 mb of the increase was crude oil stocks and 1 mb was for product stocks.

Graph 2: OECD commercial stocks



Sources: Argus Media, EIA, OilX, IEA, METI and OPEC.

Oil at sea remained unchanged overall between February and September 2026, despite strong monthly swings. Higher exports from regions outside of the Middle East and longer voyage times have resulted in declining floating storage and increasing oil in transit, that kept the overall level stable.

However, non-OECD inventories were a major contributor to the global decline. Between February and September, non-OECD inventories fell by an estimated 294 mb, of which around 156 mb came from China and 56 mb from the Middle East. In terms of days of forward cover, total inventories in the non-OECD stood at 46 days in September, down from 60 days in February. This compares to OECD inventories that stood at 60.3 days of forward cover in September, compared to 63 days in February 2026.

Table of Contents

Crude Oil Price Movements **1**
Crude spot prices 1
OPEC Reference Basket (ORB) value 3
The oil futures market 3
The futures market structure 4
Crude spreads 5

Commodity Markets **6**
Trends in select energy commodity markets 6
Trends in select non-energy commodity markets 7
Investment flows into commodities 9

World Economy **11**
OECD 14
Non-OECD 20
The impact of the USD and inflation on oil prices 31

World Oil Demand **32**
OECD 33
Non-OECD 36

World Oil Supply **44**
OECD 46
DoC NGLs and non-conventional liquids 54
DoC crude oil production 55
OPEC crude oil production 55

Product Markets and Refinery Operations **56**
Refinery margins 56
Refinery operations 57
Product markets 58

Tanker Market **62**
Dirty tanker freight rates 62
Clean tanker freight rates 63

Crude and Refined Products Trade **65**
US 65
OECD Europe 66
Japan 67
China 67
India 68
Eurasia 69

Table of Contents

Commercial Stock Movements **70**
OECD 70
US 71
Japan 72
EU-14 plus the UK and Norway 73
Singapore, Amsterdam-Rotterdam-Antwerp (ARA) and Fujairah 74

Balance of Supply and Demand **75**
Balance of supply and demand in 2026 75
Balance of supply and demand in 2027 75

Appendix **76**

Glossary of Terms **82**
Abbreviations 82
Acronyms 82

Crude Oil Price Movements

In October, the OPEC Reference Basket (ORB) value increased by $1.53/b, m-o-m, to average $112.12/b.

The ICE Brent front-month contract increased by $6.32/b, m-o-m, to average $108.34/b in October. The NYMEX WTI front-month contract increased by $1.25/b, m-om, to average $96.94/b. In contrast, the GME Oman front-month contract dropped by $3.24/b, m-o-m, to average $111.29/b.

The forward curves of the major crude futures benchmarks remained in backwardation in October, reflecting near-term supply concerns and geopolitical risks. However, prompt market structures flattened slightly amid improving crude availability.

Hedge funds and other money managers increased their combined bullish positions in ICE Brent and NYMEX WTI futures and options contracts in October, although positioning diverged between the two contracts. According to ICE and CFTC data, combined net long positions rose by 18,101 contracts, or 5.5%, between the weeks of 29 September and 27 October, reaching 345,228 contracts. The increase in net long positions was driven by short covering and fresh long buying concentrated entirely in the ICE Brent contract.

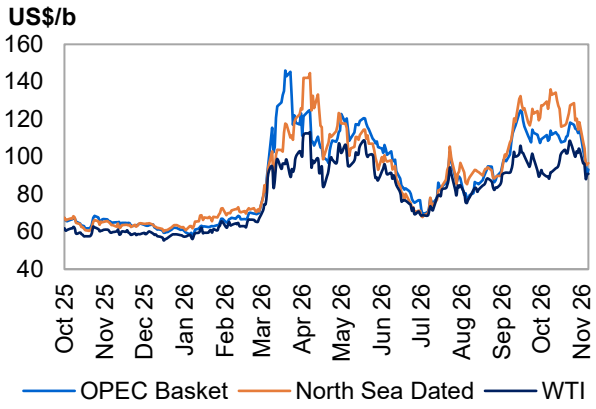
Crude spot prices

Crude spot prices remained supported in October by ongoing geopolitical tensions in the Middle East and uncertainty regarding regional crude exports.

Concerns over potential disruptions to shipping activity through the Strait of Hormuz continued to underpin prices. Spot prices rallied in the first half of the month, with North Sea Dated climbing to a six-month high.

Meanwhile, freight costs surged amid a revival in Asia-Pacific spot buying, including for Middle Eastern crude. This increased European buyers' demand for short-haul North Sea cargoes, which in turn supported the North Sea crude benchmark.

Graph 1 - 1: Crude oil price movements



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

However, physical crude markets softened slightly as the availability of sour crude in the Middle East improved, while refiners reduced purchases amid seasonal maintenance. Sour crude benchmarks retreated the most, as elevated freight costs weighed on crude trade flows, particularly for long-haul shipments, including between the Atlantic Basin and Asia. These developments resulted in a divergence between Atlantic Basin and East of Suez crude benchmarks. Lower refining margins also limited gains in spot crude prices.

North Sea Dated increased by $8.05/b, m-o-m, to average $124.94/b, and WTI increased by $1.30/b to average $97.68/b. Dubai dropped by $0.61/b, m-o-m, to average $110.79/b.

Crude oil differentials showed mixed movements in October, m-o-m, reflecting differences in regional crude availability, refinery demand and freight costs. North Sea light sweet grades remained well supported, while several West African and Mediterranean grades weakened amid subdued buying interest and increased competition from alternative supplies.

North Sea crude differentials strengthened in October, supported by strong demand from European buyers despite the refinery maintenance season in Europe. High freight costs and supply disruptions in the Middle East increased demand for North Sea grades. Forties and Ekofisk crude differentials increased by $2.46/b and $2.79/b, respectively, m-o-m, to average premiums of $13.37/b and $15.61/b against North Sea Dated. However, Johan Sverdrup sour crude weakened, with its differential declining by $9.90/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $4.08/b. The decline was due to improving availability of medium sour crude in the second half of October and increased competition from the Middle Eastern and Caspian grades.

West African crude differentials weakened in October, pressured by subdued demand from European and Asian refiners amid elevated freight costs. European refiners increasingly favoured competitively priced Middle Eastern, North Sea and Caspian crude, while Asian buyers reduced purchases of long-haul Atlantic Basin barrels. The accumulation of unsold cargoes added further downward pressure. Bonny Light and Forcados differentials declined by $3.04/b and $4.50/b, respectively, m-o-m, to average premiums of $2.40/b and $4.10/b against North Sea Dated. Cabinda's differential also weakened by $6.14/b, moving from a premium of $1.09/b in September to a discount of $5.06/b in October.

In the Mediterranean, crude differentials showed mixed movements. Azeri Light's differential strengthened by $1.94/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $13.21/b against North Sea Dated. The crude differential for Saharan Blend also rose by $1.13/b, m-o-m, to stand at a premium of $7.80/b. However, CPC Blend's differential dropped by $2.84/b, moving from a premium of $1.91/b in September to a discount of $0.93/b in October. Improving availability of medium sour crude, including from the Middle East, weighed on regional prices. The increase in crude exports through Ceyhan port and subdued refinery demand further increased competition among sour grades.

Table 1 - 1: OPEC Reference Basket and selected crudes, US$/b

			Change	Year-to-date	
OPEC Reference Basket (ORB)	Sep 26	Oct 26	Oct 26/Sep 26	2025	2026
ORB	**110.59**	**112.12**	***1.53***	**70.85**	**95.44**
Arab Light	109.02	107.97	*-1.05*	72.45	97.28
Basrah Medium	108.93	111.79	*2.86*	70.35	94.25
Bonny Light	118.95	129.71	*10.76*	71.09	99.97
Djeno	109.44	117.29	*7.85*	62.66	89.92
Es Sider	117.49	129.94	*12.45*	69.53	98.93
Iran Heavy	105.84	104.87	*-0.97*	71.17	93.94
Kuwait Export	108.99	107.87	*-1.12*	71.74	95.24
Merey	93.75	91.66	*-2.09*	57.53	75.76
Murban	115.39	111.16	*-4.23*	70.84	93.14
Rabi Light	116.43	124.28	*7.85*	69.65	96.91
Sahara Blend	118.49	137.94	*19.45*	70.83	101.15
Zafiro	114.89	119.55	*4.66*	71.53	95.88
Other Crudes					
North Sea Dated	116.89	124.94	*8.05*	70.12	97.38
Dubai	111.40	110.79	*-0.61*	70.58	93.48
Isthmus	99.03	101.72	*2.69*	65.87	85.94
LLS	100.36	101.74	*1.38*	68.52	88.07
Mars	97.89	100.86	*2.97*	66.64	87.10
Minas	130.89	141.82	*10.93*	73.61	107.48
Urals	88.93	95.22	*6.29*	57.18	69.97
WTI	96.38	97.68	*1.30*	66.12	85.26
Differentials					
North Sea Dated/WTI	20.51	27.26	*6.75*	4.00	12.12
North Sea Dated/LLS	16.53	23.20	*6.67*	1.60	9.31
North Sea Dated/Dubai	5.49	14.15	*8.66*	-0.47	3.90

Sources: Argus, Direct Communication, and OPEC.

In the Middle East, crude differentials weakened as supply availability improved and the tightness observed in September eased. The Oman crude differential declined by $14.13/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $7.86/b. Higher spot sales from regional producers and the recovery in crude exports reduced competition for prompt-loading barrels.

In the US Gulf Coast (USGC), crude differentials mostly increased in October amid strong domestic refinery demand. The LLS crude differential increased slightly by $0.10/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $4.06/b, while the Mars differential increased by $1.71/b, to average a premium of $3.18/b. The stronger performance of Mars reflected relatively firm demand for medium sour crude. Meanwhile, the WTI Midland crude differentials weakened by $0.59/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $0.44/b. Elevated freight costs continued to weigh on export economics, although the widening Brent–WTI spread improved the competitiveness of US crude in international markets.

OPEC Reference Basket (ORB) value

In October, the ORB value increased by $1.53/b, m-o-m, to stand at $112.12/b, although movements in the Basket components were mixed. The West and North African Basket components – Bonny Light, Djeno, Es Sider, Rabi Light, Sahara Blend and Zafiro – increased by an average of $10.50/b, m-o-m, to $126.45/b. Multiple-region destination grades – Arab Light, Basrah Medium, Iran Heavy and Kuwait Export – fell slightly, declining by $0.07/b, m-o-m, to settle at $108.13/b. Murban crude fell by $4.23/b, m-o-m, to average at $111.16/b. The Merey component decreased m-o-m by $2.09/b, to average at $91.66/b.

The oil futures market

Crude oil futures prices were volatile in October as uncertainty regarding geopolitical developments in the Middle East persisted. ICE Brent and NYMEX WTI increased on average, m-o-m, supported by continued concerns over the security of crude supplies, particularly in the first half of October. Uncertainty surrounding shipping through the Strait of Hormuz and concerns about disruptions to regional oil infrastructure sustained an elevated geopolitical risk premium. However, signs of improving physical crude availability and seasonal refinery maintenance limited further upward momentum. Increasing crude exports from the Middle East also helped to ease concerns about an immediate shortage of prompt barrels.

Table 1 - 2: Crude oil futures, US$/b

Crude oil futures	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct 26/Sep 26	Year-to-date 2025	Year-to-date 2026
NYMEX WTI	95.69	96.94	1.25	65.93	85.28
ICE Brent	102.02	108.34	6.32	69.27	90.86
GME Oman	114.53	111.29	-3.24	70.55	93.73
Spread					
ICE Brent-NYMEX WTI	*6.33*	*11.40*	*5.07*	*3.34*	*5.58*

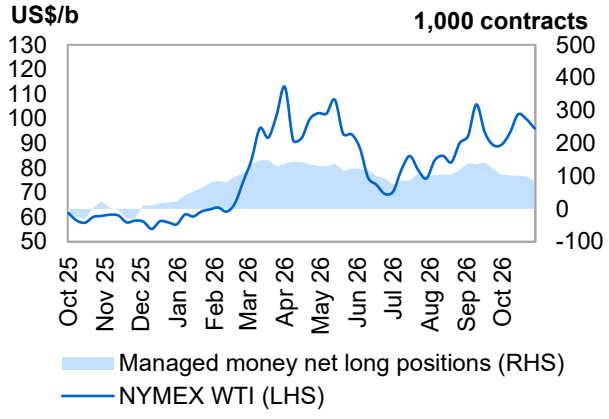
Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.
Sources: CME, ICE, GME and OPEC.

Crude futures prices were also influenced by developments in refined product markets. Although strong middle distillate margins remained supportive of crude demand in some regions, weaker gasoline margins and the seasonal decline in refinery operations weighed on crude buying interest.

The stronger performance of the ICE Brent benchmark compared to other crude benchmarks reflected its greater exposure to international crude trade amid uncertainty surrounding Middle East supply, along with a sharp increase in freight costs.

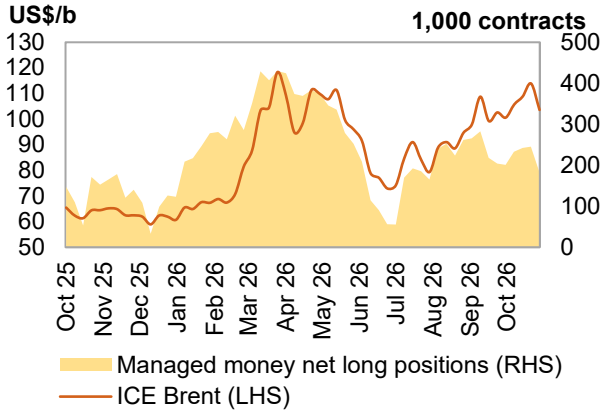
The ICE Brent front-month contract increased by $6.32/b, m-o-m, to average $108.34/b in October. The NYMEX WTI front-month contract increased by $1.25/b, m-o-m, to average $96.94/b. In contrast, the GME Oman front-month contract fell by $3.24/b, m-o-m, to average $111.29/b.

Graph 1 - 2: NYMEX WTI vs. Managed Money net long positions



Sources: CFTC, CME and OPEC.

Graph 1 - 3: ICE Brent vs. Managed Money net long positions



Sources: ICE and OPEC.

The ICE Brent–NYMEX WTI first-month spread widened sharply in October, reflecting differences in regional crude market conditions. The spread increased by $5.07/b compared with the September average, to stand at $11.40/b, as geopolitical risk premiums provided greater support to ICE Brent, while the US market remained relatively well supplied. Moreover, elevated Atlantic Basin freight costs weighed on the economics of WTI-related crude exports.

The spread between North Sea Dated and WTI Houston also increased by $7.49/b, m-o-m, in October, to average $26.39/b. The wider spread helped to improve the relative competitiveness of US crude in international markets and supported export opportunities, although elevated tanker freight rates continued to limit arbitrage economics.

Hedge funds and other money managers increased their combined bullish positions in ICE Brent and NYMEX WTI futures and options contracts in October, although positioning diverged between the two contracts. According to ICE and CFTC data, combined net long positions increased by 18,010 contracts, or 5.5%, between the weeks of 29 September and 27 October, reaching 345,228 contracts. The increase in net long positions was driven by short covering in both contracts and fresh long buying concentrated entirely in ICE Brent.

Combined short positions declined by 40,902 contracts, or 18.7%, while combined long positions fell by 22,892 contracts, or 4.2%. This suggests that money managers became less keen to maintain bearish positions amid persistent geopolitical risks, but remained cautious about increasing their outright bullish exposure despite an increase in oil prices.

Money managers increased their net long positions in ICE Brent by 41,155 contracts, or 20.1%, over the same period, to 245,457 contracts. This reflected both an increase of 27,342 contracts, or 8.5%, in long positions, to 349,867 contracts, and a reduction of 13,813 contracts, or 11.7%, in short positions, to 104,410 contracts. Consequently, the long-to-short ratio increased from about 2.7:1 in late September to 3.4:1 in late October. The increase in bullish exposure was consistent with stronger Brent futures prices and continued concerns about Middle East supply disruptions.

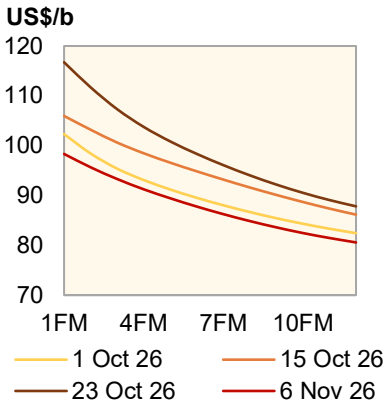
However, money managers reduced their net long positions in NYMEX WTI by 23,145 contracts, or 18.8%, between the weeks of 29 September and 27 October, to 99,771 contracts. Long positions declined sharply by 50,234 contracts, or 22.5%, to 173,297 contracts, while short positions also fell by 27,089 contracts, or 26.9%, to 73,526 contracts. The long-to-short ratio remained almost unchanged at 2:1. The reduction in WTI net long positions reflected the US market's lower exposure to international oil market developments compared with Brent, amid relatively ample US crude availability.

ICE Brent open interest declined slightly by 38,917 contracts over the same period, to stand at 3.33 million contracts in the week ending 27 October, while NYMEX WTI open interest increased by 111,993 contracts, to stand at 2.61 million contracts in the week of 27 October.

The futures market structure

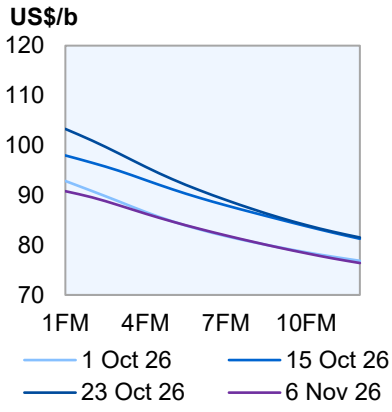
The forward curves of the major crude futures benchmarks remained in backwardation in October, reflecting continued concerns over near-term supply availability and geopolitical risks. However, prompt market structures flattened slightly amid improving crude availability.

Graph 1 - 4: ICE Brent forward curves



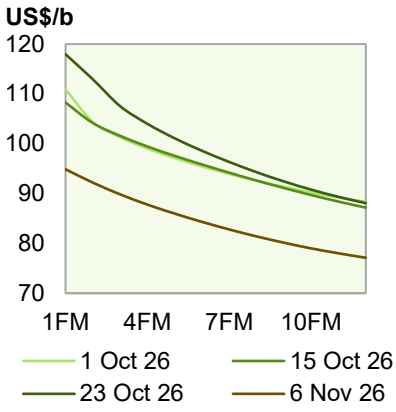
Sources: ICE and OPEC.

Graph 1 - 5: NYMEX WTI forward curves



Sources: CME and OPEC.

Graph 1 - 6: GME Oman forward curves



Sources: GME and OPEC.

The ICE Brent forward curve remained in backwardation, although near-time spreads narrowed, as physical crude market tightness in the Atlantic Basin eased. Moreover, the recovery in Middle East exports, increased availability of competing Atlantic Basin crude and seasonal refinery maintenance in Europe reduced demand for prompt-loading barrels. The North Sea Dated premium to the ICE Brent front-month contract narrowed sharply in the second half of October, reflecting the easing of the physical crude tightness observed in September and early October. The ICE Brent M1/M3 spread narrowed by $1.50/b, m-o-m, to an average backwardation of $6.73/b in October, compared with $8.24/b in September.

The NYMEX WTI futures curve also remained supported by relatively firm US crude demand and low stock levels. Nevertheless, the availability of additional Canadian heavy crude and weaker export economics amid elevated freight costs moderated the strength in some regional physical markets. The NYMEX WTI M1-M3 spread declined by $3.47/b, m-o-m, to average a backwardation of $3.41/b.

The GME Oman and physical Dubai forward structures weakened in October as Middle East crude supply availability improved. Additional prompt spot offers from regional producers and elevated freight costs reduced competition for prompt barrels. However, continued geopolitical tensions and uncertainty over shipping through the Strait of Hormuz prevented a more pronounced weakening in regional crude price structures. The GME Oman M1-M3 spread softened the most, falling by $5.13/b, m-o-m, to average a backwardation of $7.92/b.

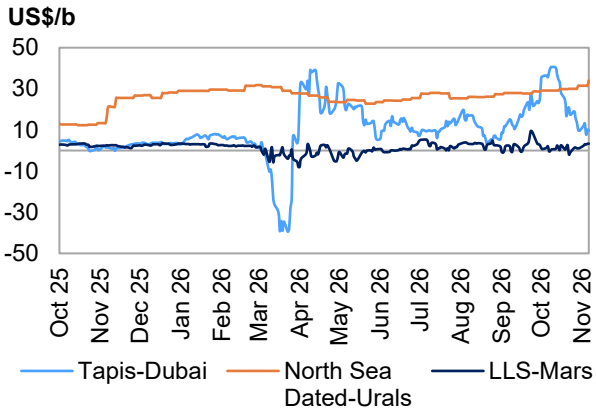
The North Sea Brent and WTI M1–M3 spreads narrowed by $3.02/b and $3.50/b, m-o-m, respectively, to backwardation levels of $9.77/b and $3.86/b in October. The Dubai M1–M3 spread narrowed the most, by $11.13/b, m-o-m, to a backwardation of $8.19/b.

Crude spreads

The sweet–sour crude price differentials showed mixed movements across key refining hubs in October, reflecting changes in crude availability, refinery demand, freight costs, and regional trade flows that continued to influence the relative values of light sweet and medium sour crude grades. Sweet–sour crude differentials widened in Asia and Europe in October, m-o-m, while narrowing in the USGC. The Brent-Dubai spread also widened, reflecting these changing regional market conditions.

In Europe, the values of light sweet grades in the North Sea were supported by firm demand from European refiners in the first half of October, as a sharp increase in freight costs increased the competitiveness of short-haul grades and closed arbitrage opportunities for similar grades from other regions. Meanwhile, the supply of sour crude improved, including in the Middle East, which weighed on the value of medium sour crude in Europe. Low crack spreads for high-sulphur fuel oil (HSFO) also weighed on sour grades. The Ekofisk-Johan Sverdrup spread widened sharply by $12.69/b, m-o-m, moving from a discount of $1.15/b in September to a premium of $11.54/b in October. The widening reflected the significant weakening of Johan Sverdrup amid increased competition from alternative medium sour grades, while Ekofisk remained relatively well supported. the North Sea Dated-Urals spread also widened by $1.76/b, m-o-m, to average $29.72/b in October.

Graph 1 - 7: Differentials in Asia, Europe and the USGC



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

In Asia, the Tapis-Dubai spread widened by $10.08/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $27.40/b in October. The widening reflected the relative strength of regional light sweet crude, while the sour crude market reacted to improving Middle East sour crude availability and softer demand for long-haul Atlantic Basin supplies due to the sharp increase of freight costs. At the same time, strong middle distillate margins continued to support demand for crude grades with high diesel and jet fuel yields.

In the USGC, the sweet-sour crude differential was affected by improving heavy sour crude availability, particularly from Canada. Rising Canadian flows and transportation constraints resulted in wider discounts for Western Canadian Select, supporting demand from US refiners. Competition from additional heavy crude supplies also weighed on regional sour crude values. Meanwhile, elevated international freight rates continued to weigh on US crude export economics, and the competitiveness of US light sweet crude in other markets. The LLS-Mars spread narrowed by $1.59/b, m-o-m, to average a premium of $0.88/b.

Commodity Markets

Commodity price indices were mixed in October. The energy index advanced, while all indices in the group of non-energy declined.

In the futures market, sentiment weakened in October amid a decline in combined money managers' net length, along with a reduction in combined open interest (OI).

Energy commodity prices displayed relative resilience in October, while in the non-energy group, price performance was generally negative, with 'other minerals and precious metals prices experiencing the biggest losses.

Trends in select energy commodity markets

The energy price index increased in October, rising by 7.1%, m-o-m. The benchmark was supported by positive performance across the entire complex, with European natural gas prices experiencing the biggest gains. Compared with the same period last year, the index was up by 89.3%, y-o-y.

Table 2 - 1: Select energy prices

Commodity	Unit	Monthly average			% Change		Year-to-date	
		Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Oct 26/ Sep 26	Oct 26/ Oct 25	2025	2026
Energy*	*Index*	**118.5**	**149.0**	**159.6**	**7.1**	**89.3**	**91.4**	**124.2**
Coal, Australia	*US$/boe*	12.9	14.0	14.5	3.5	41.7	10.3	12.8
Coal, US	*US$/boe*	7.1	7.2	7.5	3.5	8.1	6.8	7.4
Crude oil, average	*US$/b*	84.4	102.3	108.5	6.1	72.2	68.6	88.8
Natural gas, US	*US$/boe*	15.0	16.0	16.0	0.3	-7.5	18.5	18.8
Natural gas, Europe	*US$/boe*	114.2	137.5	154.2	12.1	161.7	66.9	97.8

*Note: * World Bank commodity price index (2010 = 100).*
Sources: World Bank and OPEC.

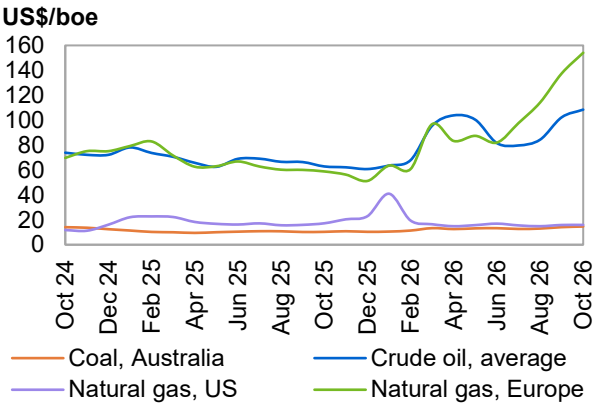
Australian thermal coal prices increased in October by 3.5%, m-o-m. Prices received support from elevated natural gas prices, which strengthened gas-to-coal switching incentives in markets with available generation capacity, and seasonal restocking activities ahead of the northern hemisphere winter. However, softer industrial demand and the availability of alternative seaborne coal supplies limited further gains. Prices were up by 41.7%, y-o-y.

In the US, coal prices increased in October by 3.5%, m-o-m, extending gains from September. Seasonal power sector demand ahead of the winter heating season and stronger export demand lifted prices. However, competition from natural gas and renewable generation continued to constrain coal-fired electricity generation and limit domestic consumption growth. Prices were up by 8.1%, y-o-y.

Average crude oil prices increased in October by 6.1%, m-o-m, amid elevated geopolitical risk premiums on prices, which were up by 72.2%, y-o-y.

Henry Hub natural gas prices edged higher in October by 0.3%, m-o-m. Prices benefited from seasonal heating demand expectations and higher US LNG demand, amid favourable export arbitrage economics, as elevated European natural gas prices and Asian LNG prices maintained wide spreads over Henry Hub. However, rising US underground storage inventories limited upward pressure. According to data from the US Energy Information Administration (EIA), average weekly storage increased by 8.4%, m-o-m, in the period. Prices were down by 7.5%, y-o-y.

Graph 2 - 1: Select energy prices



Sources: World Bank, Haver Analytics and OPEC.

The average Title Transfer Facility (TTF) price rose in October by 12.1%, m-o-m. Prices advanced on the back of relatively low European storage levels ahead of winter, competition with Asian buyers for LNG cargoes and elevated geopolitical risk premiums. However, ongoing storage injections partially mitigated price increases. According to data from Gas Infrastructure Europe (GIE), European storage levels rose by 3.1 percentage points, to 74.7% in October, up from 71.6% in September. However, they remained below the 82.8% level recorded in the same period last year. Prices were up by 161.7%, y-o-y.

Trends in select non-energy commodity markets

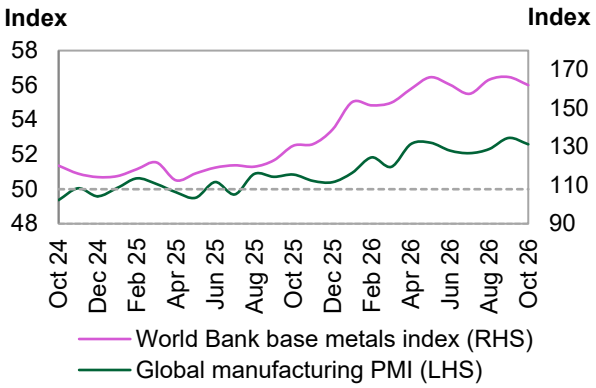
The non-energy price index dropped in October by 1.8%, m-o-m, reflecting weaker prices across the entire non-energy complex. The agriculture index decreased by 1.3%, m-o-m. Compared with the same period last year, non-energy and agriculture indices were higher by 11.5% and 7.3%, y-o-y.

Base metals

The base metal index dropped in October by 2.6%, m-o-m, dragged down by declines across all select metal prices. Higher energy-related input costs, a stronger US dollar and softer global industrial demand weighed on metal prices. The global manufacturing PMI index receded to 52.6 in October, down from 53 the previous month, a 0.8% contraction m-o-m, though it remained in expansionary territory. However, ongoing investment in AI-related infrastructure partially offset losses; it was up by 24%, y-o-y.

At London Metal Exchange (LME) warehouses, combined base metal stocks dropped by 0.5%, m-o-m, in October; however, they were up by 8.5%, y-o-y.

Graph 2 - 2: Global manufacturing PMI and World Bank base metals index



Sources: JP Morgan, IHS Markit, Haver Analytics, World Bank and OPEC.

Table 2 - 2: Non-energy commodity prices

Commodity	Unit	Monthly average			% changes		Year-to-date	
		Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Oct 26/ Sep 26	Oct 26/ Oct 25	2025	2026
Non-energy*	*Index*	**128.8**	**130.5**	**128.2**	**-1.8**	**11.5**	**115.2**	**125.7**
Agriculture*	*Index*	**119.4**	**121.4**	**119.8**	**-1.3**	**7.3**	**116.4**	**115.6**
Base metal*	*Index*	**164.8**	**166.2**	**161.9**	**-2.6**	**24.0**	**119.7**	**159.6**
Copper	*US$/mt*	14,314	14,490	14,478	-0.1	34.7	9,686	13,549
Aluminium	*US$/mt*	3,252	3,284	3,069	-6.5	10.0	2,590	3,304
Nickel	*US$/mt*	16,770	16,327	15,469	-5.3	2.2	15,276	17,185
Lead	*US$/mt*	1,865	1,882	1,867	-0.8	-5.6	1,969	1,915
Zinc	*US$/mt*	3,838	3,996	3,799	-4.9	23.9	2,803	3,539
Iron Ore	*US$/mt*	96	97	91	-6.2	-14.2	102	101

*Note: * World Bank commodity price indices (2010 = 100).*

Sources: LME, Haver Analytics, World Bank and OPEC.

Copper prices dropped marginally in October by 0.1%, m-o-m, while remaining higher by 34.7%, y-o-y. At LME warehouses, stocks increased by 1.2%, m-o-m, and were up by 79.8%, y-o-y.

Aluminium prices dropped in October by 6.5%, m-o-m, but remained up by 10%, y-o-y. LME stocks decreased by 2.7%, m-o-m, and were down by 52.1%, y-o-y.

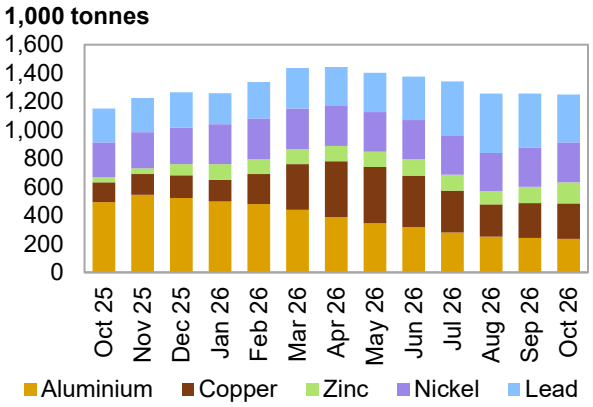
Nickel prices dropped in October by 5.3%, m-o-m, while remaining higher by 2.2%, y-o-y. LME stocks increased by 1.9%, m-o-m, and were higher by 15.5%, y-o-y.

Lead prices dropped in October by 0.8%, m-o-m, and were lower by 5.6%, y-o-y. LME stocks decreased by 11.2%, m-o-m, though they were up by 41%, y-o-y.

Zinc prices dropped in October by 4.9%, m-o-m, while remaining higher by 23.9%, y-o-y. LME stocks grew by 29.9%, m-o-m, and were higher by 294.9%, y-o-y.

Iron ore prices dropped in October by 6.2%, m-o-m, and were lower by 14.2%, y-o-y. Prices were pressured by persistent weakness in China's property sector and softer construction-related steel demand. China manufacturing PMI fell to 49.3 in October, down from 50.1 in September, a decline of 1.8%, m-o-m.

Graph 2 - 3: Inventories at the LME



Sources: LME, Thomson Reuters and OPEC.

Precious metals

The precious metals index dropped in October by 6.2%, m-o-m, amid lower precious metal prices over the period. The index was up by 3.3%, y-o-y.

Table 2 - 3: Precious metal prices

Commodity	Unit	Monthly average			% changes		Year-to-date	
		Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Oct 26/ Sep 26	Oct 26/ Oct 25	2025	2026
Precious metals*	*Index*	**345.2**	**338.6**	**317.6**	**-6.2**	**3.3**	**245.7**	**357.7**
Gold	*US$/Oz*	4,411	4,319	4,105	-5.0	1.2	3,290	4,507
Silver	*US$/Oz*	65.4	64.6	57.0	-11.8	15.4	36.5	71.8
Platinum	*US$/Oz*	1,780	1,784	1,621	-9.1	0.3	1,188	1,918

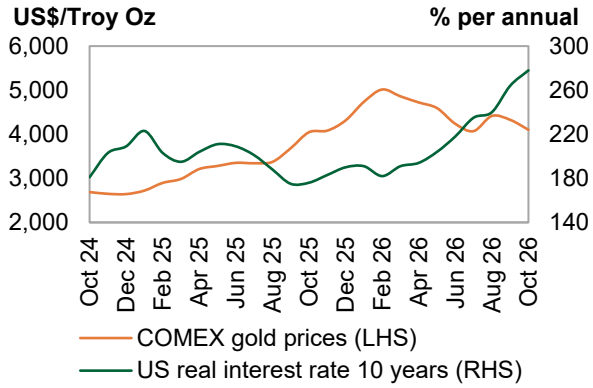
*Note: * World Bank commodity price index (2010 = 100).*

Sources: World Bank and OPEC.

Gold prices dropped in October by 5%, m-o-m. Higher US real interest rates, a stronger US dollar, and expectations of further Federal Reserve tightening weighed on prices. The 10-year inflation-indexed Treasury yield increased by 0.14 percentage points, m-o-m, to 2.78% from 2.64% in September. However, renewed safe-haven demand partially offset losses. Prices were up by 1.2%, y-o-y.

Silver and platinum prices dropped by 11.8% and 9.1%, m-o-m, respectively, in October. Softer sentiment for precious metals weighed on both, while weaker industrial demand added more downward pressure. Nonetheless, silver and platinum prices remained higher by 15.4% and 0.3%, y-o-y, respectively.

Graph 2 - 4: US real interest rate and gold price



Sources: Commodity Exchange Inc., Federal Reserve Board, Haver Analytics and OPEC.

Select other minerals

The 'other minerals' price index dropped in October by 14.7%, m-o-m, pressured by broad weakness across the 'other minerals' complex. The index was down by 4.9%, y-o-y.

Table 2 - 4: Select other minerals prices

Commodity	Unit	Monthly average			% changes		Year-to-date	
		Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Oct 26/ Sep 26	Oct 26/ Oct 25	2025	2026
Other minerals*	*Index*	**72.2**	**58.8**	**50.2**	**-14.7**	**-4.9**	**41.0**	**69.5**
Cobalt	*US$/mt*	55,921	42,128	36,356	-13.7	-15.9	31,945	52,567
Graphite	*US$/mt*	425	425	415	-2.2	-2.2	433	421
Lithium	*US$/mt*	19,844	19,971	16,056	-19.6	55.0	9,397	20,727

*Note: * OPEC price index (2022 = 100).*

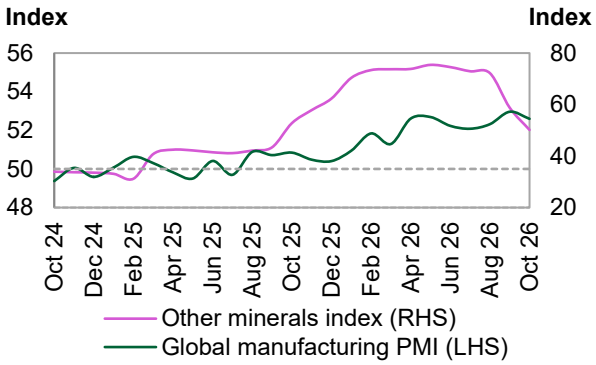
Sources: LME, Haver Analytics and OPEC.

Cobalt prices dropped in October by 13.7%, m-o-m, and were lower by 15.9%, y-o-y. Prices were pressured by expectations of improved supply availability. However, policy and ongoing demand from battery makers limited the decline.

Graphite prices dropped by 2.2%, m-o-m in October, and were lower by 2.2%, y-o-y. Ample supply and cautious downstream procurement weighed on prices.

Lithium prices dropped in October by 19.6%, m-o-m, though they remained higher by 55%, y-o-y. Prices were pressured by expectations of additional supply, elevated inventories and cautious buying.

Graph 2 - 5: Global manufacturing PMI and other minerals index*



*Note: * OPEC price index (2022 = 100).*
Sources: JP Morgan, Haver Analytics, IHS Markit, LME and OPEC.

Investment flows into commodities

Combined money managers' net length dropped in October by 56.5%, m-o-m. The decline was driven by reduced net long positions across all select commodities in the period. Compared with the same period last year, combined net length was up by 0.7%, y-o-y,

Combined OI decreased by 1.9%, m-o-m, driven by lower participation in crude oil, natural gas and gold; however, a higher copper OI partially offset the decline. Combined OI was lower by 3%, y-o-y.

Table 2 - 5: CFTC data on non-commercial positions, 1,000 contracts

Selected commodity	Open interest			Long		Short		Net length				
	Sep 26	Oct 26	Oct 26/ Sep 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Sep 26	% OI	Oct 26	% OI	Oct 26/ Sep 26
Crude oil (WTI)	2,563	2,555	***-0.3%***	225	187	93	84	132	5	102	4	***-22.7%***
Natural gas (HH)	1,828	1,755	***-4.0%***	255	212	351	371	-97	-5	-158	-9	***-63.3%***
Gold	570	526	***-7.7%***	144	127	10	16	135	24	110	21	***-17.9%***
Copper	310	335	***8.0%***	93	71	16	19	76	25	53	16	***-30.9%***
Total	**5,272**	**5,171**	***-1.9%***	**717**	**597**	**471**	**490**	**246**	**48**	**107**	**32**	***-56.5%***

Note: Data in this table is based on a monthly average.
Data in this table is based on commitments of traders' futures and options.
Open interest includes both commercial and non-commercial positions.
Sources: CFTC and OPEC.

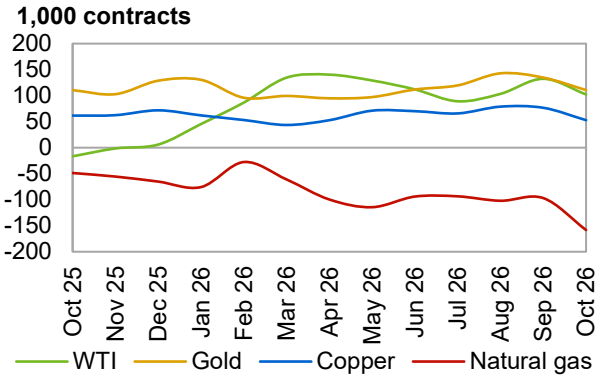
Crude oil's (WTI) OI and money managers' net length dropped in October by 0.3% and 22.7%, m-o-m, respectively. However, compared with the same period last year, OI and net length were up by 2.9% and 718.1%, y-o-y.

Natural gas (Henry Hub) OI and net length dropped by 4% and 63.3%, m-o-m, respectively, in October. Compared with the same period last year, OI was up by 5.1%, y-o-y, while net length was down by 224.8%, y-o-y.

Gold's OI and net length dropped in October by 7.7% and 17.9%, m-o-m, respectively. OI was down by 39.8%, y-o-y, while net length was slightly higher by 0.2%, y-o-y.

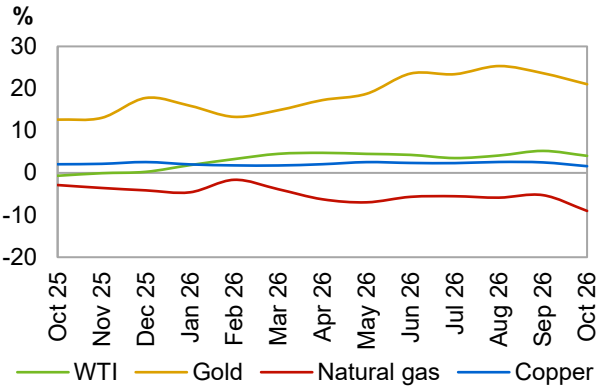
Copper's OI increased by 8%, m-o-m, in October while money managers reduced net length by 30.9%, m-o-m over the same period. OI was higher by 10.6%, y-o-y, while net length was down by 14.1%.

Graph 2 - 6: Money managers' activity in key commodities, net length



Note: Data on this graph is based on a monthly average.
Sources: CFTC and OPEC.

Graph 2 - 7: Money managers' activity in key commodities, as % of open interest



Note: Data on this graph is based on a monthly average.
Sources: CFTC and OPEC.

World Economy

Economic growth across all major economies has held up well so far this year, underscoring the underlying resilience of the global economy. This is despite for ongoing geopolitical conflicts, renewed inflationary pressures and rising global bond yields. The latest economic growth data for 3Q26 has further reinforced this assessment, with growth in the United States, the Eurozone and China all coming in above market expectations and confirming the robust growth dynamic in the global economy.

In OECD economies, the United States contributed strongly to this positive momentum, while the Eurozone expanded more than expected, confirming the continued resilience of economic activity. Japan, meanwhile, continued to record healthy expansion throughout the year. Elsewhere, growth in non-OECD economies has been particularly robust, supported by global investment in AI, strong expansion in international trade and fiscal measures that have helped cushion these economies from the impact of higher energy costs. In China, economic growth has slightly exceeded market expectations this year, with exports and manufacturing remaining key drivers of expansion, supported by the continued growth of the high-end technology sector. In India, economic growth in 1H26 also exceeded expectations and was the strongest among all major economies. Government spending is expected to continue supporting the economy through infrastructure investments, while the services sector remains a key driver of growth and manufacturing benefits from structural reforms. Brazil has maintained steady growth, supported by its commodities sector and domestic resilience, while Russia's economy contracted at the beginning of the year, recovered in 2Q26, and is now expected to maintain stable growth for the remainder of 2026.

This resilience is expected to be sustained through the end of the year and into 2027. Robust momentum in AI spending, coupled with consumer spending across the major economies, is anticipated to remain the principal driver of growth, complemented in China by continued government-led support and in India by the country's considerable growth dynamic. While an easing of geopolitical tensions may provide some further upside to global economic growth, the evolution of inflation and related developments in global financial conditions require close monitoring. The stronger-than-expected economic growth recorded in 3Q26, particularly in the United States, the Eurozone and China, confirms the solid pace of global economic expansion seen in 1H26. This has led to an upward revision in the global growth forecast for 2026 to 3.1%, from 3% in the previous month's assessment. The global growth forecast for 2027 remains unchanged at a healthy 3.2%.

Table 3 - 1: Economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	World	US	Eurozone	Japan	China	India	Brazil	Russia
2026	**3.1**	**2.3**	**1.0**	**0.8**	**4.6**	**7.3**	**2.0**	**1.0**
Change from previous month	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.1	0.0	0.7	0.0	-0.1
2027	**3.2**	**2.1**	**1.1**	**0.8**	**4.5**	**6.8**	**2.1**	**1.5**
Change from previous month	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.3	-0.1	0.0

*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast. The GDP numbers are based on 2021 ppp.*

Source: OPEC.

Update on the latest global developments

The latest output data has reinforced the outlook for steady global economic growth. Following stronger-than-expected growth across all major economies in 3Q26, the global economy entered 4Q26 with solid momentum, despite ongoing geopolitical tensions, above-target inflation, elevated bond yields and associated uncertainties. In the US, real GDP expanded by 3.4%, q-o-q, SAAR, equivalent to growth of 2.1%, y-o-y, in 3Q26, and accelerated from 2.2%, q-o-q, SAAR, in 2Q26. The US dynamic was supported by investment, consumer spending and government expenditure. The Eurozone expanded by 0.4%, q-o-q, in 3Q26 – following 0.6% in the previous quarter – while year-on-year growth strengthened to 1.3%. Together, these results indicate that economic activity in the major OECD economies has remained more resilient than market expectations had anticipated.

This robust growth trend in OECD economies was accompanied by continued expansion in the major non-OECD economies. China's economy expanded by 4.5%, y-o-y, in 3Q26, slightly above expectations, bringing growth in the first three quarters to 4.6%. Manufacturing remained particularly resilient, expanding by 5.9% in 3Q26. India has maintained the strongest growth dynamic among the major economies, with growth in 1H26 exceeding expectations. GDP expanded by 7.8%, y-o-y, in 2Q26, well above the Reserve Bank of

India's earlier expectation of around 7%, supported by strong manufacturing and services activity. Across Asia more broadly, the AI investment cycle continues to provide important support to industrial activity, investment and exports.

Fiscal policy continues to support activity in several major economies through infrastructure, defence, energy-related measures, and strategic investment. At the same time, fiscal sustainability and elevated government borrowing have become increasingly important market concerns. Long-term government bond yields rose sharply in several developed economies during September and early October, amplified by resilient growth, persistent inflation, and expectations of tighter monetary policy. The US 10-year Treasury yield reached a multi-decade high in early October before subsequently declining, although financing conditions remain considerably tighter than earlier in the year. Higher long-term borrowing costs could increasingly offset part of the positive growth impulse from fiscal expansion, although equity markets have remained relatively resilient, supported in particular by technology-sector performance.

Trade-policy uncertainty also remains elevated, particularly between the US and several major trading partners. US-China tensions have eased somewhat after the two countries agreed to extend their existing trade truce by two months beyond its scheduled expiry in November, while negotiations on a broader agreement continue. Nevertheless, structural trade tensions remain, including concerns over tariffs, access to critical materials and China's large external surplus.

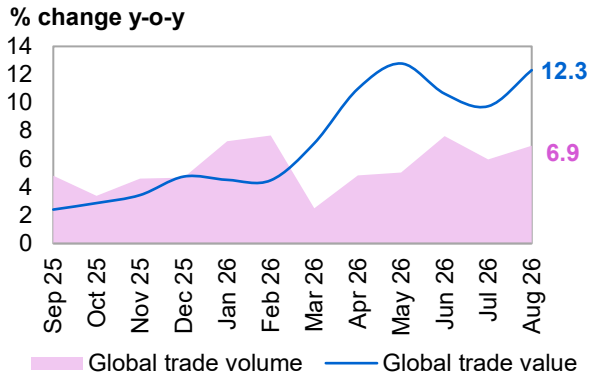
Inflation remains persistent, with recent developments mixed across economies. Eurozone inflation rose to 4% in October, following already elevated 3.8%, y-o-y, in September, and therefore remaining well above the ECB's 2% target. In the US, headline CPI inflation increased to estimated 3.8% in October from 3.7% in September, while core inflation stood at estimated 2.7%, y-o-y, in October, compared with 2.6% in September. The Fed's preferred PCE measure also accelerated from 3.4%, y-o-y, in August to 3.6%, y-o-y, in September with core PCE inflation rising from 3%, y-o-y, in August to 3.1%, y-o-y, in September. Japan's headline and core inflation stood at 2.1% in September, while inflation excluding fresh food and energy reached 2.4%. Chinese inflation remained comparatively subdued at 0.7%. In contrast, India's inflation accelerated to 5.5% in September, strengthening concerns over broadening price pressures. Inflation also increased to 4.6% in Brazil and 6.3% in Russia.

Monetary policy has consequently shifted towards a more restrictive stance. The Fed raised its policy-rate range by 25 bp in September to 3.75–4.00%, before keeping rates unchanged in October as it assesses incoming inflation and economic activity data. The ECB likewise raised rates by 25 bp in September and held them unchanged in late October, while emphasizing continued upside risks to inflation from higher energy prices. The BoJ raised its policy rate to 1.25% in September and maintained that level in October, while continuing to signal that further tightening remains possible. India has now also joined the tightening cycle, with the RBI raising its repo rate by 25 bp to 5.5% in October and shifting its stance to "calibrated tightening" amid stronger growth and rising inflation. Monetary conditions elsewhere remain more diverse. China continues to rely on targeted easing to support domestic demand, while monetary policy in both Brazil and Russia remains comparatively restrictive. Brazil reduced its Selic rate to 13.75% in September, whereas the Bank of Russia kept its key rate unchanged at 14% in October amid persistent underlying inflation pressures.

Global trade continued to expand in both volume and value terms. Y-o-y trade volume growth rose by 6.9% in August, following growth of 6%, y-o-y, in July, and 7.6% in June.

In value terms, global trade increased by 12.3%, y-o-y, in August, following growth of 9.7%, y-o-y, in July and 10.6% in June.

Graph 3 - 1: Global trade



Sources: CPB Netherlands Bureau for Economic Policy Analysis and Haver Analytics.

Near-term global expectations

Looking towards the end of the year and into 2027, the global economy remains on a robust growth trajectory, with recent 3Q26 data from major economies – including the US, the Eurozone and China – indicating that the healthy expansion recorded in 1H26 has continued. Early evidence from 4Q26 points to resilient economic activity despite persistent geopolitical tensions, higher energy prices, and tighter financial conditions, with current momentum

anticipated to carry over into 2027. Continued technology- and AI-related investment remains an important source of support for capital expenditure, high-value manufacturing, and semiconductor-related trade, particularly across emerging Asia and the US. Household demand has also remained broadly resilient, supported by healthy labour markets. In China, policymakers continue to provide targeted support amid persistently soft underlying consumption. India remains supported by government spending, investment, and strong domestic demand, although high energy prices and weaker-than-normal rainfall represent challenges. Brazil continues to benefit from strong commodity-sector activity, agriculture, and resilient consumption, as well from ongoing fiscal expansion that may, however, pose challenges in the coming year. Russia has also seen continued support from the commodity sector, although capacity constraints and elevated inflation remain headwinds. The principal areas to monitor in the near term are renewed inflationary pressures, further monetary tightening and rising sovereign bond yields, which are increasingly contributing to tighter global financial conditions.

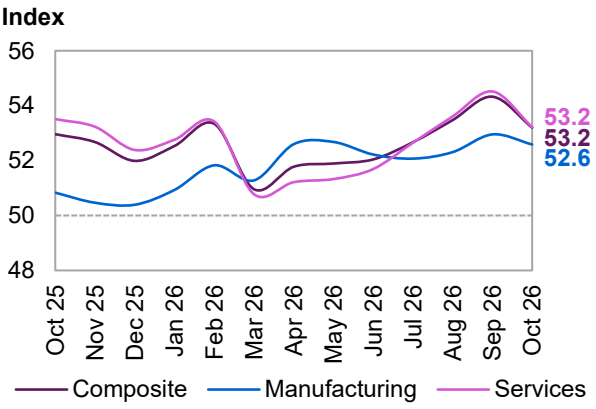
Artificial intelligence remains an important source of support for the global economy, although its impact differs considerably across countries. The United States has recorded the largest increase in AI investment, while Asian producers, particularly Taiwan and Korea, have benefitted strongly from semiconductor and technology-related manufacturing and exports. Europe has benefitted mainly through data-centre investment and broader supply-chain effects. Research by Goldman Sachs and the International Monetary Fund indicates that AI investment is already making a meaningful contribution to global economic growth, even before potentially larger productivity gains from broader AI adoption materialize. Current estimates suggest that AI-related investment could contribute around 0.4–0.5 percentage points to global GDP growth in 2026, with a broadly similar contribution possible in 2027. These estimates should be treated with some caution, however, as higher equipment prices, import dependence and other offsetting effects reduce the impact on real GDP. Nevertheless, against global growth of around 3%, AI investment represents a significant source of support for the global economy.

In light of rising headline inflation, monetary policy has shifted more decisively towards tightening as persistent price pressures, resilient economic activity and renewed inflation concerns have reduced the scope for easing. Following the Fed's most recent decision in October to keep the key policy rate unchanged, subsequent communication has indicated that further tightening remains possible. The ECB similarly kept interest rate levels unchanged, while policymakers have signalled that additional tightening will depend on the persistence of underlying price pressures. Similarly, the BoJ's recent communication points to a continued tightening bias amid persistent inflation and yen weakness. In the UK, Bank of England policymakers have highlighted the inflationary implications of higher energy prices. Emerging-market monetary policy remains more differentiated. The RBI faces increasing inflation risks from higher energy and food prices, while Brazil has maintained a restrictive stance amid persistent inflation pressures and is likely to continue doing so. Russia continues to face a difficult trade-off between weak growth and elevated inflation, limiting the scope for further easing.

Looking ahead to 2027, however, there is a reasonable likelihood that headline inflation will moderate, provided that the exceptional commodity price increases associated with this year's geopolitical developments and adverse weather conditions are not repeated on a similar scale. As inflation is measured on a year-on-year basis, the sharp price increases recorded during 2026 will gradually drop out of the annual comparison, likely creating dampening base effects during 2027. This should be particularly visible in energy inflation and could allow headline inflation to decline even if underlying price levels remain elevated. Recent IMF projections broadly support such a profile, although the extent of the decline will depend on the persistence of second-round effects on wages and services prices and, importantly, on the absence of renewed geopolitical or commodity-price shocks. Meanwhile, the combination of resilient global growth and persistent inflation is likely to keep monetary conditions relatively tight. Higher debt-servicing costs and changing interest-rate differentials therefore remain important risks, particularly for highly indebted governments and currencies exposed to shifts in global capital flows.

Global PMIs strengthened further in October, confirming the trend of continued growth across sectors and regions. The global Manufacturing PMI eased slightly to 52.6 in October from 53 in September, but remained firmly in expansionary territory for a fifteenth consecutive month. Global manufacturing output continued to grow at a solid pace, with new orders, exports and employment also remaining supportive, although momentum moderated slightly from September's multi-year highs. The expansion remained broad-based across consumer, intermediate and investment goods, while technology- and AI-related demand continued to support manufacturing activity, particularly across Asia and the US.

Graph 3 - 2: Global PMI



Sources: JP Morgan, S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

The global Services PMI eased to 53.2 in October from 54.5 in September, following 53.6 in August. Despite the moderation, the index remained firmly above the 50 thresholds, indicating continued solid expansion in global services activity. Growth in business activity and new orders slowed from September's strong pace, while business confidence weakened amid elevated uncertainty. Nevertheless, services continued to provide an important contribution to global growth at the start of 4Q26.

Overall, the global outlook remains healthy across sectors and regions, underpinned by resilient private consumption in most major economies. Fiscal support, technology investment – particularly in AI – and solid global trade continue to provide additional support to activity. Stronger-than-expected 3Q26 growth in the US, Eurozone, and China, together with India's particularly strong performance in 1H26, further confirms the resilience of the global economy. Reflecting these developments, the 2026 global growth forecast has been revised up to 3.1% from 3% in the previous month's assessment.

Table 3 - 2: World economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	World
2026	**3.1**
Change from previous month	0.1
2027	**3.2**
Change from previous month	0.0

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

In 2027, the prospect of continued technology-led investment and fiscal support, alongside easing inflation and consequently more accommodative monetary policies, is anticipated to underpin global economic growth. Combined with continued healthy momentum in manufacturing and global trade, this is expected to lift global growth to 3.2%, unchanged from the previous month's assessment.

OECD

US

Update on the latest developments

The US economy remains resilient, with the latest data confirming strong underlying momentum. Economic growth stood at 3.4%, q-o-q, SAAR, and 2.1%, y-o-y, in 3Q26, accelerating from 2.2%, q-o-q, SAAR, in 2Q26 and exceeding market expectations. Growth was supported by robust private consumption and investment, including continued strong spending on information-processing equipment and AI-related infrastructure. Final sales to private domestic purchasers increased by a particularly strong 4.9%, q-o-q, SAAR, highlighting the strength of underlying domestic demand. The labour market has softened somewhat, but remains broadly healthy, while inflation continues to exceed the Fed's target.

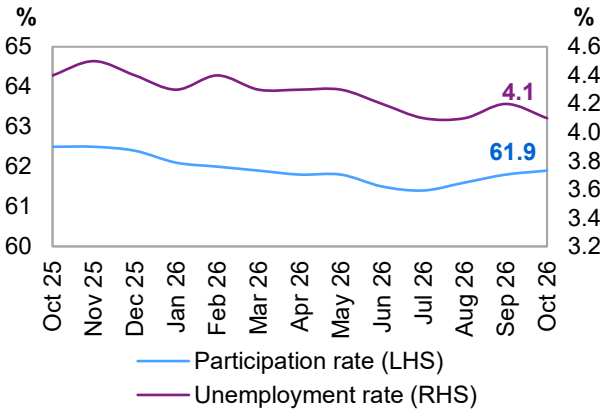
The 3Q26 GDP release further strengthens the picture of an economy that has performed better than expected during 2026. Consumer spending increased by 3.8%, q-o-q, SAAR, in 3Q26 and contributed 2.5 percentage points to overall GDP growth. Gross private domestic investment increased by 19.4%, q-o-q, SAAR. Equipment investment rose particularly strongly by 20.9%, while investment in information-processing equipment increased by 37.3%, highlighting the continued strength of technology- and AI-related investment. These gains were partly offset by the external sector. Exports declined by 5.7%, q-o-q, SAAR, while imports increased by 19.7%, with capital goods accounting for an important part of the increase. Hence, resilient domestic demand and investment continue to outweigh softness in the external sector.

Household spending therefore remains an important driver of growth, although some challenges have remained. Real disposable income declined by 0.3%, m-o-m, in September, while the household saving rate fell to 3.8% in September from 4% in August. Consumer confidence nevertheless recovered markedly in October, with the Conference Board index rising to 91.7 from 84.2 in September, partially reversing three consecutive monthly declines. Financial conditions also remain relatively restrictive. The 10-year US Treasury yield rose to around 5.3% in early October before easing to around 4.9% by early November, but long-term borrowing costs remain elevated and continue to pose a headwind to interest-sensitive parts of the economy.

At its most recent meeting on 28 October, the FOMC kept the federal funds target range unchanged at 3.75–4.00%, following the 25 bp increase in September. The decision was taken by a 10–2 vote, with two members favouring another 25 bp increase. The Fed highlighted strong economic activity, resilient domestic spending, and robust capital investment, while stressing that inflation remains elevated and further tightening remains possible. Headline CPI inflation increased to estimated 3.8% in October from 3.7%, y-o-y, in September, while core CPI stood at estimated 2.7%, y-o-y, in October, compared with 2.6% in September. The Fed's preferred PCE measure also accelerated from 3.4%, y-o-y, in August to 3.6%, y-o-y, in September with core PCE inflation rising from 3%, y-o-y, in August to at 3.1%, y-o-y, in September. Combined with stronger-than-expected growth, these developments suggest that the Fed has limited scope to ease policy in the near term.

The October labour-market report pointed to a renewed strengthening in hiring after a somewhat soft September reading. Nonfarm payrolls increased by 165,000, well above the average monthly gain of 48,000 over the preceding 12 months. In addition, earlier estimates were revised substantially higher. August payroll growth was raised from 133,000 to 186,000 and September from 29,000 to 60,000, adding a combined 84,000 jobs to previous estimates. Moreover, the unemployment rate edged down to 4.1% from 4.2% in September, while the labour-force participation rate increased further to 61.9% from 61.8%. Average hourly earnings rose by 3.1%, y-o-y, indicating that wage growth remains firm but broadly consistent with gradually cooling inflation.

Graph 3 - 3: US monthly labour market



Sources: Bureau of Labor Statistics and Haver Analytics.

Near-term expectations

Recent data continues to point to a healthy US growth trajectory, with a strong 3Q26 performance providing a solid starting point for near-term activity. Underlying domestic demand remains sound, supported by resilient household consumption and a labour market that, despite slower hiring, continues to benefit from relatively low unemployment and limited layoffs. Continued AI-related capital spending, broader technology investment and some continued rebuilding of inventories should provide additional support through the remainder of 2026 and, assuming this momentum is sustained, into 2027. Strong imports may continue to weigh statistically on headline GDP through net trade, although this largely reflects robust domestic demand for capital goods, industrial inputs, and technology equipment rather than underlying weakness. Some gradual moderation in household spending could nevertheless emerge from weaker real income growth rather than from a significant deterioration in employment. At the same time, inflation has remained elevated. Monetary policy and financing conditions are therefore likely to remain relatively restrictive in the near term. That said, continued investment momentum, particularly related to AI, together with resilient consumption, should provide a sound basis for continued economic expansion into 2027.

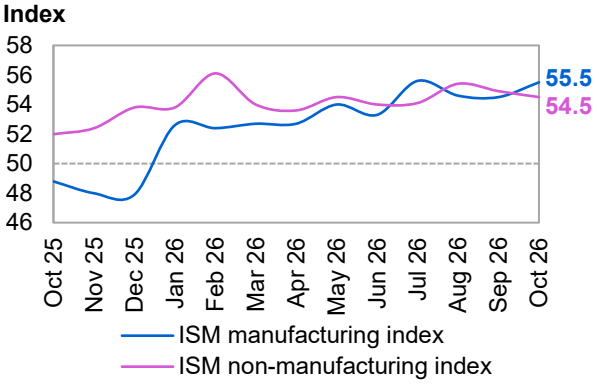
On monetary policy, Fed officials highlighted that the tightening cycle may not yet be complete. Following the last decision to keep the policy rate unchanged at the end of October, the decision-making committee, the Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC), continued to describe inflation as elevated. They also noted that economic activity was expanding at a strong pace, supported by resilient domestic spending, strong productivity growth and robust capital investment. This combination suggests that policymakers remain more concerned about persistent inflation than about any material weakening in activity. The latest formal US Fed guidance from September shows a median year-end federal funds rate of 4.1% for both 2026 and 2027, compared with 3.8% for 2026 and 3.6% for 2027 in the previous US Fed's June guidance. The US Fed's latest September median 2026 PCE inflation forecast was also raised slightly to 3.7% from 3.6% in the previous June forecast, with 2026 core PCE inflation forecast at 3.4% in the September, following the US Fed's previous June forecast of 3.3%. For 2027, the US Fed continued to expect inflation to moderate, with headline PCE inflation forecast at 2.3% and core PCE inflation at 2.5%, both unchanged from the June forecasts. Taken together, the projections and the October meeting suggest that another 25 bp increase remains possible before year-end if inflation stays firm, while the scope for meaningful easing in 2027 appears limited unless inflation declines more rapidly than expected or labour-market conditions weaken materially. Hence, the Fed is likely to maintain a cautious, data-dependent, and relatively restrictive policy stance for some time.

Against a backdrop of tightening financial conditions in the US, the interaction between high public debt, persistent fiscal deficits and elevated long-term interest rates is worth highlighting. According to the Congressional Budget Office (CBO), the federal budget deficit reached an estimated USD 2 trillion in fiscal year 2026, around USD 218 billion more than in the previous fiscal year, while net interest costs continued to rise. The CBO's October analysis also highlights the sensitivity of the fiscal outlook to higher interest rates, as elevated borrowing costs would further increase debt-service expenses and add to future deficits. Against this, substantial Treasury financing needs and concerns over the longer-term fiscal trajectory may contribute to upward pressure on long-term yields. Higher Treasury yields are effectively tightening financial conditions even without additional Fed action, raising financing costs for businesses and households and keeping mortgage rates elevated, thereby weighing on housing affordability and other interest-sensitive areas of the economy. At the same time, higher yields feed back into the fiscal position by increasing the cost of refinancing government debt. Despite these pressures and some associated market volatility, equity markets have remained resilient, supported by solid consumption, a healthy labour market and strong technology- and AI-related investment.

Based on the ISM indices, as provided by the Institute for Supply Management (ISM), data continued to point to expansion across both manufacturing and services.

The Manufacturing PMI increased to 55.5 in October from 54.5 in September, marking the tenth consecutive month of expansion and indicating a further strengthening in industrial activity. New orders edged up to 55.5 from 55.3, while production accelerated more markedly to 59 from 56.7, its strongest level since late 2021. Employment remained in expansionary territory at 52.4, only slightly below 52.7 in September. Inventories rebounded to 51.4 from 48.6, while customers' inventories remained very low at 41.6, continuing to point to potential restocking demand.

Graph 3 - 4: US-ISM manufacturing and non-manufacturing indices



Sources: Institute for Supply Management and Haver Analytics.

The ISM Services PMI eased very slightly to 54.5 in October from 54.9 in September, remaining firmly in expansion territory for a 28th consecutive month.

The stronger-than-expected 3Q26 performance, together with resilient domestic demand and continued investment momentum, has strengthened the near-term US growth outlook. As a result, the 2026 growth forecast has been revised up to 2.3% from 2.2% in the previous month's assessment. Looking into 2027, the healthy growth dynamic is expected to carry over, supported by continued consumer spending, business investment, and AI-related capital expenditure. Growth is nevertheless expected to moderate somewhat as fiscal support and other temporary effects fade. That said, the stronger starting point from late 2026 has led to an upward revision in the 2027 growth forecast to 2.1% from 2% in the previous month's assessment. As indicated by the latest October ISM survey numbers, private inventories should also become a more supportive factor in the near term, especially as some replenishment is likely to continue through late 2026 and become an even more meaningful contributor to growth in 1H27.

Table 3 - 3: US economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	US
2026	**2.3**
Change from previous month	0.1
2027	**2.1**
Change from previous month	0.1

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

Eurozone

Update on the latest developments

Recent Eurozone data continues to point to resilient growth momentum. GDP expanded by 0.4%, q-o-q, in 3Q26. This was equivalent to around 1.6%, q-o-q, SAAR, and followed growth of 0.6% in 2Q26. The outcome was above market expectations. Annual growth strengthened to 1.3%, y-o-y, from 1.2%, y-o-y. Performance across member states remained uneven. Germany expanded by 0.2%, q-o-q, and Spain by 0.6%, q-o-q, while Italy stagnated and France contracted slightly by 0.1%, q-o-q. Overall, the 3Q26 result confirms that the Eurozone economy has remained more resilient than expected, supported by household consumption, fiscal spending, infrastructure and defence investment. In addition, digitalization and AI-related business investment are also increasingly playing a supportive role. The labour market remains an important source of resilience, although some gradual softening is evident. The Eurozone unemployment rate stood at 6.5% in September, unchanged from August but up from 6.3% a year earlier.

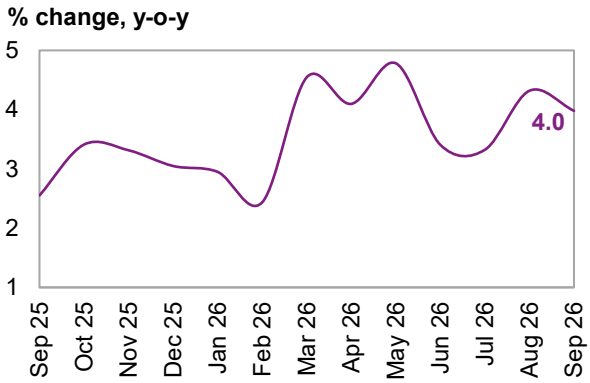
Monetary policy has shifted towards a more restrictive stance in recent months. In September, the ECB raised its three key policy rates by 25 bp, taking the deposit facility rate to 2.5%. This was in response to renewed inflationary pressures that were particularly related to higher energy prices. September ECB staff projections foresaw headline inflation averaging 3% in 2026 and 2.5% in 2027, while growth was revised up to 0.9% and 1.4%, respectively, reflecting greater-than-expected economic resilience. At its October meeting, however, the ECB kept rates unchanged at 2.50%, 2.65% and 2.90%, noting that financing conditions had already tightened and outlining that underlying inflation and wages had so far shown limited second-round effects. Nevertheless, continued energy-price pressures leave open the possibility of further tightening, with the ECB maintaining a data-dependent, meeting-by-meeting approach.

Inflation remains the principal near-term challenge. Headline inflation accelerated to 4% in October, following 3.8%, y-o-y, in September and 3.2% in August. Core inflation excluding energy, food, alcohol, and tobacco edged up to 2.6%, following 2.5% in September. The increase in inflation therefore extends beyond energy,

but underlying pressures remain considerably more contained than the headline rate, and there is still limited evidence of significant wage-related second-round effects. Overall, although this combination of resilient economic growth and above-target inflation is likely to keep ECB policy relatively restrictive in the near term, favourable energy base effects should support a gradual moderation in headline inflation during 2027, assuming no renewed geopolitical or commodity-price shock of a similar magnitude.

Retail activity weakened in September, with Eurozone retail trade volumes falling by 0.7%, m-o-m, while annual growth slowed to 0.4%, y-o-y, pointing to softer household spending momentum at the start of 4Q26. Retail sales values increased by 4%, y-o-y. Sentiment weakened further in October. The European Commission's Economic Sentiment Indicator fell very slightly to 96.9 from 97.5 in September, marking the second consecutive monthly decline, although employment expectations improved. Industrial activity remained comparatively weak. Eurozone industrial production declined by 1.2%, y-o-y, in August and by 0.5%, m-o-m, following a 0.3% monthly decline in July.

Graph 3 - 5: Eurozone retail sales



Sources: Statistical Office of the European Communities and Haver Analytics.

Near-term expectations

The Eurozone growth outlook has improved gradually over recent months, with stronger-than-expected activity suggesting that the economy is absorbing energy, trade, and financial-market headwinds better than previously anticipated. GDP expanded by 0.4%, q-o-q, and 1.3%, y-o-y, in 3Q26, following growth of 0.6%, q-o-q, in 2Q26. Of note, the expectation of healthy growth towards the end of the year also provides a relatively solid starting point for 2027. Reflecting this resilience, the ECB raised its September growth forecasts to 0.9% for 2026 and 1.4% for 2027, up from 0.8% and 1.2%, respectively.

Domestic demand should increasingly support growth into 2027. The labour market remains resilient, and wage income should continue to underpin household consumption, while real income growth should improve as the exceptional energy-price increases of 2026 gradually drop out of annual inflation comparisons. Fiscal policy is also becoming a more important growth driver, particularly through higher infrastructure, defence, and energy-related investment, while digitalization, data-centre construction and AI-related capital expenditure should provide additional support to business investment.

Germany remains central to this improving outlook. Fiscal expansion in infrastructure and defence should provide a stronger impulse during 2027, while Germany's ifo Institute has raised its growth forecasts to 1.4% for 2026 and 1.2% for 2027. Structural weakness in traditional industries, including autos, chemicals and machinery, remains a constraint, but the growth base should gradually broaden towards infrastructure, defence, technology, and services. Measures aimed at improving investment conditions, reducing administrative burdens, and strengthening labour supply could also gradually support potential growth.

Monetary policy is nevertheless likely to remain relatively restrictive in the near term. Following a 25 bp increase in September, the ECB kept rates unchanged in October, leaving the deposit rate at 2.50%. With growth proving more resilient and headline inflation remaining elevated, the ECB is likely to retain the option of further tightening. However, if energy-related inflation moderates during 2027 as expected, base effects and softer underlying price pressures should reduce the need for additional rate increases and could allow monetary conditions to become gradually less restrictive later in the coming year.

External trade remains an important element of the outlook, albeit one that also remains uncertain to some degree. Eurozone exports continued to grow strongly in August, but even faster import growth, partly reflecting higher energy costs, resulted in a €16.1bn trade deficit. Trade relations with the US have become somewhat more predictable following the latest tariff arrangements, although sector-specific restrictions and implementation risks remain. At the same time, the EU continues to diversify its external trade relationships through agreements with Mercosur, India, and deeper links with other Indo-Pacific economies. These initiatives should gradually broaden export opportunities and reduce reliance on traditional trading partners.

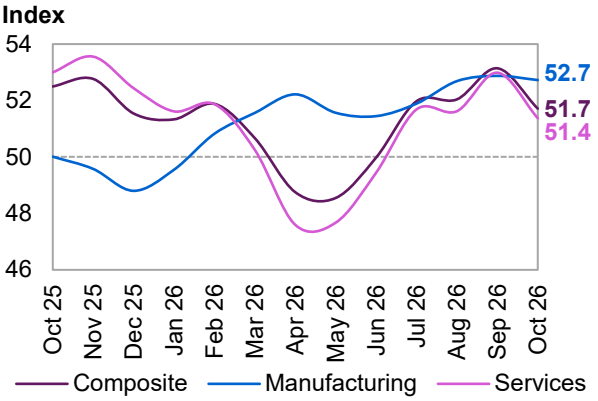
Overall, the Eurozone outlook for 2027 has improved. Fiscal expansion, resilient household demand, improving real incomes and rising investment should support a gradual strengthening in growth, with Germany providing an important additional impulse. Persistent inflation, elevated financing costs, renewed challenges in the energy sector and trade tensions remain key risks, but the stronger-than-expected 3Q26 performance suggests that the Eurozone enters 2027 from a firmer base than previously anticipated.

October PMI readings point to continued expansion across the Eurozone, although momentum moderated from the very strong September levels.

The Manufacturing PMI eased slightly to 52.7 in October from 52.9 in September, remaining firmly in expansionary territory and above the preliminary flash estimate of 52.4. Export orders increased at their fastest pace in more than four years, although domestic new-order growth softened and higher energy and supply-chain costs increased pressure on manufacturers.

The Services PMI eased to 51.4 in October from 53 in September, indicating that services activity continued to expand at the start of 4Q26, but at a noticeably slower pace. New business growth weakened and overall demand became less supportive, while employment declined slightly and business confidence softened.

Graph 3 - 6: Eurozone PMIs



Sources: S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

The stronger-than-expected growth dynamic through 3Q26, together with continued expansion – as also highlighted in the latest PMI indicators – suggests that the Eurozone economy is entering 4Q26 with firmer momentum than previously anticipated. Resilient household demand, improving real-income prospects and stronger fiscal and investment support, particularly in Germany, have therefore led to an upward revision in the 2026 growth forecast to 1% from 0.8% in the previous month's assessment.

Table 3 - 4: Eurozone economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	Eurozone
2026	**1.0**
Change from previous month	0.2
2027	**1.1**
Change from previous month	0.1

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

Looking at 2027, growth is expected to remain supported by expansionary fiscal policy, particularly infrastructure and defence spending, alongside continued digitalization, and AI-related investment. Improving real incomes and a gradual moderation in inflation should also provide additional support to household consumption, while new EU trade agreements are expected to broaden external growth opportunities. Reflecting stronger momentum at the end of this year and the consequent carry-over, the 2027 growth forecast has been revised up to 1.1% from the previous month's assessment of 1%.

Japan

Update on latest developments

Japan's economic growth momentum has been well maintained since the beginning of October, supported by strong exports, continued AI- and semiconductor-related investment and a very tight labour market, although domestic demand remains more uneven. Export growth has remained robust, particularly in technology-related sectors, while corporate investment in data centres, machinery and digital infrastructure continues to provide an important source of support heading into 2027. Wage growth also remains relatively firm and should gradually strengthen household purchasing power, although consumption has so far responded only modestly as elevated food and energy costs continue to weigh on real incomes. Inflation remains above the Bank of Japan's 2% target, and the weak yen continues to add to imported inflationary pressures, leaving the monetary-policy outlook tilted towards further gradual tightening following the September rate increase to 1.25%. The BoJ kept rates unchanged in October, but another increase remains possible if wage and price pressures stay firm. Fiscal policy should partly offset these headwinds: the government is considering continued support for electricity and gas bills even as gasoline subsidies are gradually phased out from December, while additional household-oriented measures, including a possible temporary reduction in the consumption tax on food from 2027, could provide further support to real disposable incomes.

At the same time, higher energy prices and continued yen weakness have increased imported inflationary pressures, while domestic demand remains steady. These developments have led the BoJ to continue normalizing monetary policy, maintaining a tightening bias that reflects greater confidence in the sustainability of the wage-price cycle and increased concern over persistent inflation. Financial conditions have also become an increasingly important transmission channel, with long-term sovereign yields rising markedly and adding to government financing costs. Fiscal policy is therefore facing a more constrained environment, requiring a balance between support for domestic demand and strategic investment on the one hand and debt sustainability on the

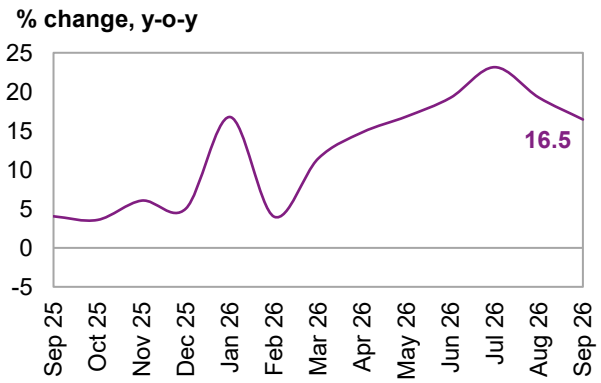
other. Japan thus appears to be transitioning towards an environment of higher inflation and interest rates, with the economy so far adjusting very well to this gradual shift.

Recent activity indicators point to a mixed economic picture. Industrial production rebounded by 2.2%, m-o-m, in September, reversing much of August's decline, with manufacturers expecting a further increase in October. Household demand remains less convincing, with retail sales increasing by 2.3%, y-o-y, in September, but declining by 0.7%, m-o-m, for a second consecutive monthly fall that suggests continued pressure from elevated living costs. Consumer confidence also eased to 34.8 in October from 35.4 in September. The labour market nevertheless remains tight, with the unemployment rate declining to 2.4% in September from 2.5% in August, while the latest available wage data showed real wages increasing by 1.5%, y-o-y, in August, providing some support to household purchasing power.

Inflationary pressures remain persistent. Nationwide headline CPI and core inflation excluding fresh food both increased to 2.1%, y-o-y, in September, while inflation excluding fresh food and energy rose to 2.4%. More timely Tokyo data point to continued underlying pressures in October: core inflation eased slightly to 2.6%, y-o-y, from 2.7% in September, while the measure excluding fresh food and energy remained elevated at 2.6%. Against this backdrop, the BoJ kept its policy rate unchanged at 1.25% in October following September's 25 bp increase, but maintained a tightening bias and indicated that further increases remain likely if its inflation outlook materializes. The October Outlook Report raised the FY2026 real GDP forecast to 0.7% while lowering FY2027 growth slightly to 0.7%; core inflation is projected at 2.5% in FY2026 and 2.6% in FY2027. With inflation risks assessed as tilted to the upside, another rate increase remains possible, although the timing will depend on wage developments, domestic demand and the impact of elevated energy and import costs.

On a non-seasonally adjusted basis, exports continued to expand strongly in September, rising by 16.5%, y-o-y, following a 19.3% increase in August and marking a thirteenth consecutive annual gain. Export growth remained supported by semiconductors, chipmaking equipment and other AI-related products. However, the moderation from August suggests that external momentum is normalizing somewhat. Imports also remained strong, increasing by 18.9%, y-o-y, although this was well below August's 28.1% rise as energy-import growth moderated. With imports still outpacing exports, Japan recorded a trade deficit of JPY 556.6 bn in September.

Graph 3 - 7: Japan's exports



Sources: Ministry of Finance, Japan Tariff Association and Haver Analytics.

Near-term expectations

Japan's economy is expected to continue expanding at a moderate pace through the remainder of 2026 and into 2027, supported by resilient exports, AI- and semiconductor-related demand, corporate investment and fiscal support. Business conditions remain comparatively firm as the September BoJ Tankan showed sentiment among large manufacturers rising to +24 from +22, while confidence among large non-manufacturers remained high despite easing to +35 from +37. Firms also expect fixed investment to remain robust, particularly in manufacturing and technology-related sectors. Household fundamentals are gradually improving, with real wages rising by 1.5%, y-o-y, in August and the tight labour market continuing to support incomes, although elevated living costs still constrain consumption. Fiscal policy should provide some additional support. FY2027 ministry budget requests reached a record JPY 143tn, reflecting increased spending plans for growth investment and economic security, although the final budget will be smaller. The government also plans to restore electricity and gas subsidies from December through February, while gradually reducing gasoline subsidies, and intends to lower the consumption tax on food from 8% to 1% for two years from April 2027, subject to parliamentary approval. These measures should support household purchasing power, but also add to fiscal pressures.

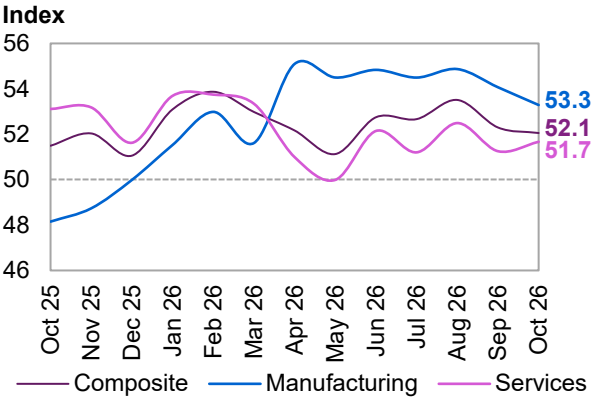
The expansionary fiscal stance is increasingly constrained by Japan's high public debt and elevated government-bond yields. Long-term JGB yields remain historically high as investors weigh larger fiscal commitments, reduced BoJ bond purchases and the prospect of further monetary tightening, increasing government debt-servicing costs and gradually tightening financing conditions across the economy. Monetary policy is also becoming less accommodative. Following September's increase to 1.25%, the BoJ kept its policy rate unchanged in October but raised its inflation outlook and reiterated that further rate increases are likely if its projections materialize. One board member already favoured an increase to 1.5%, while the BoJ Governor indicated that another rate increase could be considered as early as the December meeting. With underlying inflation now assessed as being around the 2% target, continued wage growth, elevated energy costs and yen-related import-price pressures strengthen the case for further gradual tightening into 2027. Overall, investment, exports and fiscal support should sustain

moderate growth, but increasingly restrictive monetary conditions and fiscal constraints are likely to limit the pace of expansion.

Japan's latest PMI data point to continued private-sector expansion at the start of 4Q26, although momentum in manufacturing moderated while services activity strengthened.

The Manufacturing PMI eased to 53.3 in October from 54.1 in September, its lowest level in seven months but still consistent with solid expansion. Output and new orders continued to increase, albeit at their slowest rates since March, while export demand remained supportive, particularly from North America, China, and other Asian markets. AI- and semiconductor-related demand and the weak yen continued to support manufacturing activity, although higher energy and input costs added to margin pressures.

Graph 3 - 8: Japan's PMIs



Sources: S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

The Services PMI edged up to 51.7 in October from 51.3 in September, marking a fifth consecutive month of expansion. Business activity and new orders strengthened modestly, supported mainly by firmer domestic demand.

Reflecting the stronger growth momentum in 1H26 and continued resilience in economic activity into 2H26, the 2026 growth forecast has been revised up to 0.8% from 0.7% in the previous month's assessment. The revision is supported by robust exports, particularly in semiconductor and AI-related sectors, continued corporate investment and improving household fundamentals as real wages rise and the labour market remains tight. Fiscal measures, including temporary energy support, should also help cushion household purchasing power. While tighter monetary conditions and still-elevated living costs are likely to moderate domestic demand, the overall growth dynamic remains stronger than previously anticipated.

Table 3 - 5: Japan's economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	Japan
2026	**0.8**
Change from previous month	0.1
2027	**0.8**
Change from previous month	0.0

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

For 2027, the growth forecast remains at 0.8%, unchanged from the previous month's assessment. Activity should remain supported by technology-related investment, resilient external demand and continued fiscal support, alongside a gradual strengthening in household consumption as real incomes improve. The expansion is nevertheless expected to remain moderate, as further BoJ tightening, higher government-bond yields and elevated energy costs constrain demand at the margin.

Non-OECD

China

Update on the latest developments

China's economy expanded by a stronger-than-expected 4.5%, y-o-y, in 3Q26, bringing growth in the first nine months to 4.6% and leaving the official 2026 growth target of 4.5–5% within reach. The economy nevertheless remains uneven, with relatively strong production, technology-related activity and exports contrasting with considerably weaker domestic demand. Retail sales rose by only 1.1% in September. Services consumption performed better, increasing by 5% during the first nine months.

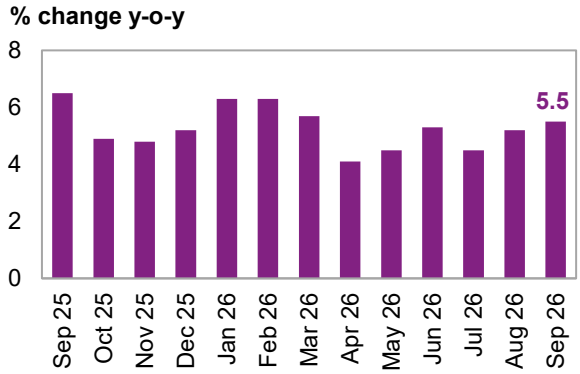
The property downturn remains an important constraint on household confidence and private investment. Weak residential sales, construction activity and property investment continue to weigh on domestic demand, reinforcing the need for additional policy support. Official January–September 2026 data continued to show significant weakness, with residential sales volumes down 13.8%, y-o-y, real-estate investment falling by 20.6% and residential new starts contracting by 25.4%. At the end of September, the stock of newly built commercial property for sale stood at 748.3m square metres, down slightly from 753.5m square metres in August but still well above recent historical averages. These trends are likely to continue weighing on household confidence, wealth and private-sector investment. Despite these headwinds, stronger manufacturing and technology-related activity have helped maintain overall economic momentum.

Policy support was stepped up at the end of September and beginning of October. At the end of September, China's State Council held an executive meeting that called for stronger counter-cyclical macro policy adjustments, faster implementation of major projects, and support for consumption, employment, the property market, and private investment. Consequently, the PBoC cut its one-year Pledged Supplementary Lending rate to 1.5% from 1.75%, increased its relending quota for technology and equipment upgrades, and expanded funding for agriculture, small businesses and private enterprises. These measures underline the authorities' preference for targeted monetary and credit support rather than broad-based stimulus. Additional fiscal measures have also become more supportive of household demand. From 1 October, eligible first-time homebuyers can receive a mortgage-interest subsidy of up to 1 percentage point, while existing consumer-loan and business-loan subsidy programmes have been expanded.

Inflation moderated slightly in October, with headline CPI easing to 0.7%, y-o-y, from 0.9% in September. Food prices remained a drag, declining by 2.9%, y-o-y. By contrast, the category of transport and communication prices rose by 5.5%, y-o-y, reflecting continued energy-related pressures. Core CPI also softened to 0.8%, y-o-y, from 1% in September. Producer-price inflation strengthened further, with PPI rising to 5.7%, y-o-y, from 5%, driven by higher raw-material and energy costs. Overall, the data point to still-subdued underlying consumer-price pressures despite increasingly strong underlying producer price inflation.

Industrial production remained an important source of support and strengthened further in September. Industrial output expanded by 5.5%, y-o-y, up from 5.2% in August, while manufacturing increased by 6%. High-technology manufacturing remained particularly strong, rising by 15.3%, y-o-y, with computer, communications and electronic-equipment production increasing by 16.4%, underscoring the continued strength of China's technology-related and export-oriented industrial sectors.

Graph 3 - 9: China's industrial production

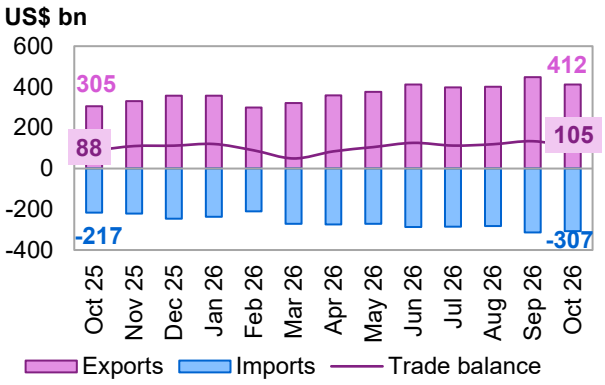


Sources: China National Bureau of Statistics and Haver Analytics.

External demand remains an important source of resilience. China's trade surplus narrowed to USD 105.3 billion in October from USD 133.5 billion in September, although the cumulative surplus for the first ten months of 2026 reached USD 1.04 trillion. Export growth remained exceptionally strong at 35.2%, y-o-y, only slightly below 36.3% in September, while imports accelerated to 41.6%, y-o-y, from 31.0%. in September.

The large external surplus continues to support manufacturing and overall activity amid subdued domestic demand, although growing reliance on exports also increases exposure to protectionist measures and weaker global demand. Exports reached USD 412.3 billion in October, compared with USD 447.2 billion in September. Technology-related shipments remained particularly strong. Imports stood at USD 307.1 billion, with stronger growth reflecting robust demand for technology inputs and a recovery in commodity purchases, including crude-oil imports, which reached their highest level since March.

Graph 3 - 10: China's trade balance



Sources: General Administration of Customs of China and Haver Analytics.

Near-term expectations

China's growth outlook into 2027 remains broadly resilient, supported by industrial production, exports, technology investment, and continued policy support. Manufacturing and high-technology industries are likely to remain important growth engines, helped by China's strong position in global supply chains, AI-related equipment, electronics, electric vehicles, clean-energy products, and other advanced manufacturing sectors. External demand should therefore continue to provide meaningful support, although exceptionally large trade surpluses also leave China exposed to further protectionist measures and trade tensions with the US and Europe.

At the same time, fiscal and monetary policy are expected to remain supportive. The authorities have signalled stronger counter-cyclical adjustment, faster implementation of major infrastructure projects and increased

financing for technology, private enterprises, and other strategic sectors. The September State Council meeting specifically called for accelerated bond issuance and investment in projects linked to the 15th Five-Year Plan, including power, computing, communications, and logistics infrastructure, while allowing monetary-policy tools to be adjusted further if necessary. Fiscal support is also increasingly being directed towards household demand through consumer subsidies, interest subsidies and measures aimed at supporting housing and services consumption.

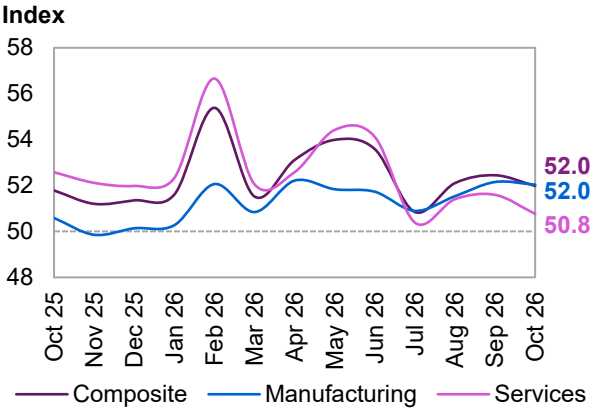
The 15th Five-Year Plan points to a gradual shift in the composition of growth towards domestic consumption, while maintaining a strong emphasis on technological upgrading and industrial competitiveness. China aims to increase household consumption as a share of GDP and raise retail sales of consumer goods to around RMB 60tn by 2030, alongside continued investment in digitalization, AI, advanced manufacturing, and other strategic industries. This suggests that the transition is likely to be gradual rather than abrupt: exports, industrial production and investment should remain important drivers through 2027, while stronger household income, services consumption and targeted fiscal support are expected to increase the contribution from domestic demand over time.

Monetary policy is expected to remain supportive through 2027, although the PBoC is likely to continue favouring targeted measures over aggressive broad-based easing. More recently, the PBoC shifted its operating framework towards the overnight reverse-repo rate, currently at 1.25%, which should help maintain ample liquidity, improve monetary-policy transmission, and keep financing conditions relatively accommodative. Looking into 2027, monetary policy is likely to remain closely coordinated with fiscal policy and increasingly directed towards supporting domestic demand, technology investment, private enterprises, and the property sector. Further moderate reductions in policy or lending rates remain possible if household demand and private investment remain weak, although the stronger 2026 growth performance reduces the need for aggressive near-term easing. Fiscal policy is therefore likely to carry a larger share of the stimulus, while monetary policy provides liquidity and targeted credit support. At the same time, the PBoC will need to balance domestic easing against exchange-rate and financial-stability considerations. Its November decision to raise the foreign-exchange reserve requirement from 4% to 6% illustrates this balancing act, with the authorities seeking to limit excessive renminbi appreciation while maintaining accommodative domestic financial conditions.

The latest PMI indicators point to continued resilience in China's manufacturing sector, although momentum became somewhat more uneven in October.

The privately published RatingDog/S&P Global Manufacturing PMI edged down only slightly to 52 in October from 52.1 in September and remained comfortably in expansionary territory, with output rising at its fastest pace in six months and new orders remaining strong at 53.3. By contrast, the official Manufacturing PMI fell to 49.3 in October from 50.1 in September, returning below the 50-point expansion threshold, with both production and new orders declining.

Graph 3 - 11: China's PMI



Sources: Caixin, S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

The Services PMI eased to 50.8 in October from 51.6 in September. New business continued to increase at broadly the same pace as in September, while new export orders rose for a sixth consecutive month.

Following a steady economic performance in 1H26, China's expansion is forecast to remain healthy. The broader outlook remains supported by advanced manufacturing, exports, and targeted policy support. Notably, the latest fiscal and monetary policy support measures suggest continued near-term momentum. Overall, economic growth forecast for 2026 is unchanged at a solid 4.6%.

Continued export diversification, combined with an improving domestic consumption outlook, will also shape the economic growth dynamic in 2027. In addition, ongoing fiscal and monetary support is expected to underpin a steady growth path next year. As a result, China's economic expansion is projected to remain resilient in 2027, maintaining robust growth at 4.5%, also unchanged from the previous month's assessment.

Table 3 - 6: China's economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	China
2026	**4.6**
Change from previous month	0.0
2027	**4.5**
Change from previous month	0.0

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

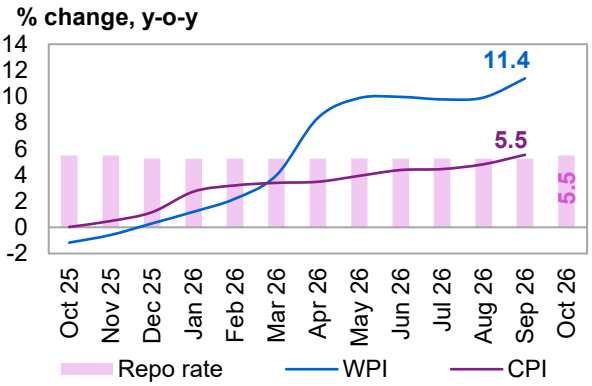
India

Update on the latest developments

Recent data suggests that the momentum seen in 1H26 continued into 3Q26 and the beginning of 4Q26, indicating a strong and broad-based expansion. Economic growth was revised up to 8.6%, y-o-y, in 1Q26 and remained exceptionally strong at 7.8%, y-o-y, in 2Q26, considerably above expectations. Growth was supported by robust private consumption, fixed investment, manufacturing, and services, confirming India's position as one of the fastest-growing major economies despite elevated energy prices and a challenging global environment. Industrial production increased by 6.7%, y-o-y, in September, following 7.8% in August, with manufacturing expanding by 7.6% and electricity and gas output by 11.2%. Capital-goods production remained particularly strong at 10.4%, while intermediate goods increased by 12.2%, pointing to continued strength in investment and industrial activity. Vehicle demand also remained strong, with total retail sales increasing by 31.8%, y-o-y, in September, although part of the increase reflected a beneficial base effect. Labour-market conditions have also remained supportive. The unemployment rate stood at 5% in September, unchanged from August and below the 5.2% recorded a year earlier, according to data from the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) – India's official labour-market survey – conducted by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI). Rural unemployment stood at 4.2% and urban unemployment at 6.9%, while labour-force participation remained relatively firm.

Inflationary pressures strengthened markedly in September. Headline CPI inflation increased to 5.5%, y-o-y, from 4.8% in August, marking the fourth consecutive month above the RBI's 4% target and the highest reading so far in 2026. Food and beverage inflation accelerated particularly sharply to 7.4%, y-o-y, from 5.7%, reflecting weaker monsoon conditions and higher prices for vegetables and other staples, while transport inflation increased to 5%, y-o-y, from 4.6%. The rise partly reflects adverse supply conditions and base effects, but price pressures have also become more broad-based, increasing the risk of second-round effects. Estimates of core inflation also moved higher in September, indicating some pass-through of higher input costs beyond food and energy.

Graph 3 - 12: Repo rate and inflation in India



Sources: Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Reserve Bank of India and Haver Analytics.

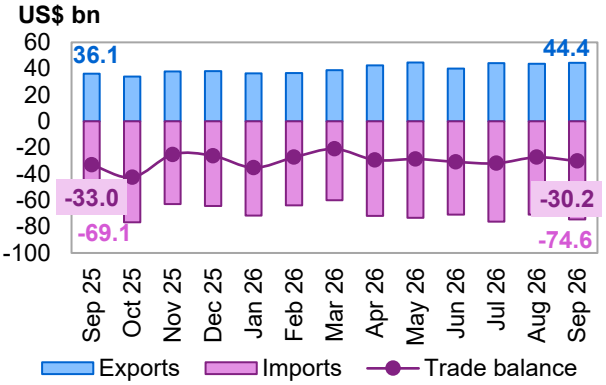
Core inflation has also edged higher, to 4.3%, y-o-y, in September from 4.1%, y-o-y, in August and 3.8%, y-o-y, in July. While underlying core inflation remains considerably more contained than headline inflation, the gradual increase suggests to some extent that that rising input costs are beginning to pass through more broadly.

Due to rising inflation, the RBI raised the policy repo rate by 25 bp to 5.50% at its October meeting, its first increase in nearly four years. The rate decision was unanimous, while the MPC voted 4-2 to shift its stance from "neutral" to "calibrated tightening". The subsequently released minutes clarified that, under the current stance, near-term policy choices are effectively limited to either a further rate increase or a pause, with rate cuts off the table for now. The RBI also raised its fiscal year 2026/27 inflation forecast to 5.2% and its economic growth forecast for the same period to 7.1%, highlighting the combination of stronger-than-expected growth and increasing inflation risks.

In terms of trade, India's merchandise trade deficit widened again to USD 30.2 billion in September from USD 27.3 billion in August, as imports increased more strongly than exports.

Nevertheless, external demand remained resilient, with merchandise exports rising to USD 44.4 billion from USD 43.7 billion in August, equivalent to growth of around 23%, y-o-y. Between April and September, merchandise exports increased by 18.5%, y-o-y, to USD 259.9 billion, while total goods and services exports rose by 13.8%. Export growth remained broad-based. Electronic-goods exports increased by 70.4%, y-o-y, in September, engineering goods by 20.9% and petroleum products by 31.9%, highlighting continued strength in manufacturing and technology-related exports.

Graph 3 - 13: India's trade balance



Sources: Ministry of Commerce and Industry and Haver Analytics.

Merchandise imports increased to USD 74.6 billion from USD 71 billion in August, around 8% above their level one year earlier, reflecting stronger domestic demand and elevated energy-import costs, although gold imports declined.

Near-term expectations

India is expected to remain one of the fastest-growing major economies through the remainder of 2026 and into 2027. Strong consumption, investment, manufacturing, and services provide a solid basis for continued expansion, as also reflected in the latest economic growth assessment of the RBI, which has raised its FY2026/27 growth forecast to 7.1% from 6.7%. The main risks have increasingly shifted towards inflation and the external environment, particularly elevated energy and food prices, a weaker rupee, tighter global financial conditions, and uncertainty surrounding trade relations with the US. Fiscal policy should remain supportive while broadly preserving the government's consolidation path. Under the Union Budget 2026–27, the fiscal-deficit target is set at 4.3% of GDP, while central-government debt is projected to decline to 55.6% of GDP from 56.1% in FY2025/26. More recent fiscal data shows that capital spending remains strong, with central-government capex rising to INR 6.5tn between April and September 2026, compared with INR 5.8tn a year earlier. Infrastructure investment should therefore remain an important driver of growth in 2027, while resilient tax revenues provide additional support to fiscal financing conditions.

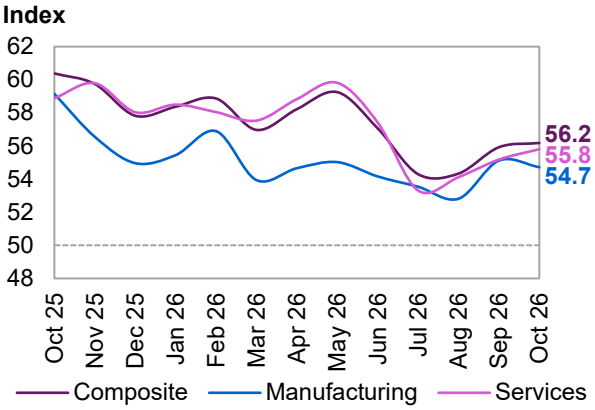
Structural reforms should increasingly reinforce this cyclical strength. The latest Goods and Services Tax (GST) measures represent a further stage of the "Next-Generation GST" reform process launched in September 2025, when the government simplified the rate structure and reduced taxes across a broad range of consumer and business goods. The October 2026 reforms increasingly focus on implementation, including faster automated refunds, simpler registration, wider input-tax-credit eligibility and lower compliance and litigation burdens. These measures should improve working capital and reduce transaction costs, particularly for Small and Medium Enterprises (SME), exporters, and manufacturers. Broader deregulation, SME financing, infrastructure, and labour-market reforms should gradually strengthen private investment and productivity into 2027.

Monetary policy will nevertheless become a greater near-term constraint. The RBI raised the repo rate by 25 bp to 5.50% in October and shifted to a "calibrated tightening" stance as food, energy and broader inflation pressures increased. Further moderate tightening remains possible if inflation stays elevated, although strong growth gives the RBI room to proceed gradually rather than through an aggressive hiking cycle. Assuming that this year's exceptional food and energy shocks are not repeated, inflation should moderate during 2027 as base effects kick in, eventually reducing the need for further tightening. However, near-term inflation risks remain tilted to the upside. A weak monsoon and El Niño conditions continue to threaten food supplies, while elevated global energy prices and a relatively weak rupee add to imported inflation pressures. In its October meeting, the RBI raised its CPI inflation forecast to 5.2% from 5.1%, with inflation expected to reach 6% in 3Q FY2026/27 and 5.7% in 4Q FY2026/27. Recent industry surveys provide some offsetting evidence, however: October manufacturing and services PMIs showed a moderation in input-cost and selling-price pressures, suggesting that underlying inflation momentum may not be accelerating uniformly across the economy. However, India's external position remains exposed to global developments. Positively, electronics exports increased particularly strongly this year, alongside continued growth in engineering and other manufactured goods, supporting India's gradual integration into higher-value global supply chains. Strong services exports, remittances, and substantial foreign-exchange reserves remain important buffers, although elevated oil prices and capital-flow volatility could continue to pressure the current account and rupee.

PMI indicators point to continued strong expansion in India's private sector in October, although developments differed somewhat across manufacturing and services.

The Manufacturing PMI eased slightly to 54.7 in October from 55.1 in September, but remained firmly in expansionary territory. New-order growth moderated somewhat from September's seven-month high, while export orders accelerated to their strongest pace in six months. Employment continued to increase, albeit more slowly, while input-cost inflation fell to its lowest level since February and selling-price inflation to its weakest in almost four years.

Graph 3 - 14: India's PMIs



Sources: S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

The Services PMI strengthened to 55.8 in October from 55.2 in September, its highest level in four months, supported by stronger domestic demand and the fastest increase in new business since June. External demand was softer, however, with export-order growth close to its weakest pace in almost four years, while hiring nearly stagnated.

Reflecting the stronger-than-expected growth performance in 1H26 and continued solid momentum into 2H26, the 2026 economic growth forecast has been revised up to 7.3% from 6.6% in the previous month's assessment. The positive trend is supported by resilient private consumption, strong fixed investment, robust manufacturing and services activity, continued infrastructure spending, and healthy external demand. Recent GST reforms, broader deregulation, and measures to improve SME financing and logistics should also increasingly support private investment and productivity.

With this steady momentum expected to carry over into 2027, the economic growth forecast has also been revised up to 6.8% from 6.5% in the previous month's assessment. Growth is expected to moderate somewhat from the particularly strong 2026 pace, but remain supported by continued structural reforms, further expansion in manufacturing and services, infrastructure investment, and gradually stronger private-sector activity. Monetary conditions could become less restrictive during 2027 if inflation moderates as expected.

Table 3 - 7: India's economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	India
2026	**7.3**
Change from previous month	0.7
2027	**6.8**
Change from previous month	0.3

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

Brazil

Update on latest developments

Brazil enters the final months of 2026 with a healthy economic growth dynamic, supported by a strong labour market, rising real incomes and a sound external position. Unemployment remains historically low, while robust commodity and oil exports continue to support the trade balance. At the same time, high interest rates are weighing on credit, investment, and industrial activity, although recent inflation developments suggest that price pressures may gradually ease, potentially creating scope for renewed monetary easing during 2027.

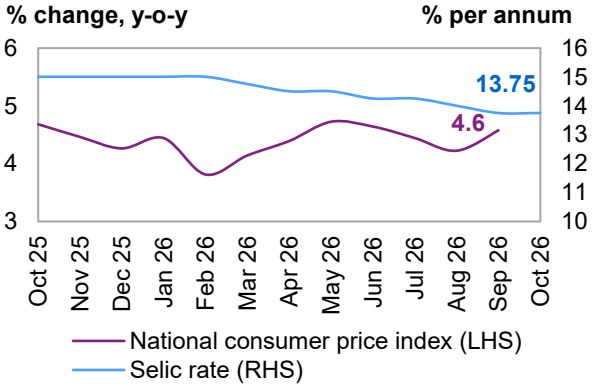
Recent fiscal policy measures should provide some additional support to household and small-business activity. The gradual reduction of the maximum working week from 44 to 40 hours by end-2027, combined with two guaranteed weekly rest days and unchanged salaries, could support worker welfare and productivity over time, although the transition may temporarily raise labour costs for smaller and labour-intensive firms. Debt-relief measures for micro and small enterprises should have a more direct positive effect by improving balance sheets, access to credit and investment capacity.

The main uncertainty for the near term remains fiscal. High public debt and elevated interest costs continue to limit policy space, particularly following the election period. Nevertheless, if inflation moderates, interest rates decline gradually and the ongoing implementation of the consumption-tax reform is implemented smoothly, growth should remain supported by employment, consumption, exports, and improving financing conditions.

Although the central government recorded a stronger-than-expected primary surplus in September, high borrowing costs and rising mandatory expenditure continue to complicate debt stabilization. The October Prisma Fiscal survey, the Ministry of Finance's monthly survey of private-sector fiscal expectations, projects gross general government debt at 83.4% of GDP in 2026 and 87% in 2027. While private-sector forecasts envisage a modest narrowing of the central-government primary deficit from around BRL 53bn in 2026 to BRL 44bn in 2027, this improvement is likely insufficient to stabilize public debt given the high interest burden. These projections contrast with the government's 2027 primary-surplus target of 0.5% of GDP and underline persistent uncertainty over the pace of fiscal consolidation. Following the presidential election, the government has signalled a stronger commitment to improving the primary balance, but implementation will be critical, particularly given elevated interest costs and limited expenditure flexibility.

Inflation remains elevated. Headline inflation rose to 4.6%, y-o-y, in September from 4.2% in August. This follows the central bank's decision to reduce the key-policy rate, the Selic rate, by a further 25 bp to 13.75% in September, prompting renewed uncertainties about the way forward. The BCB's September reference scenario projected inflation of 5.2% in 2026 and 3.9% in 2027, while the latest Focus survey, published by the BCB, raised the market forecast for 2027 inflation to 4.8%. Confidence indicators remain mixed: consumer confidence improved modestly to 84.7 in October from 84.2 in September, while business confidence declined further to 89.8 from 90.1. The labour market nevertheless remains a key source of resilience, with the unemployment rate declining to a historical low of 5.2% in the three months to September, down from 5.4% in the preceding period.

Graph 3 - 15: Brazil's inflation vs. interest rate



Sources: Banco Central do Brasil, Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística and Haver Analytics.

Near-term expectations

Brazil enters the final part of 2026 with a relatively sound growth base. Real GDP expanded by 1.8%, y-o-y, in 1Q26 and by 2%, y-o-y, in 2Q26, indicating that activity remained resilient through the first half of the year despite restrictive financial conditions. This provides a solid starting point for the remainder of 2026, although growth is expected to moderate as high borrowing costs continue to weigh on credit-sensitive sectors. Household demand should remain supported by historically low unemployment and continued real income growth, while agriculture, energy and commodity exports provide additional resilience.

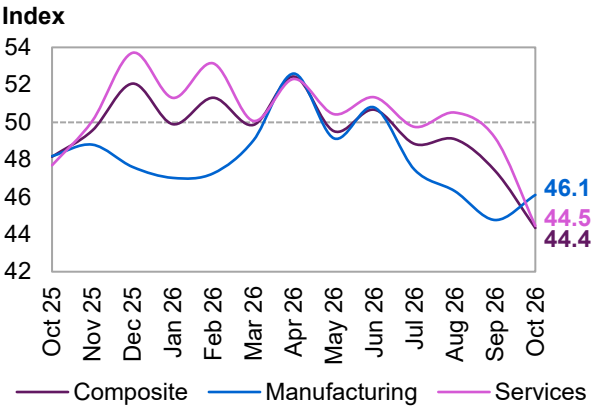
Monetary policy should become less restrictive only gradually. The Selic rate has been reduced by 125 bp from its peak of 15% to 13.75%, but the outlook for further easing remains uncertain. Inflation is still clearly above the 3% target, expectations remain elevated and the central bank continues to emphasize fiscal and external risks. Further rate cuts are therefore likely to depend on clearer evidence of disinflation and more stable inflation expectations. If these conditions materialize during 2027, lower real interest rates should gradually improve credit conditions and support consumption, residential activity, and private investment. Otherwise, monetary policy could remain restrictive for longer, depending also, to some extent, on fiscal spending dynamic in the near term.

Fiscal policy will thus be particularly important for the 2027 outlook. The government's draft budget targets a primary surplus of 0.5% of GDP, implying a meaningful improvement in the fiscal position and, if achieved, potentially supporting confidence, sovereign yields and the Brazilian real. However, delivery remains uncertain. Private-sector forecasts continue to envisage gross government debt rising to about 87% of GDP, while high interest expenditure and rigid mandatory spending continue to complicate debt stabilization. Following the October election, credible implementation of the consolidation strategy will therefore be critical to creating room for lower interest rates and stronger private investment.

The external sector should remain an important buffer. While US tariffs have weakened Brazilian exports to the US, Brazil's diversified export base and strong agricultural, mining and energy exports should limit the overall impact. Trade links with China, the EU and other emerging markets remain an important source of resilience, while mining and energy exports continue to provide additional support. Meanwhile, Brazilian exports to the US declined by 6.5%, y-o-y, from January to September, while Brazil recorded a USD 4.3 billion trade deficit with the US. September itself was more encouraging, however, with exports to the US rebounding by 31.9%, y-o-y, suggesting that exempt products, resilient US demand, and some trade adjustments are cushioning the impact of tariffs.

The Services PMI fell sharply to 44.5 in October from 49.2 in September, marking the steepest contraction since April 2021. New business declined for a second consecutive month and at the fastest pace in more than five years, reflecting weaker demand, project cancellations, elevated costs, and lingering uncertainty around the election period.

Graph 3 - 16: Brazil's PMIs



Sources: HSBC, S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

Manufacturing conditions remained weak in October, although the pace of contraction moderated. The Manufacturing PMI rose to 46.1 from 44.8 in September, but remained well below the 50-point threshold. Production declined for a sixth consecutive month and new orders for a nineteenth consecutive month, reflecting continued weak demand and restrictive financing conditions. Export orders also fell, albeit at a slower pace, while employment edged lower. More positively, business confidence increased to a nine-month high, suggesting some improvement in expectations following the elections.

Reflecting the solid growth performance in 1H26 and continued resilience in domestic demand and the labour market, the 2026 growth forecast remains unchanged at 2%. Activity is estimated to have moderated somewhat in 2H26 as restrictive financial conditions continue to weigh on credit-sensitive sectors, while higher commodity prices may keep inflationary pressures elevated. At the same time, strong agricultural, energy and mineral exports should continue to support incomes, the external balance and investment in commodity-related sectors, providing an important offset to weaker momentum elsewhere in the economy.

Table 3 - 8: Brazil's economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	Brazil
2026	**2.0**
Change from previous month	0.0
2027	**2.1**
Change from previous month	-0.1

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

For 2027, the growth forecast has been revised down slightly to 2.1% from 2.2% in the previous month's assessment. The revision reflects the likelihood that restrictive monetary conditions will weigh on domestic demand for longer, while the timing and extent of further monetary easing remain uncertain. Fiscal consolidation could eventually support confidence, sovereign yields and private investment if implemented credibly, but may also restrain demand in the near term. Nevertheless, resilient household incomes, investment and strong commodity exports should continue to support moderate expansion, with some upside possible if inflation declines more rapidly and monetary easing resumes earlier.

Russia

Update on the latest developments

Having expanded by around 1% in 3Q26, Russia's economic outlook nevertheless remains exposed to elevated inflation, while economic activity is increasingly concentrated in state-supported sectors and broader private demand and investment are being constrained by very high borrowing costs. Fiscal pressures have remained despite elevated global energy prices, while external pressure continue to dampen some areas of the economy. The relatively strong rouble is helping to contain imported inflation but is also reducing the domestic-currency value of export revenues.

Based on monthly data, economic growth slowed to 0.5%, y-o-y, in September from 0.8% in August, leaving GDP growth at around 0.6% over the first nine months of 2026. The sectoral picture nevertheless remains mixed rather than uniformly weak. Industrial production increased by 1.5%, y-o-y, in September after contracting by 0.7% in August, while retail sales growth accelerated to 4.1% from 3.4%, indicating continued support from household demand. High interest rates, labour and capacity constraints and disruptions in the energy sector remain important headwinds. Refinery activity recovered significantly during the second half of October as damaged facilities returned to operation, with crude processing rising considerably.

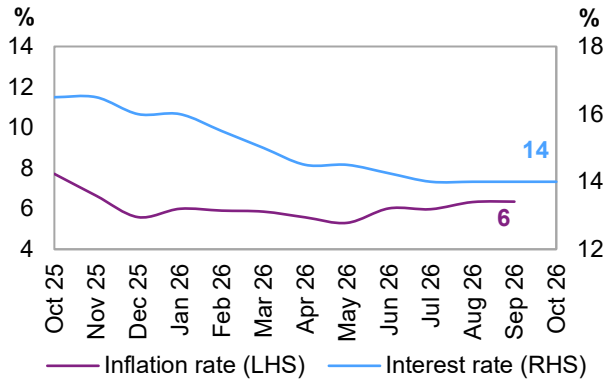
Fiscal policy remains supportive but increasingly constrained. The federal budget deficit narrowed to RUB 5.19tn, or 2.2% of GDP, from January to September, compared with 2.5% of GDP through August, helped by a sizeable September surplus. However, the finance ministry has revised the full-year 2026 deficit estimate to RUB 7.35tn, equivalent to 3.2% of GDP, twice the original 1.6% target, while the draft 2027 budget envisages a still-sizeable deficit of 2.2% of GDP. Proposed revenue measures include raising the tax on dividends paid

to non-residents through restricted accounts to 35% and introducing windfall levies of 20% on gold producers and 30% on selected metals and mining companies. Oil and gas revenues recovered sharply in October to RUB 971bn as global energy prices rose, but remained around 14% lower, y-o-y, at RUB 6.44tn from January to October, limiting the improvement in the broader fiscal position.

Inflation remains the principal constraint on faster monetary easing. Headline CPI increased to almost 6.4%, y-o-y, in September from 6.3% in August, while core inflation stood at 5.5%. Price pressures intensified again in October, partly reflecting the October utility-tariff increase and continued food and fuel pressures; the Bank of Russia estimated annual inflation at around 6.8%. Against this backdrop, the central bank kept the policy rate unchanged at 14% for a second consecutive meeting in October.

Recent data points to a modest rebound in industrial production alongside still-resilient household demand. However, industrial growth remained weak over a longer horizon, at only 0.2%, y-o-y, from January to September. The September rebound was driven almost entirely by manufacturing, which expanded by 5.5%, y-o-y, while mining output fell by 4.1% and electricity, gas and steam production declined by 3.2%. The composition of manufacturing growth remains particularly uneven. Output of computers, electronic and optical equipment increased by 38.1%, y-o-y, other transport equipment – including aircraft and shipbuilding – by 29.2%, motor vehicles by 27.6% and fabricated metal products by 20.1%, highlighting the continued importance of defence-related and state-supported production. By contrast, several more civilian-oriented industries remained considerably weaker, suggesting that the improvement in headline industrial production does not yet represent a broad-based recovery.

Graph 3 - 17: Russia's inflation vs. interest rate



Sources: Federal State Statistics Service, Central Bank of Russian Federation and Haver Analytics.

The labour market also remains exceptionally tight, with unemployment standing unchanged at 2.2% in September, close to the record low of 2.1% recorded earlier in the year. Persistent labour shortages therefore continue to constrain productive capacity and wage-sensitive sectors, while contributing to underlying inflation pressures.

Near-term expectations

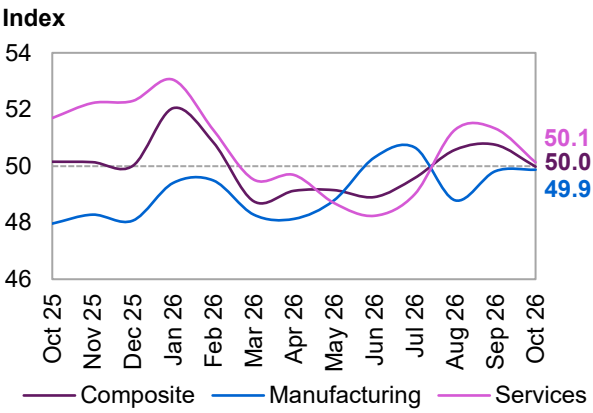
Russia's economy is expected to expand modestly after GDP growth slowed to around 1%, y-o-y, in 3Q26 from 1.3% in 2Q26. Household demand remains relatively resilient, and unemployment is near historic lows, but high borrowing costs, labour shortages, capacity constraints, and weaker activity outside state-supported sectors are increasingly weighing on growth. Energy infrastructure disruptions remain an additional near-term risk through their effects on fuel supply, prices, and exports. Fiscal policy should continue to provide some support, although the 2027–2029 budget envisages gradual consolidation, with the federal deficit narrowing from around 3.2% of GDP in 2026 to 2.2% in 2027 and 1.9% in 2028 and 2029. The framework assumes an Urals oil price of USD 50/b and a return to a zero structural primary deficit by 2029, although high defence, security and social spending will continue to limit fiscal flexibility.

Monetary policy is also likely to remain restrictive for longer than previously anticipated. The Bank of Russia kept its policy rate unchanged at 14% in both September and October as underlying inflation remained around 5–6% in annualized terms and near-term price pressures stayed elevated. The central bank raised its end-2026 inflation forecast to 7.1–7.6% and now expects the policy rate to average 12.5–13.5% in 2027. Monetary easing is therefore likely to proceed considerably more slowly than previously expected, with inflation still projected to return to the 4% target only during 2027.

The latest October PMI data points to broadly stagnant private-sector activity. The Manufacturing PMI edged up to 49.9 from 49.8 in September, remaining just below the 50-point threshold. Output and new orders continued to decline, although only marginally, while export orders fell at their fastest pace since May 2022. Employment also decreased, but at the slowest rate since the beginning of the year, and business confidence improved somewhat.

The Services PMI fell to 50.1 in October from 51.3 in September, indicating near-stagnation after two months of expansion. New business declined for the first time in three months, external demand weakened sharply and business confidence softened further.

Graph 3 - 18: Russia's PMI



Sources: HSBC, S&P Global and Haver Analytics.

Following the contraction in 1Q26, activity recovered modestly over the subsequent quarters, although GDP growth slowed to around 1%, y-o-y, in 3Q26. While household demand, government spending and commodity prices continue to provide support, the latest indicators point to weaker underlying momentum, with private-sector activity close to stagnation and growth increasingly concentrated in state-supported sectors. Reflecting this, the 2026 growth forecast has therefore been revised down to 1% from 1.1% in the previous month's assessment. In 2027, the Russian economy is forecast to accelerate, likely supported by further monetary easing and steady domestic demand. The economy is forecast to grow by 1.5%, unchanged from the previous month's assessment.

Table 3 - 9: Russia's economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	Russia
2026	**1.0**
Change from previous month	-0.1
2027	**1.5**
Change from previous month	0.0

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

Africa

South Africa

Update on the latest developments

Although South Africa's economy remains on a gradual recovery path, near-term momentum has weakened. Real GDP expanded by 0.9%, y-o-y, in 2Q26 but contracted by 0.2%, q-o-q, as mining, manufacturing and trade activity weakened, while household consumption remained positive. Both the South African Reserve Bank (SARB) and National Treasury now forecast growth of around 1.2% in 2026, with the latter expecting an acceleration to 1.6% in 2027. The medium-term outlook remains supported by structural reforms, including a further opening of electricity and freight-rail markets to private participation, a restructuring of Eskom and Transnet, and continued reforms in water and telecommunications. The recent GDP rebasing and benchmarking exercise revised the estimated size of the economy upward by around 5%, mechanically improving debt- and deficit-to-GDP ratios, although it does not materially alter the underlying real growth momentum. Most notably, Stats SA's new benchmarked series puts 2025 real GDP growth at 0.9%, compared with the 1.1% previously reported. So, while the level of nominal GDP was revised upward by roughly 5%, some historical real-growth rates were revised downward because the new methodology and data sources changed the measured composition and trajectory of output.

Fiscal developments have become more encouraging. The October Medium-Term Budget Policy Statement (MTBPS), published by the National Treasury, revised the 2026/27 deficit slightly lower to 3.9% of GDP, supported by stronger corporate, dividend and VAT receipts, while the government continues to generate a sizeable primary surplus and plans to introduce legislation for a principles-based fiscal anchor in 2027. Following Stats SA's subsequent GDP rebasing, the National Treasury mechanically revised the estimated peak in gross debt to 74.6% of GDP in 2025/26 from 78.4% previously, with the debt ratio now expected to fall below 70% by 2032/33. These developments strengthen the medium-term consolidation outlook, although elevated debt-service costs, expenditure pressures and dependence on commodity-related revenues remain important risks. The MTBPS also introduced temporary reductions in petrol and diesel levies through early January 2027 to cushion households and firms from elevated fuel prices without increasing borrowing.

Inflation remains the main near-term macroeconomic constraint. Headline CPI increased to 4.5%, y-o-y, in September from 4.4% in August. The SARB raised the policy rate by 25 bp to 7.25% in September and expects inflation to remain elevated into 2027. Monetary policy is therefore likely to remain cautious, with further tightening possible if fuel and administered-price shocks become more persistent. Overall, South Africa enters 2027 with stronger fiscal fundamentals and continued structural-reform momentum, but the pace of recovery will depend on whether inflation moderates sufficiently to allow less restrictive monetary conditions and whether reform implementation translates into higher investment and productivity.

Near-term expectations

While tighter monetary conditions are likely to restrain domestic demand in the near term, improving macroeconomic stability and continued progress in addressing infrastructure constraints should support investment and growth into 2027. Recent business surveys remain mixed. The S&P Global PMI was unchanged at 49 in October, indicating a second month of contraction as weak demand, higher fuel costs and port disruptions weighed on activity. The Absa Manufacturing PMI improved to 49.6 from a revised 48.7 in September, suggesting that industrial conditions are stabilizing, although production and new orders remain below the expansionary threshold. Household demand should continue to benefit from relatively subdued food inflation and resilient incomes, but unemployment of 33.6%, high borrowing costs and elevated fuel prices remain significant constraints. Electricity supply has improved markedly. South Africa has recorded more than 500 consecutive days without load shedding, while Eskom's financial-year-to-date energy availability factor has risen to around 68%, its highest level in six years. Continued implementation of electricity, transport and other structural reforms, alongside greater private-sector participation, should gradually strengthen potential growth.

Following the 25 bp increase in September, which lifted the policy rate to 7.25%, the SARB is likely to maintain a restrictive stance in the near term. Its current projections imply broadly unchanged rates through the remainder of 2026, reflecting persistent services inflation, renewed fuel-price pressures and inflation expectations that remain above the 3% target. Further tightening cannot be excluded if these pressures prove more persistent, although temporary fuel-levy relief announced in the MTBPS should provide some near-term offset. Assuming inflation gradually moderates towards the target during 2027, scope for cautious monetary easing should emerge, providing increasing support to consumption and investment later in the year.

South Africa's 2026 growth forecast has been revised down to 1.3% from 1.5% in the previous month's assessment, reflecting softer 1H26 momentum, restrictive financing conditions, and persistent logistics constraints. Improved electricity supply and structural reforms should nevertheless continue to support activity.

For 2027, growth has been revised down to 1.5% from 1.6%. A gradual recovery is expected as reform implementation and private investment strengthen.

Table 3 - 10: South Africa's economic growth rate and revision, 2026–2027*, %

	South Africa
2026	**1.3**
Change from previous month	-0.2
2027	**1.5**
Change from previous month	-0.1

*Note: * 2026–2027 = Forecast.*

Source: OPEC.

OPEC Member Countries

Saudi Arabia

Saudi Arabia's near-term outlook remains supported by resilient non-oil activity and a gradual recovery in oil production. Economic growth contracted by 3.8%, y-o-y, in 3Q26, improving from the 4.7% decline in 2Q26, while non-oil activity strengthened to 3.1%, y-o-y, in 2Q26. On a sequential basis, the economy expanded by 1.3%, q-o-q, supported by a strong rebound in oil activity. Non-oil momentum also remains firm, with the Riyad Bank PMI at 54 in October, despite easing from 55.3 in September. Inflation remained contained at 1.9%, y-o-y, in September, while Saudi unemployment stood at 6.5% in 2Q26. Looking ahead, recovering oil output, continued diversification investment and resilient domestic demand should support stronger growth into 2027.

Nigeria

Nigeria's near-term outlook continues to improve, supported by stronger oil activity, resilient non-oil growth, and a strengthening external position. Economic growth accelerated to 4.5%, y-o-y, in 2Q26 from 3.9% in 1Q26, while the September Stanbic IBTC PMI fell slightly to 55.7 in October from 56.4 in September. Headline inflation eased further to 14.7%, y-o-y, in September from 15.3% in August, although food-price pressures remain elevated. External resilience has also strengthened. Looking ahead, firmer private investment,

improving macroeconomic stability and continued oil-sector recovery should support growth into 2027, although high living costs and fuel-price pressures remain important risks.

United Arab Emirates (UAE)

The UAE economy remains resilient, although regional disruptions weighed on activity in 1H26. The economy grew by only 0.4%, y-o-y, in the first half of the year, with output declining by 2.1%, y-o-y, in 2Q26 as tourism, transport and trade were affected by regional tensions; non-oil GDP fell by 1.1% in the quarter. More timely indicators nevertheless point to a recovery, with the S&P Global UAE PMI at 54.8 in October after 55.3 in September, as new orders strengthened and export demand rose at its fastest pace in two years. Inflation remains manageable overall, although input costs and selling prices have risen sharply.

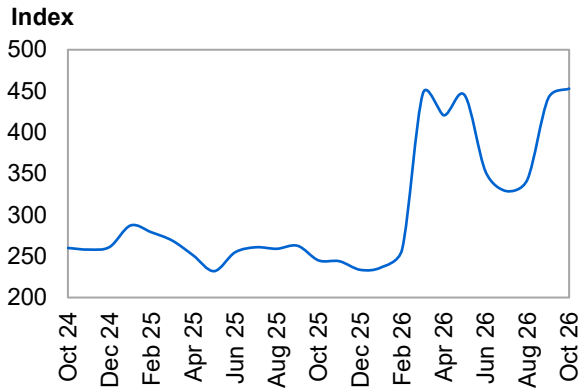
The impact of the USD and inflation on oil prices

The US dollar (USD) index increased in October by 2.1%, m-o-m. Higher US Treasury yields, resilient economic activity, and expectations of further Federal Reserve tightening supported investor demand for dollar-denominated assets. The index was up by 3.3%, y-o-y.

On select developed market currencies, the USD advanced against all major currencies. It rose against the euro, yen, and pound by 2.7%, 1% and 0.9%, m-o-m, respectively.

Compared with the same period last year, the USD was higher against the euro, yen, and pound by 3.8%, 4.4% and 0.4%, y-o-y, respectively.

Graph 3 - 19: The Modified Geneva I + USUSD Basket (base June 2017 = 100)



Sources: IMF and OPEC.

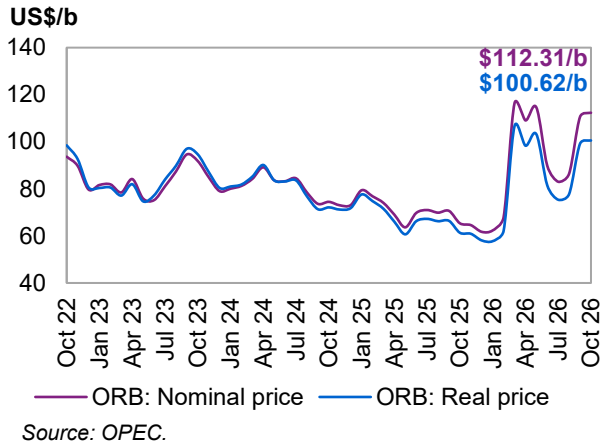
In terms of select emerging market currencies, the USD weakened against all major currencies. It declined against the rupee, yuan and real by 0.1%, 0.4% and 0.2%, m-o-m, respectively. Compared with the same period last year, the USD was higher against the rupee by 8%, y-o-y. At the same time, it was down against the yuan and real by 6.2% and 4.7%, y-o-y, respectively.

The differential between nominal and real ORB prices widened in October. Inflation (nominal price minus real price) increased by 3.2%, m-o-m.

In nominal terms, the ORB price increased by 1.6%, m-o-m, in October and was higher by 71.9%, y-o-y.

In real terms (excluding inflation), the ORB increased by 1.4%, m-o-m, in October and was up by 64.1%, y-o-y.

Graph 3 - 20: Impact of inflation and currency fluctuations on the spot ORB price (base June 2017 = 100)



Source: OPEC.

World Oil Demand

In 2026, world oil demand is forecast to grow by about 0.2 mb/d, y-o-y, unchanged from last month's assessment. The OECD oil demand is forecast to ease by about 0.2 mb/d in 2026, while the non-OECD oil demand is forecast to grow by about 0.4 mb/d, y-o-y.

Global oil demand in 2027 is forecast to grow by about 2.6 mb/d, y-o-y, unchanged from last month's assessment. The OECD oil demand is forecast to grow by around 0.5 mb/d, while oil demand in the non-OECD countries is forecast to grow by about 2 mb/d.

Table 4 - 1: World oil demand in 2026*, mb/d

World oil demand	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026	Change 2026/25
Americas	25.72	25.67	25.56	26.40	26.05	25.92	0.20
of which US	*20.88*	*20.82*	*20.80*	*21.42*	*21.12*	*21.04*	*0.17*
Europe	13.52	13.01	13.28	13.58	13.43	13.33	-0.19
Asia Pacific	7.09	7.34	6.30	6.65	7.12	6.85	-0.24
Total OECD	**46.33**	**46.01**	**45.14**	**46.63**	**46.61**	**46.10**	**-0.23**
China	16.88	17.24	15.86	16.93	17.21	16.81	-0.07
India	5.65	5.85	5.34	5.43	6.18	5.70	0.05
Other Asia	9.85	10.17	9.96	9.82	9.91	9.96	0.11
Latin America	6.94	6.94	7.10	7.19	7.09	7.08	0.14
Middle East	8.82	8.64	8.42	8.92	9.10	8.77	-0.05
Africa	4.92	5.07	4.75	4.97	5.39	5.05	0.13
Russia	4.01	4.07	3.87	4.06	4.21	4.05	0.05
Other Eurasia	1.31	1.48	1.34	1.20	1.37	1.35	0.04
Other Europe	0.83	0.83	0.84	0.82	0.92	0.85	0.02
Total Non-OECD	**59.21**	**60.29**	**57.47**	**59.34**	**61.37**	**59.62**	**0.41**
Total World	**105.54**	**106.30**	**102.61**	**105.97**	**107.98**	**105.72**	**0.18**

*Note: * 2026 = Forecast. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding. Source: OPEC.*

Table 4 - 2: World oil demand in 2027*, mb/d

World oil demand	2026	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27	2027	Change 2027/26
Americas	25.92	25.79	25.70	26.64	26.14	26.07	0.15
of which US	*21.04*	*20.93*	*20.94*	*21.63*	*21.15*	*21.16*	*0.12*
Europe	13.33	13.10	13.61	13.83	13.64	13.55	0.22
Asia Pacific	6.85	7.39	6.63	6.83	7.26	7.03	0.17
Total OECD	**46.10**	**46.29**	**45.93**	**47.30**	**47.04**	**46.64**	**0.54**
China	16.81	17.43	16.49	17.55	17.64	17.28	0.47
India	5.70	6.15	6.05	5.80	6.44	6.11	0.41
Other Asia	9.96	10.49	10.53	10.23	10.22	10.37	0.40
Latin America	7.08	7.07	7.25	7.32	7.22	7.21	0.14
Middle East	8.77	8.96	8.79	9.30	9.37	9.11	0.34
Africa	5.05	5.23	4.89	5.15	5.55	5.21	0.16
Russia	4.05	4.12	3.92	4.10	4.26	4.10	0.05
Other Eurasia	1.35	1.51	1.37	1.24	1.40	1.38	0.03
Other Europe	0.85	0.85	0.85	0.84	0.94	0.87	0.02
Total Non-OECD	**59.62**	**61.81**	**60.14**	**61.52**	**63.03**	**61.63**	**2.01**
Total World	**105.72**	**108.10**	**106.08**	**108.82**	**110.08**	**108.28**	**2.55**

*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding. Source: OPEC.*

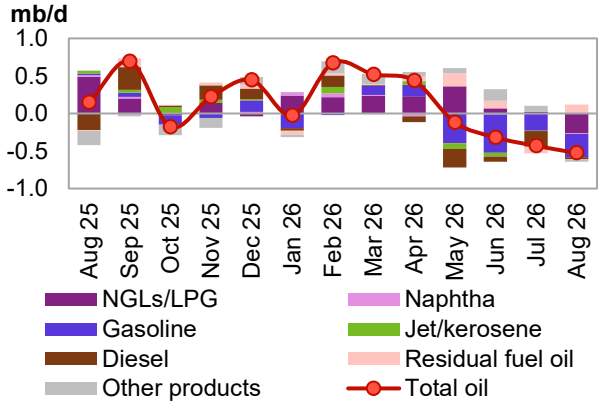
OECD

OECD Americas

Update on the latest developments

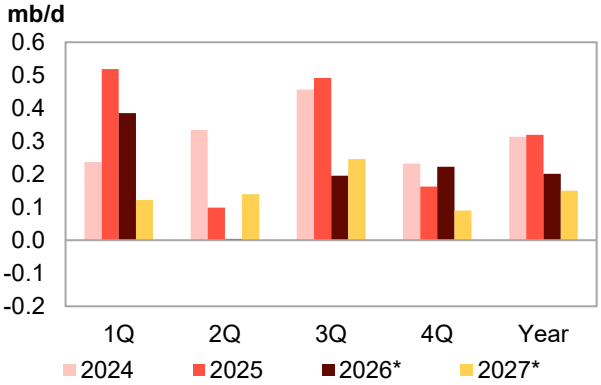
OECD Americas' oil demand contracted in August by around 530 tb/d, y-o-y. US-led oil demand declined by around 620 tb/d, y-o-y, which more than offset an increase of about 90 tb/d, y-o-y, from Canada. Oil demand in the region was largely subdued by a decline of about 310 tb/d, y-o-y, for gasoline, and a drop of about 260 tb/d in NGLs/LPG requirements, combined with a 40 tb/d, y-o-y, decline in requirements for the 'other products' category and 20 tb/d decline in diesel demand. This more than offset the 120 tb/d, y-o-y, increase in residual fuel oil requirements.

Graph 4 - 1: OECD Americas' oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: IEA, JODI, OPEC and national sources.

Graph 4 - 2: OECD Americas' oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

US

In August, US oil demand contracted further by about 620 tb/d, y-o-y. Regarding specific products, demand for NGLs/LPG saw the largest contraction of about 330 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a drop of about 170 tb/d, y-o-y, observed the previous month. Demand for gasoline declined by 260 tb/d, y-o-y, in August, down from a decline of 230 tb/d, y-o-y, in July. This was consistent with a decline in vehicle miles travelled (VMT) by 0.6%, y-o-y, in August.

Table 4 - 3: US oil demand, mb/d

US oil demand By product	Aug 25	Aug 26	Change Aug 26/Aug 25
NGLs/LPG	4.04	3.72	-0.33
Naphtha	0.18	0.16	-0.01
Gasoline	9.24	8.98	-0.26
Jet/kerosene	1.83	1.80	-0.03
Diesel	3.74	3.71	-0.03
Fuel oil	0.27	0.38	0.11
Other products	2.22	2.15	-0.07
Total	**21.50**	**20.89**	**-0.62**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.
Sources: EIA and OPEC.

Meanwhile, demand for the 'other products' category, including petroleum coke and lube oil, eased by 70 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, observed the previous month. Diesel demand slipped by 30 tb/d, y-o-y, though this was an improvement from a decline of about 150 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Similarly, jet/kerosene demand slipped by about 30 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of 30 tb/d, y-o-y, observed the previous month. Naphtha requirements eased by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, compared with a decrease of about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, in July.

On the flip side, residual fuel demand increased by about 110 tb/d, y-o-y, up from a decline of 90 tb/d, y-o-y, in July.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, the US economy continued to show solid macroeconomic resilience amid increased policy uncertainty. Private domestic demand remains solid, with consumer spending holding up, amid a relatively stable labour market. High-frequency, forward-looking indicators, including purchasing managers' indices (PMIs), point to a positive trajectory. Meanwhile, inflation in the US increased by an estimated 3.8%, y-o-y, in October from 3.7%, y-o-y, in September, well above the 2% target. The GDP in this quarter is projected to rise slightly from the previous quarter. Accordingly, oil demand in US is expected to increase by about 0.2 mb/d in 4Q26.

For the remainder of 2026, the US economy is expected to be steady, underpinned by resilient consumer spending. Despite headwinds from elevated energy prices and sticky inflation, oil demand in the region is projected to remain firm, leading OECD demand growth with about 170 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 21 mb/d in 2026, while oil demand in the OECD Americas region is forecast to grow by 200 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 25.9 mb/d.

Regarding oil demand products in OECD Americas, LPG and ethane are expected to drive growth in 2026, supported by petrochemical feedstock demand and heating requirements. The 'other products' category and residual fuel requirements are projected to increase. Jet/kerosene demand is also expected to show a healthy y-o-y increase, driven by stable economic activity and business travel. Naphtha demand is additionally projected to increase, though marginally. However, demand for gasoline and diesel are both projected to decline.

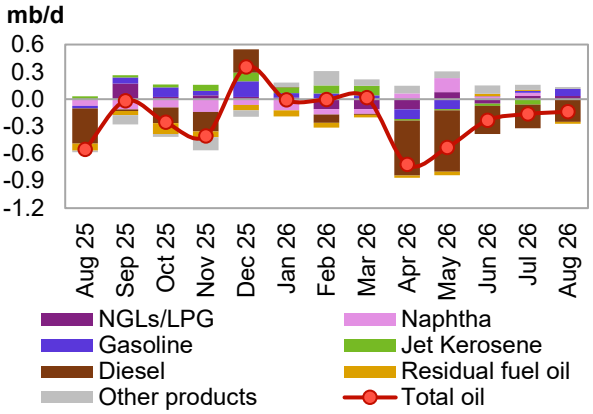
In 2027, economic activity in the region is projected to remain robust, with the GDP expected to remain at 2026 growth rates, largely driven by improvements in Canada and Mexico. The US GDP is expected to slightly moderate from 2026 growth rates, but remain firm, supported by consumer spending and steady employment. US inflation is also projected to significantly slow by next year, leading to an expected increase in OECD Americas' oil demand of about 150 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 26.1 mb/d. The US is forecast to drive regional oil demand growth, with an increase of about 120 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 21.2 mb/d.

OECD Europe

Update on the latest developments

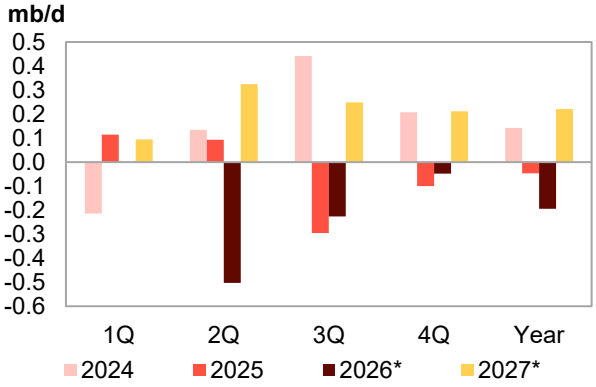
In August, oil demand in OECD Europe contracted by about 140 tb/d, y-o-y. Declines were seen across almost all countries in the region, mostly in Germany and France, which more than offset increases in demand from other countries in the region.

Graph 4 - 3: OECD Europe's oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: IEA, JODI, OPEC and national sources.

Graph 4 - 4: OECD Europe's oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

In terms of products, diesel led the y-o-y decline, with demand contracting by about 250 tb/d, slightly less than a decline of 260 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. The largest y-o-y diesel declines were observed in Germany, which accounted for 30% of the total decline. Diesel was subdued by surging pump prices amid supply chain disruptions. Furthermore, soft freight activity, weak economic momentum and an ongoing shift toward gasoline-driven and electric vehicles (EVs) also helped moderate diesel consumption in the region. Meanwhile, an expected diesel stock release of about 20 mb and issuance of a US sanctions waiver on Russian diesel exports are expected to improve supply availability ahead of increasing heating requirements in the region over winter.

Regarding petrochemical feedstock, NGLs/LPG requirements increased by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, for the second consecutive month. Naphtha demand was broadly flat, y-o-y, down from an increase of about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, in the previous month.

Meanwhile, gasoline demand saw the largest increase of about 80 tb/d, y-o-y, up from growth of about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, the previous month. Demand for jet/kerosene was broadly flat, y-o-y, though this is an improvement compared with the 60 tb/d, y-o-y, decline observed in July. Residual fuel requirements slipped by about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of 10 tb/d, y-o-y, in July, while demand for the 'other products' category increased by about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of about 50 tb/d, y-o-y, in July.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, economic activity in the region is projected to moderate amid renewed inflationary pressure. Euro-area annual headline inflation increased to 3.8% in September, up from 3.2% in August, remaining well above the European Central Bank's ongoing inflation target of around 2%, mostly driven by rising energy prices. Meanwhile, the region's composite PMI declined to 51 points in October, down from 53 points in September. Furthermore, ongoing oil market-related supply challenges continued to exert pressure on petrochemical feedstock and diesel demand. Accordingly, oil demand in the region is anticipated to decline by about 50 tb/d, y-o-y, in 4Q26, following a 230 tb/d decline in 3Q26.

For 2026, economic activity in the region is expected to remain on a moderately positive trajectory. However, a near-term downside risk is associated with weak industrial activity, rising inflation and supply tightness due to current oil market disruptions. Overall, oil demand is projected to decline by around 190 tb/d, y-o-y, in 2026, to average 13.3 mb/d.

In terms of oil demand by product, air travel activity and road mobility are predicted to support transportation fuels, which are expected to account for all oil demand growth in the region, with jet/kerosene having the strongest demand outlook among key products. Gasoline is also expected to grow. Regarding petrochemical feedstock, demand for NGLs/LPG and naphtha is projected to be moderate, y-o-y. Demand for diesel, residual fuel oil and the 'other products' category is projected to decline, y-o-y.

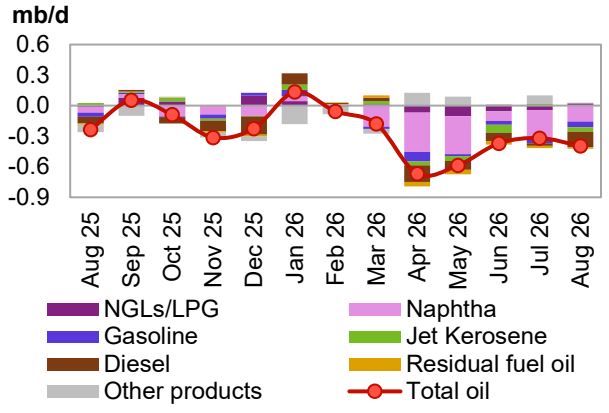
Looking ahead, the region is predicted to see a moderate improvement from 2026 growth rates in 2027, driven by increased German investment, stronger intra-regional export, improving consumer spending and slowing inflation. Furthermore, road mobility and air travel are projected to remain relatively healthy. Accordingly, these factors are anticipated to support oil demand in the region, which is forecast to rebound and grow by about 220 tb/d, y-o-y, in 2027, to average 13.6 mb/d.

OECD Asia-Pacific

Update on the latest developments

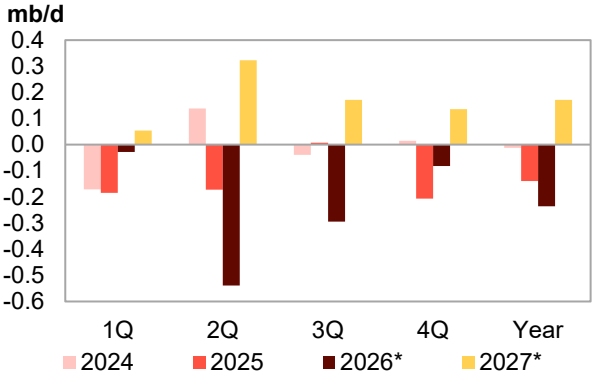
Oil demand in the OECD Asia-Pacific region contracted further by about 400 tb/d, y-o-y, in August. Within the region, South Korea led declines with about 290 tb/d, y-o-y, followed by Japan with a decline of 140 tb/d, y-o-y.

Graph 4 - 5: OECD Asia-Pacific oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: IEA, JODI, OPEC and national sources.

Graph 4 - 6: OECD Asia-Pacific oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

Regarding specific oil product demand in August, naphtha requirements saw the largest y-o-y decline of about 160 tb/d, though this was an improvement compared with a 290 tb/d contraction, y-o-y, seen a month earlier. Naphtha has been under pressure from supply chain challenges due to the ongoing oil market disruption.

Consequently, major petrochemical producers and steam cracker operators in the region were forced to slash operating rates or declare force majeure due to a shortage of raw naphtha feedstock. Meanwhile, the Asia-Pacific naphtha crack spread strengthened in October, with Japan's naphtha crack spread reaching parity with Dubai crude, mostly driven by strong cracker demand amid uncertainty surrounding Chinese export availability.

In transportation fuel demand, diesel requirements contracted by about 150 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a decline of about 30 tb/d, y-o-y, observed the previous month. Gasoline demand eased by about 60 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a decline of about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Jet/kerosene demand slipped by about 50 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, observed the previous month.

Meanwhile, LPG demand increased by about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, showing an improvement over a decline of 40 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Demand for the 'other products' category saw an uptick of about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, below the increase of 20 tb/d, y-o-y, seen a month earlier.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, the region's economy is expected to remain resilient, despite ongoing supply chain challenges stemming from persistent headwinds from high global energy costs. Various government policy measures, including subsidies and accommodative financial conditions, are expected to offset some of the pass-through effects of the global oil market disruption on the domestic cost of production. Meanwhile, Japan pledged to provide financial subsidies for the difference between kerosene import prices from 21 October 2026 to 20 March 2027. In addition, the Japanese government approved allocating $7.28 billion to a gasoline subsidy fund from a reserve fund for responses to the global oil market disruption. South Korea's private consumption is expected to see a gradual recovery amid the 2H26 implementation of government fiscal policy measures. Accordingly, in 4Q26, oil product demand in the region is projected to decline by about 80 tb/d, y-o-y, compared with a decline of about 300 tb/d, y-o-y, seen in 3Q26.

In 2026, Japan's economy is projected to continue recovering at a moderate pace, underpinned by resilient private consumption, supportive government policy measures and accommodative financial conditions. The South Korean economy is expected to remain robust with strong growth momentum, particularly from sturdy exports, in line with projections. Private consumption is also expected to continue recovering amid expansionary fiscal policy, which is projected to support a rise in consumer incomes. Meanwhile, inflation in South Korea remained lower than in most major economies, as policy measures such as price caps and fuel tax cuts eased inflationary pressure. Similarly, the manufacturing PMI in the country rose to 55.1 in September, from 51 points in August.

Despite some positive outlook, oil demand in the region is anticipated to remain broadly under pressure from ongoing oil market disruptions, creating some supply bottlenecks. Accordingly, demand in the region is projected to ease by about 240 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 6.9 mb/d in 2026.

Regarding specific products, almost all oil products are expected to show some decline at various rates. Naphtha is projected to account for the largest decline, while diesel and residual fuels are also expected to decline. Meanwhile, jet/kerosene and the 'other products' category, including petroleum coke and lube oil, are expected to remain flat, y-o-y.

In 2027, economic growth in major consuming countries of the region is expected to remain steady, supported by a gradual recovery in manufacturing activity, normalising monetary policy and ongoing fiscal support. These measures are expected to support private demand and increase public investment, lending some support to the region's economy. The region's GDP is projected to remain on a positive trajectory, but slightly moderate from 2026 growth rates. Accordingly, oil demand is projected to rebound by about 170 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 7 mb/d.

Non-OECD

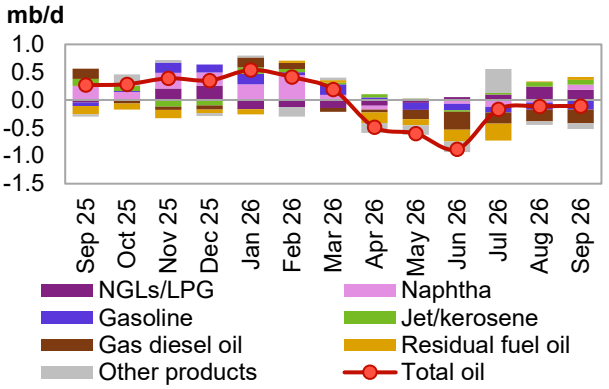
China

Update on the latest developments

China's oil demand in September contracted by about 110 tb/d, y-o-y. The contraction in diesel, combined with declines in gasoline and the 'other products' category, more than offset an increase in petrochemical feedstock, jet/kerosene and residual fuel requirements combined.

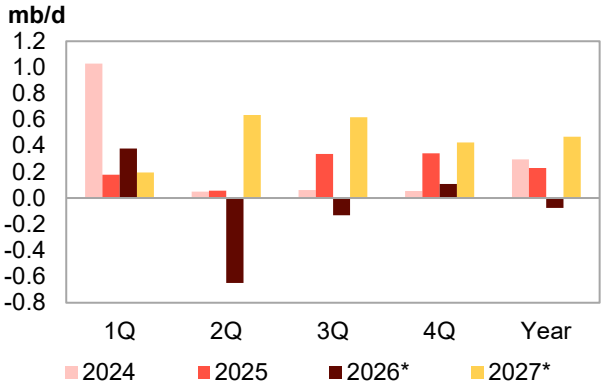
Regarding demand for specific products, diesel demand saw the largest decline, down by about 250 tb/d, y-o-y, from a contraction of about 210 tb/d, y-o-y, in August. Gasoline demand contracted by 170 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a decline of 120 tb/d, y-o-y, observed in August. Requirements for the 'other products' category eased by 100 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a decline of 60 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month.

Graph 4 - 7: China's oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: Argus Media, Chinese Customs, Chinese National Bureau of Statistics, JODI and OPEC.

Graph 4 - 8: China's oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

In terms of petrochemical feedstock, demand for LPG increased by 190 tb/d, y-o-y, though this was below the increase of 240 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Naphtha requirements increased by around 90 tb/d, y-o-y, up from a decline of about 50 tb/d, y-o-y, in August.

Meanwhile, jet/kerosene requirements increased by about 90 tb/d, y-o-y, up from an increase of 80 tb/d, y-o-y, in August. Requirements for residual fuel oil inched up by about 50 tb/d, y-o-y, up from an increase of about 10 tb/d, y-o-y in August.

Table 4 - 4: China's oil demand*, mb/d

China's oil demand By product	Sep 25	Sep 26	Change Sep 26/Sep 25
NGLs/LPG	2.79	2.98	0.19
Naphtha	1.85	1.94	0.09
Gasoline	3.86	3.69	-0.17
Jet/kerosene	0.95	1.04	0.09
Diesel	4.00	3.75	-0.25
Fuel oil	0.92	0.98	0.05
Other products	2.98	2.88	-0.10
Total	**17.36**	**17.25**	**-0.11**

*Note: * Apparent oil demand. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.*

Sources: Argus Media, Chinese Customs, Chinese National Bureau of Statistics, JODI and OPEC.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, following stronger-than-expected growth in 3Q26, China's economy is projected to accelerate in 4Q26, supported by faster implementation of planned fiscal spending, which should provide support to construction and industrial activity. According to preliminary indicators, IP has remained firm, growing by 5.5%, y-o-y, in September. The manufacturing and services PMIs have been on a broadly expansionary trajectory since January.

The rebound in manufacturing is expected to partly offset persistent domestic demand and property sector headwinds. In line with this, Chinese foreign trade maintained strong performance, with exports surging by 25.5%, y-o-y, in August, from 23%, y-o-y, in July. Most of these factors highlighted a positive near-term outlook for China's economy and oil demand. In 4Q26, oil demand is expected to increase by 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, supported by requirements for plastics and packaging amid a surge in petrochemical product exports during end-of-year festivities. Meanwhile, China's Fujian Zhongsha Petrochemical Co. Ltd.'s new 1.5 million tonnes per year (mt/y) cracker is expected to come onstream in the fourth quarter of 2026. Furthermore, Sinopec Hainan Refining & Chemical Co. Ltd.'s 40,000 b/d expansion project is also expected to start in November 2026.

China's economy is expected to remain resilient in 2026, despite significant external shocks, backed by resilient exports amid accelerated targeted policy support, which will improve near-term growth prospects. However, ongoing property-sector weakness amid subdued private consumption, along with soft private investment and rising new energy vehicle sales capturing a 62.4% market share in September from 54% in August, are expected to pose a downside risk and are anticipated to subdue oil demand in China, which is thus expected to decline by about 70 tb/d, y-o-y, in 2026.

Regarding specific products, jet/kerosene is projected to drive y-o-y demand growth. Naphtha is expected to grow, Demand for LPG and ethane is projected to grow with the average utilization rate at China's propane dehydrogenation plant operating rates projected higher in the second half of October, as units ended maintenance. Average operating rates at the country's propane dehydrogenation plants recovered to levels above 66% in October 2026. However, diesel and gasoline demand is projected to remain subdued. Similarly, requirements from the residual fuels and 'other products' categories are projected to ease.

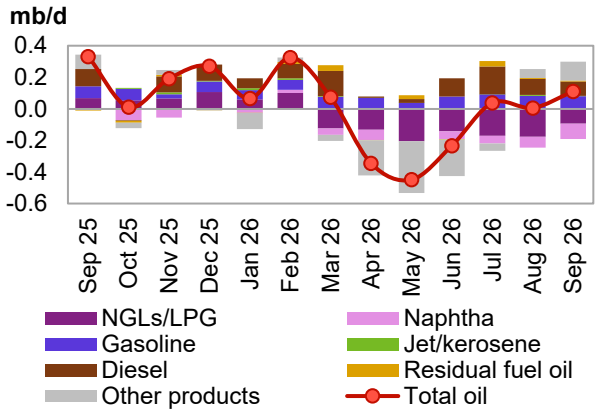
In 2027, economic activity in China is expected to continue growing amid faster implementation of targeted fiscal spending and supportive monetary policy. Household consumption and manufacturing output are also expected to improve. Similarly, demand from the petrochemical sector is projected to remain healthy. This is expected to support oil product demand growth of about 0.5 mb/d, y-o-y, bringing the average to about 17.3 mb/d.

India

Update on the latest developments

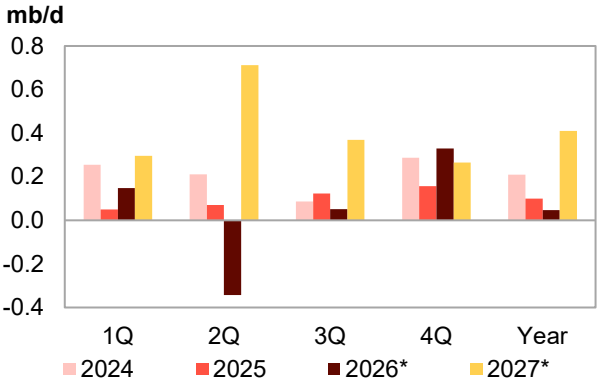
In September, India's oil demand recovered to grow by 110 tb/d, y-o-y, after five consecutive months of y-o-y declines. The y-o-y increase in September stems from demand for all products, except petrochemical feedstock requirements for LPG and naphtha.

Graph 4 – 9: India's oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: PPAC, JODI and OPEC.

Graph 4 – 10: India's oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

Regarding specific products, demand for the 'other products' category, mostly bitumen and petroleum coke led the increase by 120 tb/d, y-o-y, up from a 140 tb/d, y-o-y, decline seen the previous month. While bitumen increased by 17.2%, y-o-y, petroleum coke inched up by 5.2%, y-o-y. Demand for diesel increased by about 90 tb/d, y-o-y, although this was below an increase of 100 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Diesel was mostly supported by demand from the agriculture sector and increased transportation activity during the festival season.

Meanwhile, demand for gasoline increased by about 80 tb/d, y-o-y, for the second consecutive month. Gasoline demand was driven by strong vehicle sales, which increased by 32% in September, compared with the same period last year. Meanwhile, residual fuel demand inched up by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, broadly unchanged from the previous month. Jet/kerosene demand was broadly flat, y-o-y, after a minor increase of about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, in August.

On the flip side, naphtha requirements saw the largest y-o-y decline of about 100 tb/d, down from a decline of about 70 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Naphtha was subdued by higher import prices, forcing petrochemical producers to reduce demand. LPG requirements also contracted by about 90 tb/d, y-o-y, though this was an improvement compared with a decline of about 180 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month.

LPG was pressured by ongoing supply chain challenges leading to high import costs amid government policy restrictions on commercial and industrial supply. In addition, a growing shift towards piped natural gas (PNG), mostly by commercial users, also contributed to a decline in LPG use.

Table 4 - 5: India's oil demand, mb/d

India's oil demand By product	Sep 25	Sep 26	Change Sep 26/Sep 25
NGLs/LPG	1.08	0.99	-0.09
Naphtha	0.30	0.20	-0.10
Gasoline	0.97	1.05	0.08
Jet/kerosene	0.20	0.20	0.00
Diesel	1.71	1.80	0.09
Fuel oil	0.12	0.12	0.01
Other products	1.08	1.20	0.12
Total	**5.45**	**5.56**	**0.11**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

Sources: JODI, Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell of India and OPEC.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, India's economy should remain robust amid resilient domestic demand and a surge in investment and manufacturing activity, as well as government support for key sectors. In line with this, both manufacturing and services PMIs have been on an expansion trajectory to above 50 points since the beginning of the year. In September, the manufacturing PMI expanded to 55.9 points from 53.2 points in August, implying an ongoing expansion in factory activity, as the IP in September rose to 8%, from 7.3% in August. The services PMI increased further to 55.8 points in September from 55 points in August. Furthermore, the Indian labour market remains relatively stable; the unemployment rate among people aged 15 and above declined to 5% in September. However, inflation rose again to 5.5% in September, to reach its highest point since October 2024, marking the fourth consecutive month above the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) medium-term target of 4%, though this is still below the RBI's upper tolerance limit of 6%.

In the short-term, the current momentum of India's economic expansion is expected to continue steadily, supporting an oil demand increase of about 0.3 mb/d, y-o-y, in 4Q26. Meanwhile, preliminary data from the Indian Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell (PPAC) indicates a continuation of oil demand growth in October, with diesel demand surging by about 12%, supported by below-average monsoon rains, which forced farmers to rely heavily on diesel-powered generators to run irrigation pumps. Similarly, gasoline also increased by 3.1%, y-o-y. Overall, oil demand in India is projected to grow by around 50 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 5.7 mb/d in 2026.

Regarding specific products, transportation fuel, diesel and gasoline are expected to drive oil demand in 2026. Diesel demand is anticipated to gain additional support from strong manufacturing and agricultural activity. Gasoline is expected to be supported by heightened road mobility amid robust vehicle sales. Demand for residual fuel and jet/kerosene is expected to increase marginally. However, demand for LPG and naphtha is expected to be subdued by ongoing supply chain challenges.

Looking ahead to 2027, India is expected to maintain its position as the world's fastest-growing major economy. Stronger private consumption, infrastructure investment and resilient services activity are presumed to drive the country's economy. In addition, fiscal policy is expected to be expansionary, while inflation is predicted to moderate. These factors are expected to support a positive economic outlook for 2027. Accordingly, ongoing government support for households and expected new petrochemical capacity additions are expected to provide additional support for oil demand growth of about 0.4 mb/d, y-o-y, bringing the average to 6.1 mb/d.

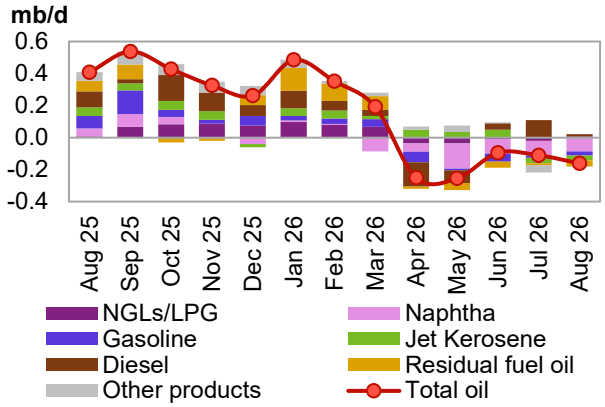
Other Asia

Update on the latest developments

Oil demand in Other Asia contracted by around 160 tb/d, y-o-y, in August. Declines were seen across Singapore, Taiwan, Hong Kong and Vietnam, which more than offset a y-o-y increase of about 90 tb/d in Indonesia. Similarly, all product categories saw y-o-y declines at various rates, except demand for diesel and LPG, which saw minor increases, y-o-y.

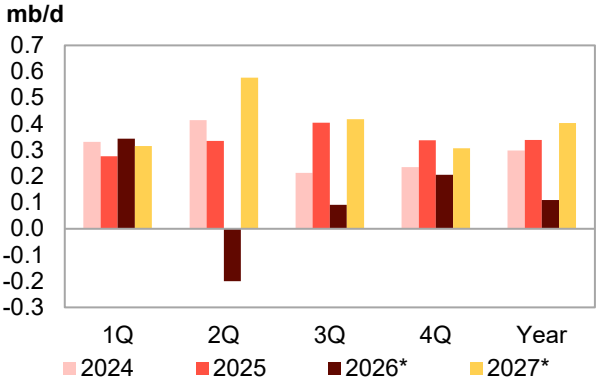
Regarding specific products, naphtha requirements saw the largest contraction of about 90 tb/d, y-o-y, roughly the same decline as seen a month earlier. LPG requirements increased by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, up from a decline of about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Residual fuel demand contracted by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a decline of 10 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month.

Graph 4 - 11: Other Asia's oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: JODI, National sources, and OPEC.

Graph 4 – 12: Other Asia's oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

In transportation fuels, demand for diesel inched up by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of 110 tb/d, y-o-y, seen in the previous month. Jet/kerosene requirements contracted by about 30 tb/d, y-o-y, for the second consecutive month. Gasoline demand eased by around 30 tb/d, y-o-y, down from a decline of about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, in July.

Meanwhile, demand for the 'other products' category was broadly flat, y-o-y, though this was an improvement compared with a decline of 50 tb/d, y-o-y, seen a month earlier.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, economic activity in the region's major oil-consuming countries is anticipated to demonstrate strong resilience but grow moderately in 4Q26, driven primarily by resilient household consumption amid contained inflation and structural investments, which are expected to support a regional increase in oil demand of about 0.2 mb/d, y-o-y.

In 2026, economic activity in major oil-consuming countries is expected to remain steady, albeit uneven, across the region's major economies, driven by strong domestic consumption, private investment, public infrastructure spending and a strong policy environment.

Malaysia's economy is anticipated to remain resilient, supported by strong economic fundamentals, despite external uncertainties. Private consumption is expected to benefit from continued income growth, as well as ongoing policy measures, which will support steady household spending, private investment and domestic demand.

Indonesia's economy is expected to remain healthy, driven by strong household consumption, a robust services sector, and strong gross fixed capital formation, supported by lower borrowing costs after the implementation of substantial monetary policy easing. Other countries in the region, including Pakistan and Thailand, are also projected to see variable but steady growth rates. Overall healthy road mobility and air travel activity are projected to continue amid strong manufacturing and agricultural output in the region.

The ongoing oil market disruption continues to exert some upward pressure on the domestic cost of production in the region, with pass-through effects on domestic inflation. The overall impact on inflation remains contained by domestic demand management policies, including targeted subsidies, amid stable domestic demand conditions, which are anticipated to continue offsetting most of pass-through effect of higher energy costs on the domestic cost of production and domestic prices.

These factors are expected to support oil demand growth of about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, in 2026, bringing the average to 10 mb/d.

Specific products in the 'other products' category, including bitumen, petroleum coke and lubricant, are projected to drive oil demand growth in the category in 2026. Jet/kerosene is expected to grow on the back of strong international and domestic air travel demand. Gasoline and diesel are also expected to grow, supported by road mobility and robust industrial and agricultural activity. The NGLs/LPG category is also projected to

grow robustly. Meanwhile, residual fuel requirements are expected to increase moderately, while naphtha oil demand is anticipated to ease, y-o-y.

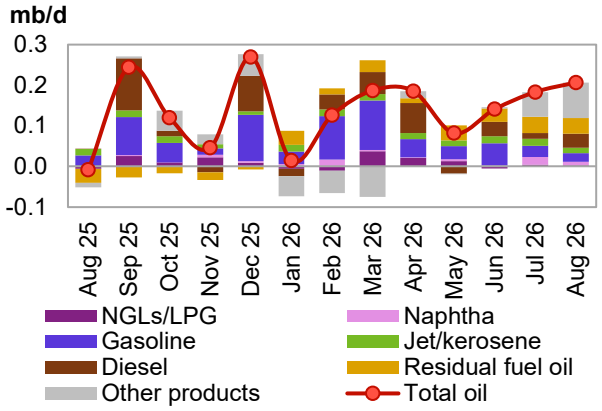
Looking ahead to 2027, economic activity in the region's major oil-consuming countries is expected to rebound, with regional GDP surpassing 2026 levels. Furthermore, consumer spending, low inflation and robust private and public investment are anticipated to continue supporting economic activity. These factors are forecast to lead to oil demand growth in the region of about 0.4 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 10.4 mb/d.

Latin America

Update on the latest developments

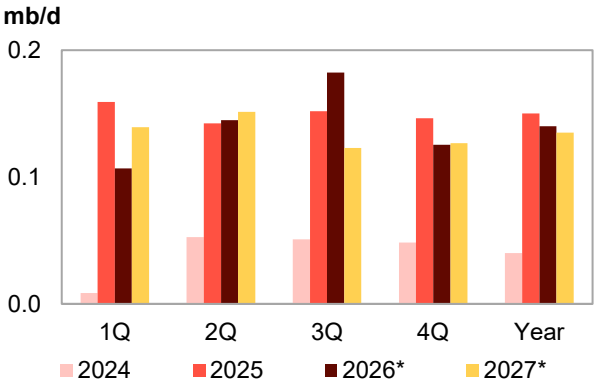
Oil demand in Latin America increased by about 210 tb/d, y-o-y, in August, up from an increase of 180 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Within the region, Brazil and Ecuador accounted for the majority of the y-o-y oil demand increase in the region.

Graph 4 - 13: Latin America's oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: JODI, OPEC and national sources.

Graph 4 - 14: Latin America's oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

Regarding specific products, the 'other products' category, including ethanol, saw the largest y-o-y increase of about 90 tb/d, up from an increase of 60 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Ethanol demand from Brazil accounted for about 84% of the increase in demand for the 'other products' category in August. Ethanol consumption in Brazil was driven by a rise in the mandatory anhydrous ethanol blend in regular gasoline to 32% (E32); which took effect on 1 August 2026. This has significantly accelerated domestic consumption and production requirements. Furthermore, in September 2026 the Brazilian government introduced temporary subsidies and tax relief packages for ethanol producers to maintain sector competitiveness.

Meanwhile, requirements for diesel and residual fuels increased by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, each in August. Gasoline requirements grew by about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of about 30 tb/d, y-o-y, in July. Jet/kerosene demand rose by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, though this is below the 20 tb/d, y-o-y, increase seen the previous month.

In terms of petrochemical feedstock, naphtha demand increased by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, down from an increase of about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, the previous month. Demand for NGLs/LPG was broadly flat, y-o-y, for the third consecutive month.

Near-term expectations

In the near term, Latin America's economy is projected to see a modest expansion. Brazil's economy is expected to slightly moderate amid gradual interest rate cutting cycles and relatively weaker economic activity. Argentina's economy is experiencing a moderate improvement, following significant progress in stabilizing the economy through reforms aimed at creating jobs and attracting investment into infrastructure. Accordingly, these factors are set to support regional oil demand growth of about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, in 4Q26.

In 2026, Latin American economies are expected to remain resilient, driven by macroeconomic stabilization amid economic and structural reforms in Brazil and Argentina. Accordingly, oil demand in Latin America is forecast to grow by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, in 2026, to average 7.1 mb/d.

Regarding specific oil products, transportation fuels, gasoline, diesel and jet/kerosene are expected to drive demand growth in the region in 2026. Demand for residual fuel oil is also expected to grow. Regarding petrochemical feedstock, while naphtha is projected to increase only marginally, NGLs/LPG requirements are projected to remain flat, y-o-y. Demand for the 'other products' category is expected to grow, y-o-y.

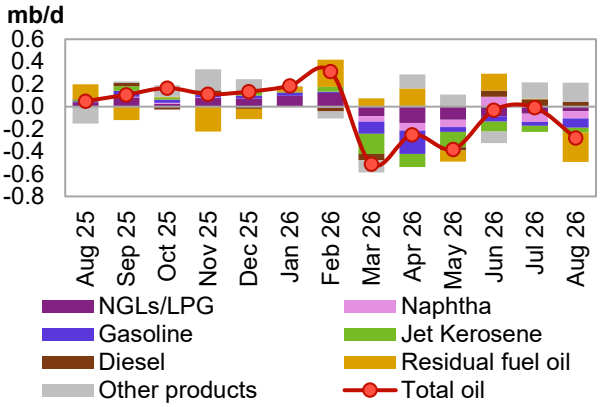
In 2027, Latin America's economy is expected to experience a moderate rebound, supported by a gradual improvement from 2026 growth rates, driven by stable economic activity amid monetary policy easing, reviving domestic demand, and continued strategic investment in the region's energy, mining and agricultural sectors. Brazil's, Argentina's and Venezuela's economies are expected to improve further in 2027, building on anticipated positive performance in 2026. These factors are forecast to support oil demand in the region, which is projected to grow by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 7.2 mb/d.

Middle East

Update on the latest developments

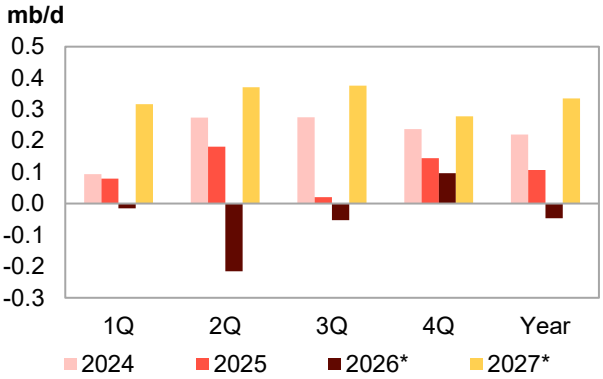
Oil demand in the Middle East in August contracted by 280 tb/d, y-o-y. A large decline of about 210 tb/d from Saudi Arabia, combined with lesser contractions from the United Arab Emirates (UAE), IR Iran and Kuwait, more than offset a y-o-y increase of 80 tb/d seen in Iraq. In terms of products, declines in residual fuel, petrochemical feedstock and transportation fuel requirements more than offset y-o-y increases in the 'other products' category and diesel demand.

Graph 4 - 15: Middle East's oil demand by main petroleum product category, y-o-y change



Sources: JODI, OPEC and national sources.

Graph 4 - 16: Middle East's oil demand, y-o-y change



*Note: * 2026-2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

Regarding specific product demand in August, residual fuel led demand declines of about 260 tb/d, y-o-y, down from broadly flat a month earlier. In petrochemical feedstock, naphtha demand contracted by about 70 tb/d, y-o-y, marginally up from a decline of 80 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. LPG requirements eased by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, though this was an improvement compared with a decline of about 60 tb/d, y-o-y, in July.

In transportation fuels, gasoline requirements eased by 80 tb/d, y-o-y, significantly below a decline of 30 tb/d, y-o-y, seen the previous month. Jet/kerosene demand declined by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, compared with a decline of about 60 tb/d, y-o-y, in July.

Meanwhile, the 'other products' category, including direct crude burning demand, saw the largest increase of about 170 tb/d, y-o-y, up from an increase of about 150 tb/d, y-o-y, seen in July. Demand for diesel increased by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, below an increase of about 70 tb/d, y-o-y, seen in July.

Near-term expectations

Looking ahead, the region's major consuming countries' GDPs are expected to moderate in 4Q26, but remain on a positive path, supported by the non-oil economy. Economic activity in the region is expected to see a gradual stabilization from current headwinds, as mobility, trade flows and economic activity gradually stabilize. Accordingly, oil demand in the region is forecast to increase by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, in 4Q26.

In 2026, the region is expected to remain cautiously resilient, supported by the non-oil economy amid steady private consumption and slowing inflation. Meanwhile, the latest PMI readings from the region's largest economies point to a steady pace of non-oil economic activity. Saudi Arabia's non-oil economy PMI remained on an expansionary trajectory, increasing to 54.7 in September from 52.8 points in August. In the UAE, the non-oil PMI increased to 55.2 in September, up from 54.8 points in August. Meanwhile, Saudi Arabia's annual inflation rate increased to 1.9% in September from 1.8% in August, in line with market expectations.

The inflation rate in the UAE was at 2.04%, y-o-y, largely consistent with market expectations of 2.3%. Despite the positive near-term outlook, oil demand in the region is projected to decline marginally by around 50 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 8.8 mb/d in 2026.

In terms of products, residual fuel is projected to drive y-o-y growth in oil demand in 2026, while diesel is also projected to show some growth. The 'other products' category, including direct crude burning, is expected to marginally increase. However, while gasoline is projected to marginally decline, LPG, naphtha and jet/kerosene are expected to decline more significantly, y-o-y.

In 2027, the region's economy is expected to rebound and economic activity to recover, supported by a resilient non-oil sector and robust domestic demand. Furthermore, infrastructure spending, strong labour market conditions, and moderating inflation are expected to support the region's economies. Strong international air traffic and driving mobility are forecast to support oil demand. Growth in the region's petrochemical industry is projected to continue through 2027. Overall, oil demand in the region is forecast to rebound and grow by about 0.3 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 9.1 mb/d.

World Oil Supply

Non-DoC liquids production (i.e. liquids production from countries not participating in the DoC) is forecast to expand by about 0.6 mb/d in 2026 to average 54.8 mb/d, unchanged from last month's assessment. The main liquids production growth drivers are set to be Brazil, the US, Canada and Argentina.

In 2027, non-DoC liquids production is forecast to grow by about 0.6 mb/d, to average 55.5 mb/d, also unchanged from last month's assessment. The main growth drivers are expected to be Qatar, Canada, Brazil and Argentina.

DoC NGLs and non-conventional liquids are forecast to rise by about 0.1 mb/d in 2026 to average 8.7 mb/d. Further growth of about 0.1 mb/d is expected in 2027, with production forecast to average 8.9 mb/d.

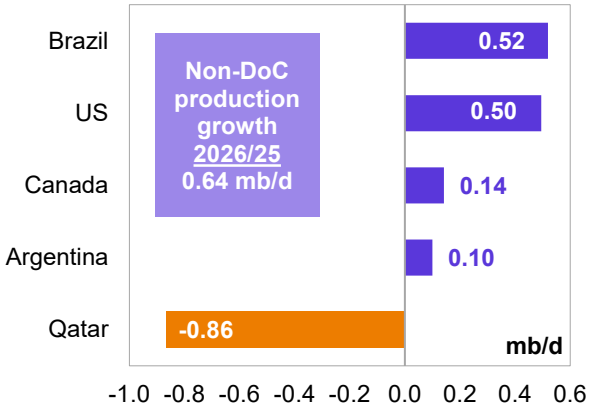
According to available secondary sources, DoC crude oil production in October increased by 2.04 mb/d, m-o-m, to average 41.23 mb/d.

Key drivers of growth and decline

Non-DoC liquids production in 2026 is expected to grow by about 0.6 mb/d, unchanged from last month's assessment. The main growth drivers are set to be Brazil, the US, Canada and Argentina.

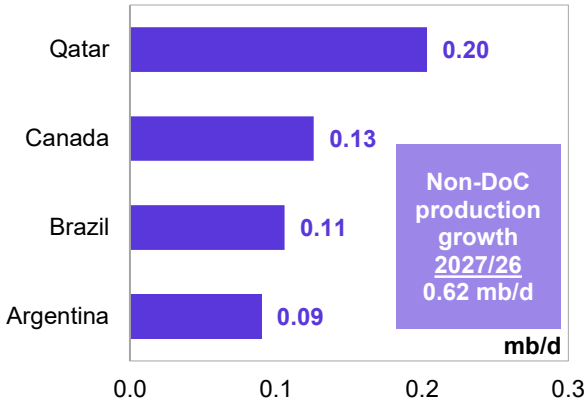
In 2027, liquids supply from non-DoC countries is forecast to expand by about 0.6 mb/d, also unchanged from last month's assessment. Growth is expected to be led by Qatar, Canada, Brazil and Argentina.

Graph 5 - 1: Annual liquids production changes, y-o-y, for selected countries in 2026*



*Note: * 2026 = Forecast. Source: OPEC.*

Graph 5 - 2: Annual liquids production changes, y-o-y, for selected countries in 2027*



*Note: * 2027 = Forecast. Source: OPEC.*

Non-DoC liquids production in 2026 and 2027

Table 5 - 1: Non-DoC liquids production in 2026*, mb/d

Non-DoC liquids production	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026	Change 2026/25
Americas	28.29	28.35	28.89	29.19	29.28	28.93	0.64
of which US	*22.22*	*22.15*	*22.85*	*22.92*	*22.93*	*22.72*	*0.50*
Europe	3.63	3.77	3.57	3.44	3.66	3.61	-0.02
Asia Pacific	0.41	0.39	0.38	0.38	0.37	0.38	-0.02
Total OECD	**32.32**	**32.51**	**32.84**	**33.01**	**33.32**	**32.92**	**0.60**
China	4.62	4.74	4.68	4.65	4.58	4.66	0.04
India	0.82	0.81	0.80	0.80	0.82	0.81	-0.01
Other Asia	1.64	1.66	1.68	1.65	1.63	1.66	0.02
Latin America	7.55	8.20	8.39	8.39	8.50	8.37	0.82
Middle East	1.99	1.53	0.65	1.02	1.37	1.14	-0.85
Africa	2.27	2.23	2.25	2.22	2.32	2.25	-0.01
Other Eurasia	0.36	0.35	0.35	0.36	0.36	0.36	0.00
Other Europe	0.09	0.09	0.09	0.09	0.09	0.09	0.00
Total Non-OECD	**19.34**	**19.61**	**18.89**	**19.19**	**19.67**	**19.34**	**0.01**
Total Non-DoC production	51.66	52.13	51.74	52.20	52.99	52.27	0.61
Processing gains	2.54	2.57	2.57	2.57	2.57	2.57	0.03
Total Non-DoC liquids production	**54.20**	**54.70**	**54.31**	**54.77**	**55.56**	**54.84**	**0.64**

*Note: * 2026 = Forecast. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.*

Source: OPEC.

Table 5 - 2: Non-DoC liquids production in 2027*, mb/d

Non-DoC liquids production	2026	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27	2027	Change 2027/26
Americas	28.93	28.87	28.93	29.19	29.36	29.09	0.16
of which US	*22.72*	*22.52*	*22.78*	*22.83*	*22.85*	*22.75*	*0.03*
Europe	3.61	3.60	3.49	3.44	3.55	3.52	-0.09
Asia Pacific	0.38	0.38	0.36	0.38	0.38	0.37	-0.01
Total OECD	**32.92**	**32.84**	**32.78**	**33.00**	**33.29**	**32.98**	**0.06**
China	4.66	4.69	4.68	4.59	4.60	4.64	-0.02
India	0.81	0.80	0.79	0.79	0.80	0.80	-0.01
Other Asia	1.66	1.64	1.63	1.63	1.65	1.64	-0.02
Latin America	8.37	8.60	8.64	8.74	8.91	8.73	0.36
Middle East	1.14	1.31	1.34	1.37	1.40	1.35	0.21
Africa	2.25	2.29	2.28	2.27	2.27	2.28	0.02
Other Eurasia	0.36	0.36	0.36	0.36	0.36	0.36	0.00
Other Europe	0.09	0.10	0.10	0.10	0.10	0.10	0.00
Total Non-OECD	**19.34**	**19.79**	**19.80**	**19.84**	**20.09**	**19.88**	**0.54**
Total Non-DoC production	52.27	52.64	52.58	52.84	53.38	52.86	0.60
Processing gains	2.57	2.59	2.59	2.59	2.59	2.59	0.02
Total Non-DoC liquids production	**54.84**	**55.23**	**55.17**	**55.43**	**55.97**	**55.45**	**0.62**

*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.*

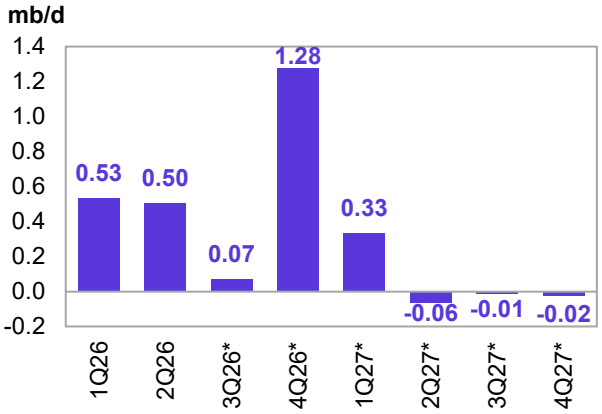
Source: OPEC.

OECD

In 2026, OECD liquids production (excluding DoC participating country, Mexico) is forecast to increase by 0.6 mb/d to average 32.9 mb/d. OECD Americas is expected to be the primary growth driver, with an increase of 0.6 mb/d to average 28.9 mb/d. OECD Europe liquids production is set to drop marginally by 16 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 3.6 mb/d, while OECD Asia Pacific is set to drop by about 24 tb/d to average 0.4 mb/d.

In 2027, OECD liquids production (excluding DoC participating country, Mexico) is forecast to increase by 0.1 mb/d to average 33 mb/d. Growth is again led by OECD Americas, with an expected increase of 0.2 mb/d to average 29.1 mb/d. OECD Europe liquids production is expected to drop by about 90 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 3.5 mb/d, while OECD Asia Pacific is set to fall by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 0.4 mb/d.

Graph 5 - 3: OECD quarterly liquids production, y-o-y changes



*Note: * 3Q26-4Q27 = Forecast. Source: OPEC.*

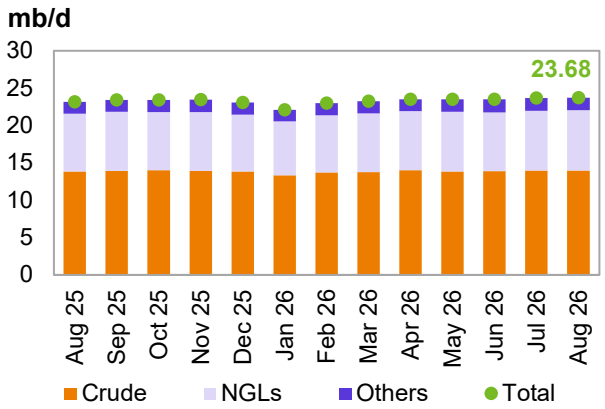
US

According to the US Energy Information Administration (EIA), US liquids production in August 2026 rose by 17 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 23.7 mb/d. This was around 0.5 mb/d higher than the same month last year.

Crude oil and condensate production rose by 19 tb/d, m-o-m, to 14 mb/d. This was up by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y.

In terms of the regional production breakdown of crude oil and condensate by Petroleum Administration for Defence District (PADD), production on the US Gulf Coast (USGC) (PADD 3) dropped by 10 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 10.3 mb/d. Production on the East and West Coasts, as well as the Midwest region (PADD 1, 5 and PADD 2), remained largely unchanged, m-o-m. Crude oil output in the Rocky Mountain region (PADD 4) rose by 25 tb/d, m-o-m.

Graph 5 - 4: US monthly liquids production by key component



Sources: EIA and OPEC.

The m-o-m expansion in output across the main producing regions is primarily reflected in higher production from wells in New Mexico and Colorado, as well as from offshore platforms in the Gulf of Mexico (GoM). However, these gains were largely offset by losses in other regions, such as Texas and Oklahoma.

Table 5 - 3: US crude oil production by selected state and region, tb/d

State	Aug 25	Jul 26	Aug 26	Change m-o-m	Change y-o-y
Texas	5,836	5,768	5,710	*-58*	*-126*
New Mexico	2,243	2,424	2,442	*18*	*199*
Gulf of Mexico (GoM)	2,025	2,043	2,075	*32*	*50*
North Dakota	1,175	1,157	1,164	*7*	*-11*
Colorado	477	442	454	*12*	*-23*
Alaska	387	421	427	*6*	*40*
Oklahoma	393	393	386	*-7*	*-7*
Total	**13,835**	**13,946**	**13,965**	***19***	***130***

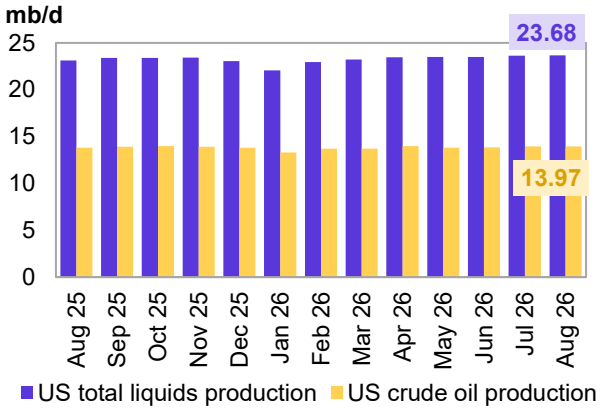
Sources: EIA and OPEC.

According to the US Department of Energy (DoE), NGLs production increased by 75 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 8.1 mb/d in August. This was 0.3 mb/d higher, y-o-y. Non-conventional liquids production (mainly ethanol) fell by 77 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.7 mb/d. Preliminary estimates indicate that non-conventional liquids production remained largely unchanged, m-o-m, to average about 1.7 mb/d in September.

GoM production rose by 32 tb/d, m-o-m, to an average of 2.1 mb/d in August. This was higher by about 50 tb/d, y-o-y. Near-term GoM crude production is expected to benefit from the ramp-up of Shenandoah, first oil from Leon-Castile and ongoing developments at Monument and Longclaw. Nevertheless, Tropical Storm Isaias weighed on October output, with DoE estimates suggesting production fell by around 0.5 mb/d during the second and third weeks of October relative to the first week's average. For the onshore Lower 48, crude and condensate production dropped by about 19 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 11.5 mb/d in August.

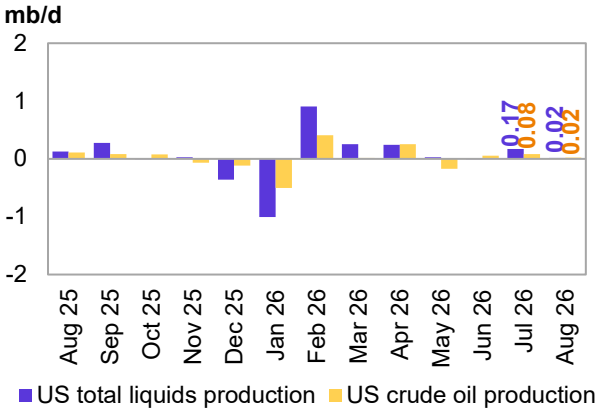
In terms of individual states, New Mexico's oil production rose by 18 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 2.4 mb/d. This is 199 tb/d higher than a year ago. Texas production fell by 58 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 5.7 mb/d. This is 126 tb/d lower than a year ago. In the Midwest, North Dakota's production rose by 7 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.2 mb/d. This was lower by 11 tb/d, y-o-y. Simultaneously, production in Oklahoma dropped slightly, m-o-m, to an average of 0.4 mb/d. Production in Colorado and Alaska rose by 12 tb/d and 6 tb/d, m-o-m, respectively.

Graph 5 - 5: US monthly crude oil and total liquids production



Sources: EIA and OPEC.

Graph 5 - 6: US monthly crude oil and total liquids production, m-o-m changes



Sources: EIA and OPEC.

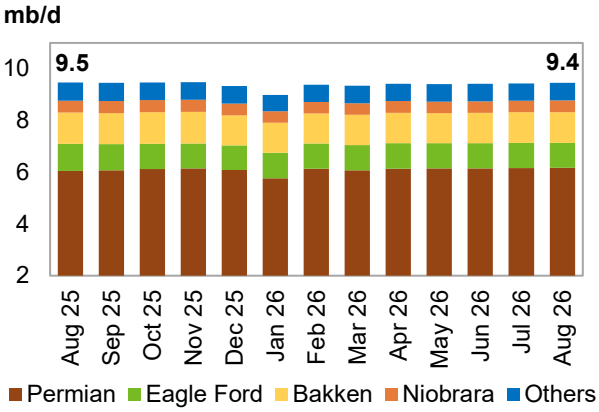
US tight crude production in August is estimated to have risen by 24 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 9.4 mb/d. This draws on the latest EIA estimates. The figure was 16 tb/d lower than the same month in 2025.

Permian production from shale and tight formations using horizontal wells in Texas and New Mexico is estimated to have increased by 10 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 6.2 mb/d. Y-o-y, this was up by 128 tb/d.

In the Williston Basin, Bakken shale oil production is estimated to have risen by a small 2 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.2 mb/d. Y-o-y, however, this was down by 25 tb/d.

Tight crude production from the Eagle Ford in Texas dropped by 6 tb/d to average 1.0 mb/d. This was down by 84 tb/d, y-o-y. Production from the Niobrara-Codell formations in Colorado and Wyoming rose marginally by 7 tb/d, m-o-m, to about 451 tb/d.

Graph 5 - 7: US tight crude production breakdown

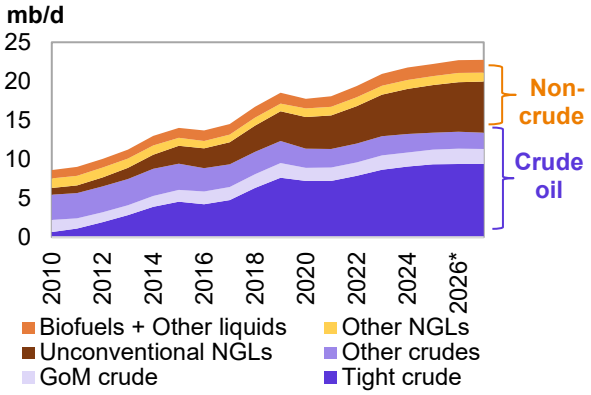


Sources: EIA and OPEC.

In 2026, US liquids production, excluding processing gains, is expected to increase by around 0.5 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 22.7 mb/d. Crude oil and condensate production is set to rise by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 13.5 mb/d. Concurrently, NGLs production is forecast to increase by 0.3 mb/d to average 7.5 mb/d, and non-conventional liquids production is set to rise by about 80 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 1.6 mb/d. Average tight crude production in 2026 is forecast to rise by about 50 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 9.4 mb/d.

Looking ahead, the end of 2026 outlook remains positive, driven by continued capital discipline, incremental drilling expansion, improving completion productivity, and sustained growth in associated gas volumes across key shale regions.

Graph 5 - 8: US liquids production developments by component



*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast.*
Source: OPEC.

In 2027, US liquids production, excluding processing gains, is forecast to grow by just 30 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 22.7 mb/d. Crude oil and condensate output is expected to drop by 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 13.4 mb/d. Conversely, NGLs production is projected to increase by 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 7.7 mb/d, while non-conventional liquids output is forecast to remain largely unchanged at 1.6 mb/d. Average tight crude output in 2027 is expected to increase marginally by about 10 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 9.4 mb/d.

The 2027 outlook remains constructive, supported by prudent capital management, ongoing efficiency improvements, steady drilling momentum, and further growth in associated gas production from the major shale plays.

Table 5 - 4: US liquids production breakdown, mb/d

US liquids	2025	Change 2025/24	2026*	Change 2026/25	2027*	Change 2027/26
Tight crude	9.35	0.26	9.40	0.05	9.41	0.01
GoM crude	1.89	0.10	1.96	0.07	1.91	-0.05
Conventional crude oil	2.18	-0.18	2.16	-0.02	2.09	-0.07
Total crude	**13.42**	**0.18**	**13.53**	**0.11**	**13.42**	**-0.11**
Unconventional NGLs	6.08	0.31	6.38	0.30	6.55	0.17
Conventional NGLs	1.15	0.00	1.16	0.01	1.13	-0.03
Total NGLs	**7.24**	**0.30**	**7.54**	**0.31**	**7.68**	**0.14**
Biofuels + Other liquids	1.57	-0.03	1.65	0.08	1.65	0.00
US total production	**22.22**	**0.46**	**22.72**	**0.50**	**22.75**	**0.03**

*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast.*

Sources: EIA and OPEC.

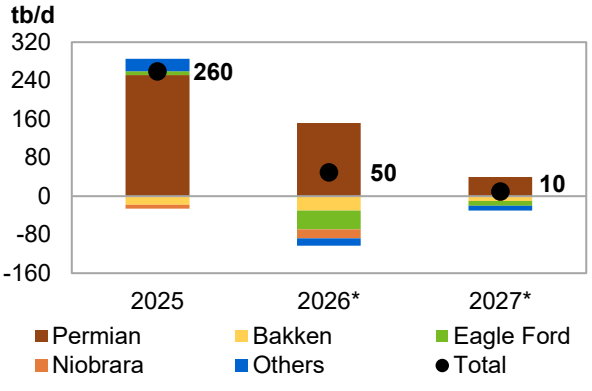
US tight crude production in the Permian Basin during 2026 is expected to increase by 152 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 6.1 mb/d. In 2027, production is forecast to increase by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y.

In North Dakota, Bakken shale production is forecast to drop by about 30 tb/d, y-o-y, to stand at about 1.2 mb/d in 2026. This remains below its pre-pandemic average of 1.4 mb/d. A decline of about 10 tb/d in 2027 would be consistent with the basin's progression toward a mature development stage.

Production in the Eagle Ford Basin in Texas is expected to drop by about 39 tb/d in 2026 to average 1 mb/d. Y-o-y, production is then forecast to decline by a further 10 tb/d in 2027.

In the Niobrara region, production in 2026 is forecast to drop by about 19 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 446 tb/d. Given the expectation of stable output in 2027, regional production is estimated to remain approximately unchanged in the short term.

Graph 5 - 9: US tight crude production by shale play, y-o-y changes



*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast.*
Sources: EIA and OPEC.

In other tight oil plays, y-o-y output is forecast to experience a modest drop of about 15 tb/d in 2026 to average about 677 tb/d. An additional decline of around 10 tb/d is anticipated in 2027, driven by tightening core acreage availability.

Table 5 - 5: US tight oil production growth, mb/d

US tight oil	2025	Change 2025/24	2026*	Change 2026/25	2027*	Change 2027/26
Permian tight	5.97	0.25	6.12	0.15	6.16	0.04
Bakken shale	1.20	-0.02	1.17	-0.03	1.16	-0.01
Eagle Ford shale	1.02	0.01	0.98	-0.04	0.97	-0.01
Niobrara shale	0.47	-0.01	0.45	-0.02	0.45	0.00
Other tight plays	0.69	0.03	0.68	-0.02	0.67	-0.01
Total	**9.35**	**0.26**	**9.40**	**0.05**	**9.41**	**0.01**

*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast.*

Sources: EIA and OPEC.

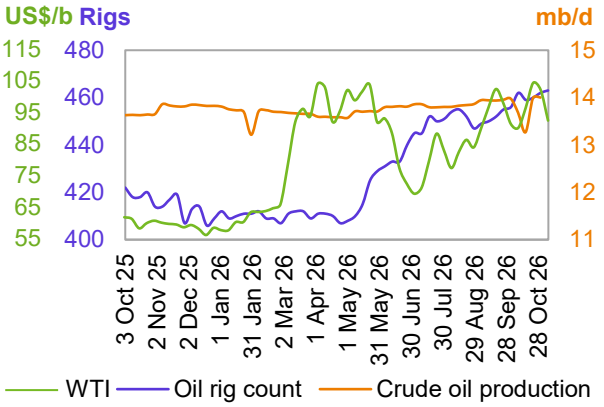
US rig count, spudded, completed, DUC wells and fracking activity

According to Baker Hughes, the total number of active US oil and gas drilling rigs in the week ending 6 November 2026 rose by one, w-o-w, to 604. The total was 56 rigs higher than a year ago. The number of active offshore rigs dropped by two, w-o-w, to 12. Compared with the same month in 2025, this is down by seven. The number of onshore oil and gas rigs rose by three, w-o-w, to 591, with one rig in inland waters. This was up by 64 rigs, y-o-y.

The US horizontal rig count rose by two, w-o-w, to 529. This compares with 478 horizontal rigs a year ago. The number of drilling rigs for oil increased by one, w-o-w, to 463, while the number of gas drilling rigs increased by one, w-o-w, to 131.

The Permian rig count rose by one, w-o-w, to 273. The rig count in the Williston Basin dropped by one, w-o-w, to 35. The rig counts in the Eagle Ford, Cana Woodford and DJ-Niobrara Basins remained unchanged, w-o-w, at 50, 18 and 9, respectively.

Graph 5 - 10: US weekly rig count vs. US crude oil production and WTI price



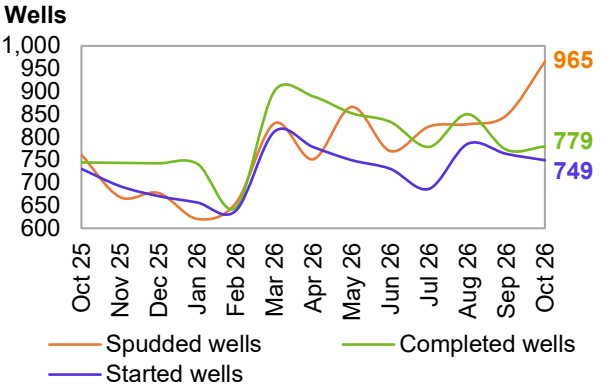
Sources: Baker Hughes, EIA and OPEC.

Based on preliminary data, drilling and completion activities for oil-producing wells across all US shale plays included 847 horizontal wells spudded in September. This is up by 19, m-o-m, and 17% higher than the same month a year earlier.

The preliminary September 2026 data indicate a lower number of completed wells, m-o-m, at 772. However, this is up by about 12%, y-o-y. The number of started wells is estimated at 763, which is approximately 5% higher than the same period in 2025.

Preliminary data for October show 965 spudded, 779 completed, and 749 started wells, according to Rystad Energy.

Graph 5 - 11: Spudded, completed and started wells in US shale plays

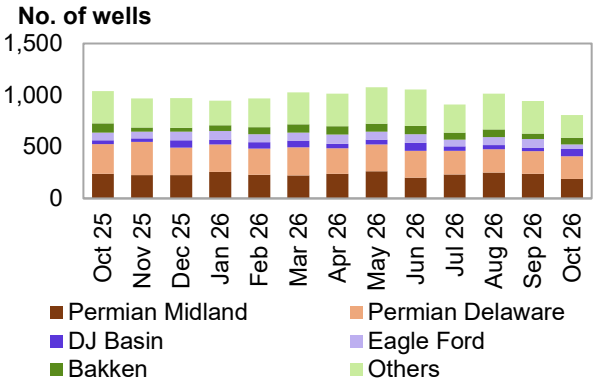


Note: Sep 26-Oct 26 = Preliminary data.
Sources: Rystad Energy and OPEC.

For US oil and gas fracking operations, 1,014 wells began fracking in August 2026. In September and October, 944 and 806 wells began fracking, respectively, according to preliminary numbers based on an analysis of high-frequency satellite data.

In regional terms, preliminary September data for the Permian Midland and Permian Delaware regions indicate that 237 and 219 wells, respectively, began fracking. This represents a drop of 13 wells in the Midland and six in the Delaware, m-o-m. Preliminary data also indicates that during September, 36 wells began fracking in the DJ Basin, 82 in the Eagle Ford and 52 in the Bakken.

Graph 5 - 12: Started fracs per month by region



Note: Sep 26-Oct 26 = Preliminary data.
Sources: Rystad Energy and OPEC.

Canada

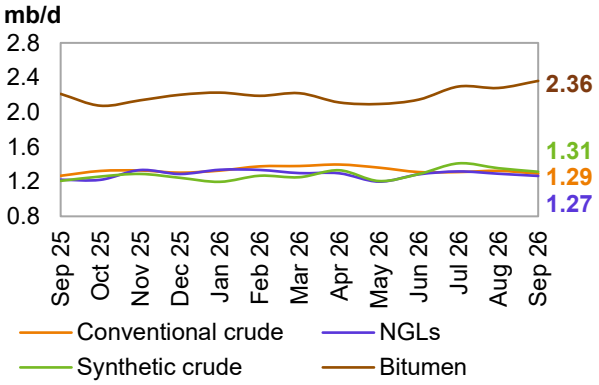
Canada's September liquids production is estimated to have fallen by about 16 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 6.3 mb/d. Conventional crude production dropped by about 32 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.3 mb/d. NGLs production fell by 25 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.3 mb/d.

Crude bitumen production in September rose by 82 tb/d, m-o-m, while synthetic crude production fell by 41 tb/d. Taken together, crude bitumen and synthetic crude production averaged 3.7 mb/d over the month.

Output is estimated to have increased by about 0.2 mb/d, q-o-q, in 3Q26, as maintenance-related downtime improved and oil sand production recovered strongly.

In 2026, Canada's liquids production is forecast to expand by 0.1 mb/d to average 6.2 mb/d. Growth in oil sands production is expected to stem from asset extensions, debottlenecking projects, brownfield developments, and the increasing adoption of advanced drilling technologies.

Graph 5 - 13: Canada's monthly liquids production development by type

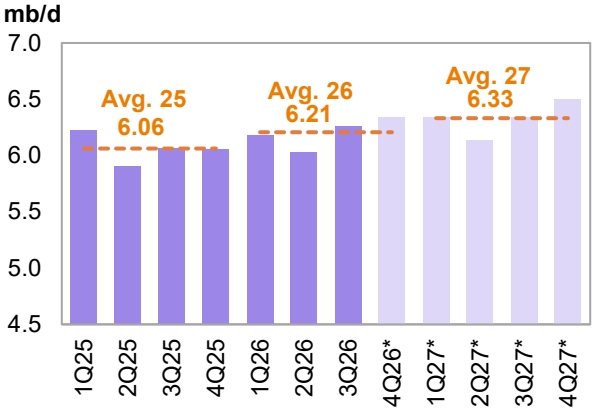


Sources: Statistics Canada, Alberta Energy Regulator and OPEC.

Additional output is estimated to come from the Montney play, Athabasca, Clear Water formation, Syncrude Mildred Lake, Kearl, Hebron, Suncor, Foster Creek, Firebag, Fort Hills, Duvernay and Cold Lake developments. Key start-ups in 2026 include the Foster Creek, Leismer, Christina Lake North, Blackrod and Meota SAGD projects. Following the completion of platform integration and subsea tieback work, Cenovus's White Rose Extension is in the final commissioning phase and remains on track for first oil in the coming weeks.

In 2027, Canada's liquids production is forecast to expand by a further 0.1 mb/d to average 6.3 mb/d. Further production is expected from the Montney play, Horizon oil sands, Athabasca oil sands, Syncrude Mildred Lake/Aurora, Kearl, Duvernay, Foster Creek, Suncor oil sands and Christina Lake. The key start-ups in 2027 are expected to be Aspen, Reford SAGD, Kirby-Pike and Horizon oil sands developments.

Graph 5 - 14: Canada's quarterly liquids production and forecast



*Note: * 4Q26-4Q27 = Forecast. Source: OPEC.*

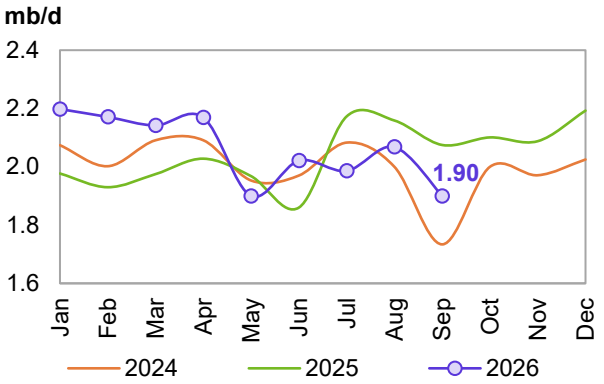
Norway

Norwegian liquids production in September dropped by 0.2 mb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.9 mb/d. Crude production declined by 145 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 1.7 mb/d. This was around 158 tb/d lower, y-o-y. Monthly oil production was 0.7% higher than the Norwegian Offshore Directorate's (NOD) forecast.

NGLs and condensate production in September was lower by 23 tb/d, m-o-m, averaging about 0.2 mb/d, according to NOD data.

Norwegian liquids production is forecast to rise by about 20 tb/d to average 2.1 mb/d in 2026. This is slightly lower than last month's assessment. Norwegian production has gained momentum this year, aided by effective maintenance management and continued ramp-ups at Johan Castberg, Balder/Ringhorne, Heidrun, Edvard Grieg, Maria and Snøhvit. These are expected to support further output growth.

Graph 5 - 15: Norway's monthly liquids production development



Sources: The Norwegian Offshore Directorate (NOD) and OPEC.

Additional contributions are assumed from assets such as the Norne floating production, storage, and offloading (FPSO) platform, the Symra, Edvard Grieg and Eirin oil fields, and the Irpa (Asterix) and Dvalin gas condensate projects.

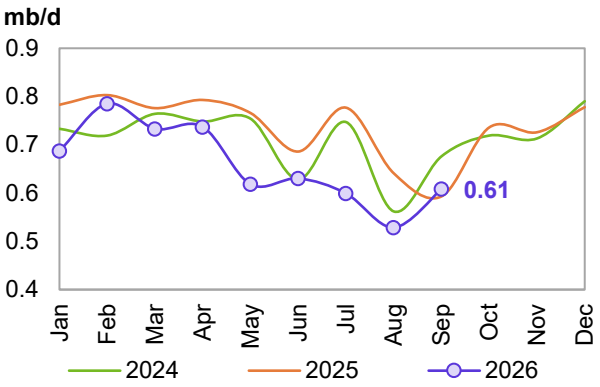
In 2027, liquids production is forecast to drop by around 70 tb/d to average 2.0 mb/d, although a number of projects are still set to provide incremental additions over the year. Production at Snorre, Symra and Edvard Grieg are expected to deliver steady ramp-ups. Separately, some new start-ups at Bestla, Valhall and Brage are likely to add moderate volumes. The expansion is supported by ongoing progress at Yggdrasil and its constituent North of Alvheim, Krafla/Askja and Lille Frigg developments, as well as the Symra and Bestla projects.

UK

In September, UK liquids production is estimated to have risen by 80 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 0.6 mb/d. Crude oil production increased by 70 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 0.5 mb/d. Based on preliminary national data, the September crude level was about 28 tb/d higher, y-o-y. NGLs production rose by about 10 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 59 tb/d.

In 2026, UK liquids production is forecast to drop by approximately 60 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 0.7 mb/d. Production ramp-ups are assumed at the Clair, Triton, Buzzard, Penguins and Murlach (Skua redevelopment) assets, along with the Captain enhanced oil recovery (EOR) phase. Ongoing production drops from mature upstream assets are expected to be a counterweight to the estimated increases.

Graph 5 - 16: UK monthly liquids production development



Sources: UK Department for Energy Security and Net Zero and OPEC.

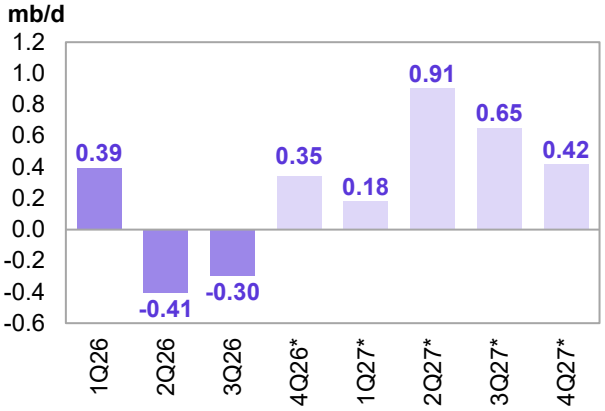
UK liquids production is forecast to drop by about 30 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 0.6 mb/d in 2027. Slight production increases are projected at Clair, Buzzard, Penguins, Jackdaw and Anasuria, with Rosebank expected to be the principal asset to come online. However, continuing declines across ageing fields are again expected to absorb a significant share of the incremental gains. With regulatory approval now secured, the Jackdaw gas condensate project is set to commence production in 2027, providing a new source of domestic gas supply amid ongoing declines in UK North Sea output.

Non-OECD

In 2026, non-OECD liquids production (excluding countries participating in the DoC) is forecast to rise slightly by about 10 tb/d to average 19.3 mb/d.

In 2027, non-OECD liquids production (excluding countries participating in the DoC) is forecast to expand by 0.5 mb/d to average 19.9 mb/d.

Graph 5 - 17: Non-OECD quarterly liquids production, y-o-y changes



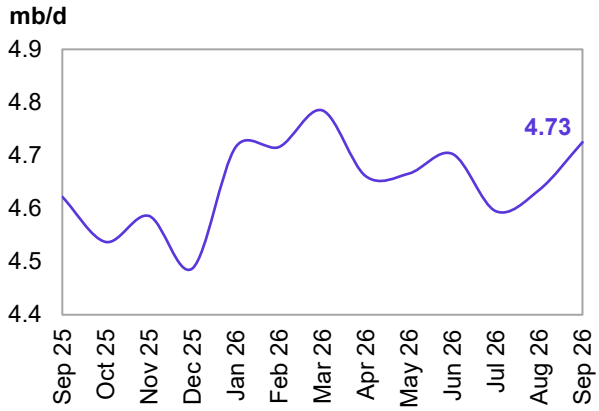
*Note: * 4Q26-4Q27 = Forecast. Source: OPEC.*

China

China's liquids production rose by 90 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 4.7 mb/d in September. According to official data, this is up by 103 tb/d, y-o-y. September crude oil production averaged 4.4 mb/d. This was up by 90 tb/d from the previous month, and higher by 106 tb/d, y-o-y.

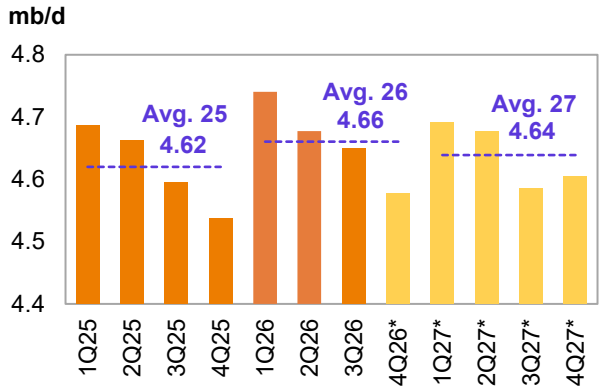
NGLs production remained largely unchanged, m-o-m, at an average of about 21 tb/d. This was largely consistent with the same month last year.

Graph 5 - 18: China's monthly liquids production development



Sources: National Bureau of Statistics of China and OPEC.

Graph 5 - 19: China's quarterly liquids production and forecast



*Note: * 4Q26-4Q27 = Forecast.*
Sources: National Bureau of Statistics of China and OPEC.

In 2026, China's liquids production is expected to rise by about 40 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 4.7 mb/d. This is slightly higher than last month's assessment. Supported by intensive infill drilling, EOR initiatives and sustained capital expenditure, decline rates across China's mature onshore fields are expected to remain contained, preserving output from key legacy assets. Meanwhile, offshore developments in the Bohai Bay and South China Sea are set to remain the main source of production growth, aided by strong investment activity, ongoing field expansions and the ramp-up of recently sanctioned and commissioned projects.

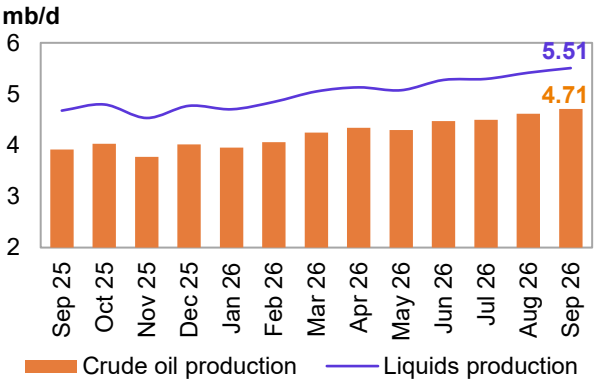
Several oil and gas condensate projects are still set to come online, namely Kenli 10-1N and Kenli 9-1. Most of the projects this year have been operated by China National Offshore Oil Corporation (CNOOC), Sinopec, and PetroChina. Concurrently, production ramp-ups are assumed from the Weizhou 11-4, Weizhou 10-3W, Peng Lai 19-3/19-9, Wushi 17-2, Xijiang 30-2, Kenli 10-2, Lufeng, Lvda 10-1 and Huizhou 26-6 projects.

In 2027, Chinese liquids production is forecast to drop by about 20 tb/d, y-o-y, to average 4.6 mb/d. The year is expected to see the commencement of several additional oil and gas-condensate developments, such as Bozhong 26-6, Bozhong 34-1W, Bozhong 19-6, Weizhou 11-4, Weizhou 4, Panyu 10-4 and Shengli. Concurrently, further ramp-ups are expected at the Kenli, Yanchang, Baikouquan tight oil (Xinjiang), Xibei, Bozhong and the East China Sea projects.

Brazil

Brazil's crude production in September rose by 93 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 4.7 mb/d. NGLs production remained largely unchanged, m-o-m, at an average of about 0.1 mb/d. It is expected to remain at a similar level in October. Biofuel production (mainly ethanol) is estimated to have remained steady, m-o-m, at an average of 0.7 mb/d, with preliminary October data indicating a stable trend. The country's total liquids production rose by about 91 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 5.5 mb/d. This is higher by 0.8 mb/d, y-o-y.

Graph 5 - 20: Brazil's monthly liquids production development by type



Sources: Brazilian National Agency of Petroleum, Natural Gas and Biofuels (ANP) and OPEC.

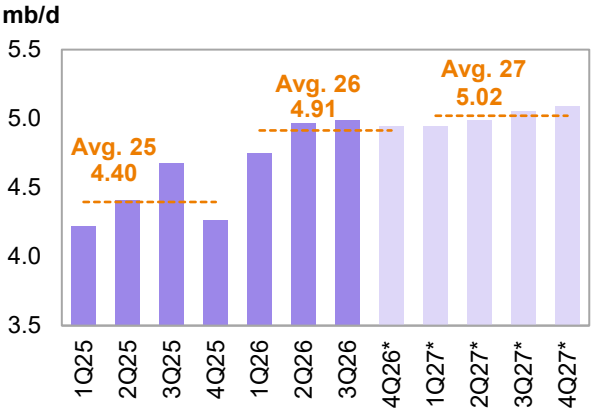
In 2026, Brazil's liquids production, including biofuels, is forecast to rise by about 0.5 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 4.9 mb/d. Upstream liquids production is set to increase through production ramp-ups at the Buzios (Franco), Mero (Libra NW), Marlim, Bacalhau (x-Carcara) and Wahoo projects. Additional oil project start-ups are also assumed to come from the Lapa and Gaviao assets.

Offshore growth in Brazil remains firmly supported by the expansion of pre-salt production, which enabled crude output to reach a fresh record in September. Looking ahead, production growth is expected to be sustained by the ramp-up of recently commissioned Santos Basin projects, the continued development of prolific pre-salt reservoirs and the phased start-up of new Petrobras-operated FPSOs.

In 2027, Brazil's liquids supply, including biofuels, is forecast to increase by about 0.1 mb/d, y-o-y, to average 5.0 mb/d. Upstream liquids output is expected to rise as production scales up at the Buzios (Franco), Bacalhau and Wahoo projects. Oil project start-ups are anticipated at the Buzios field and the Pampo-Enchova Cluster assets.

Despite the potential for additional start-up projects in offshore Brazil, rising development costs and high inflation could tighten offshore project economics, leading to possible delays in project implementation.

Graph 5 - 21: Brazil's quarterly liquids production



*Note: * 4Q26-4Q27 = Forecast. Sources: ANP and OPEC.*

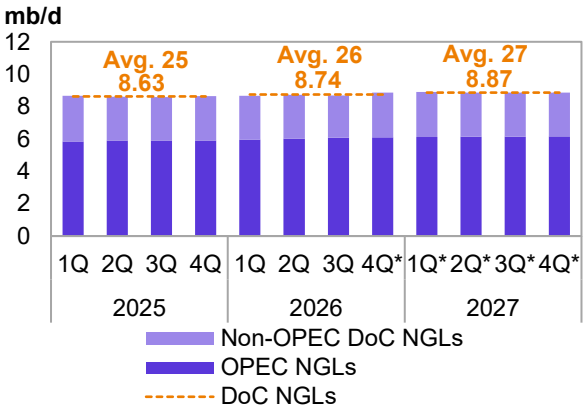
DoC NGLs and non-conventional liquids

Preliminary data show that NGLs and non-conventional liquids production in 3Q26 averaged 8.7 mb/d. According to preliminary data, OPEC Member Countries and non-OPEC DoC countries are estimated to have produced 6.1 mb/d and 2.6 mb/d of NGLs and non-conventional liquids, respectively.

The 2026 forecast indicates a combined increase of approximately 0.1 mb/d, bringing the average to 8.7 mb/d. For OPEC Member Countries, NGLs and non-conventional liquids production is projected to rise by around 150 tb/d to average 6.0 mb/d. However, a drop of about 35 tb/d is forecast for non-OPEC DoC countries to an average of 2.7 mb/d.

In 2027, the forecast shows collective growth of 0.1 mb/d, bringing the average to 8.9 mb/d. NGLs and non-conventional liquids for OPEC Member Countries are forecast to grow by about 100 tb/d, bringing the average to 6.1 mb/d. Non-OPEC DoC countries are expected to see limited growth of about 30 tb/d.

Graph 5 - 22: DoC NGLs and non-conventional liquids quarterly production and forecast



*Note: * 4Q26-4Q27 = Forecast. Source: OPEC.*

Table 5 - 6: DoC NGLs + non-conventional liquids production, mb/d

DoC NGLs and non-conventional liquids	2025	Change 25/24	2026	Change 26/25	2027	Change 27/26
OPEC	**5.90**	*0.13*	**6.05**	*0.15*	**6.15**	*0.10*
Non-OPEC DoC	**2.73**	*-0.03*	**2.70**	*-0.04*	**2.73**	*0.03*
Total	**8.63**	***0.09***	**8.74**	***0.11***	**8.87**	***0.13***

Note: 2026 and 2027 = Forecast.
Source: OPEC.

DoC crude oil production

Total DoC crude oil production averaged 41.23 mb/d in October 2026, which is about 2.04 mb/d higher, m-o-m.

Table 5 – 7: DoC crude oil production based on *secondary sources*, tb/d

Secondary sources	2024	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct/Sep
Algeria	905	935	972	983	999	1,000	1,003	1,002	-2
Congo	253	260	268	281	278	273	285	270	-15
Equatorial Guinea	57	53	51	49	49	48	45	44	-1
Gabon	222	227	214	216	210	217	207	212	5
IR Iran	3,257	3,263	3,142	2,532	2,168	2,056	1,957	1,914	-44
Iraq	4,163	4,027	3,313	1,628	3,408	3,534	3,995	4,491	496
Kuwait	2,429	2,475	2,100	867	1,840	1,906	1,766	1,998	232
Libya	1,092	1,296	1,272	1,310	1,337	1,348	1,297	1,333	36
Nigeria	1,433	1,512	1,453	1,552	1,562	1,575	1,569	1,542	-27
Saudi Arabia	8,978	9,471	9,278	6,822	7,528	7,257	8,012	9,194	1,182
UAE	2,978	3,167	2,898	2,668	3,842	3,831	3,917	4,008	91
Venezuela	867	941	920	1,089	1,134	1,132	1,147	1,158	11
Total OPEC	**26,636**	**27,628**	**25,880**	**19,999**	**24,355**	**24,176**	**25,199**	**27,164**	**1,965**
Azerbaijan	481	461	454	456	450	442	451	447	-4
Bahrain	176	179	102	44	96	93	120	135	15
Brunei	79	86	89	79	91	91	90	88	-2
Kazakhstan	1,539	1,778	1,451	1,887	1,777	1,829	1,853	1,887	34
Malaysia	347	346	332	329	305	308	306	302	-4
Mexico	1,578	1,458	1,452	1,465	1,451	1,449	1,440	1,441	1
Oman	766	777	813	916	939	940	949	941	-8
Russia	9,197	9,129	9,183	8,960	8,722	8,681	8,627	8,668	41
Sudan	29	24	21	23	23	22	22	22	-1
South Sudan	71	109	126	131	140	140	138	136	-2
Total Non-OPEC DoC	**14,263**	**14,347**	**14,022**	**14,290**	**13,994**	**13,995**	**13,996**	**14,065**	**70**
Total DoC	**40,898**	**41,975**	**39,902**	**34,289**	**38,349**	**38,171**	**39,195**	**41,230**	**2,035**

Notes: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding, given available secondary sources to date.

Source: OPEC.

OPEC crude oil production

OPEC crude oil production for October, as reported by OPEC Member Countries, is shown in ***Table 5 - 8*** below.

Table 5 - 8: OPEC crude oil production based on *direct communication*, tb/d

Direct communication	2024	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct/Sep
Algeria	907	936	972	984	1,001	1,000	1,007	1,009	2
Congo	260	271	282	283	286	278	300	..	..
Equatorial Guinea	57	46	46	43	..	..	..	..	..
Gabon	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
IR Iran	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
Iraq	3,862	3,775	3,356	1,781	3,674	3,746	4,399	4,888	489
Kuwait	2,411	2,470	2,105	926	1,912	1,988	1,774	2,100	326
Libya	1,136	1,372	1,322	1,389	1,393	1,397	1,391	1,402	11
Nigeria	1,345	1,432	1,388	1,525	1,512	1,500	1,530	1,513	-16
Saudi Arabia	8,955	9,480	9,298	6,844	7,504	7,122*	7,988*	9,203*	1,215
UAE	2,916	3,119	2,877	2,644	..	..	..	..	..
Venezuela	921	1,081	1,013	1,167	1,202	1,201	1,206	1,224	19
Total OPEC	**..**	**..**	**..**	**..**	**..**	**..**	**..**	**..**	**..**

Notes: .. Not available. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

** Saudi Arabia's supply to the market was 7,122 tb/d in Aug 26, 7,988 tb/d in Sep 26, and 9,203 tb/d in Oct 26.*

** Saudi Arabia's production was 6,238 tb/d in Aug 26, 8,372 tb/d in Sep 26, and 10,563 tb/d in Oct 26.*

Source: OPEC.

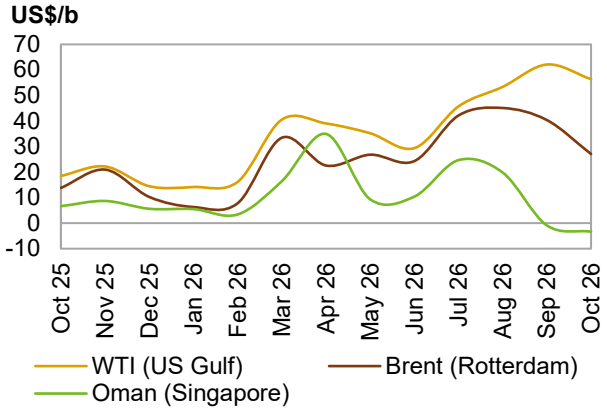
Product Markets and Refinery Operations

In October, refining margins dropped across the main trading hubs amid higher feedstock and freight costs. On the US Gulf Coast (USGC), margins retreated from the high levels registered in September, as losses in gasoline and gasoil outweighed improvements in jet/kerosene and fuel oil crack spreads. In Rotterdam, margins recorded the largest decline, mainly reflecting weaker gasoline and gasoil cracks, while jet/kerosene continued to provide support. In Singapore, reported refining margins against Oman remained negative and declined further, although most product crack spreads against Dubai improved, particularly high-sulphur fuel oil (HSFO).

Refinery margins

USGC refining margins against WTI declined in October, reversing the upward trend observed over the previous three months. Gasoline and gasoil accounted for most of the losses, reflecting seasonally weaker road-fuel demand and easing diesel supply concerns. Nevertheless, margins remained elevated, supported by firm transportation fuel cracks.

Graph 6 - 1: Refining margins



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

Gasoline markets weakened following the end of the summer driving season and the transition to winter-grade specifications. Continued exports and relatively low stock levels provided some support but were insufficient to offset the monthly decline. Gasoil cracks also retreated from September's high levels, as expectations of additional diesel availability in other regions weighed on the market. In contrast, jet/kerosene cracks strengthened again, while fuel oil cracks rebounded firmly, which limited the decline in overall margins. Lower domestic product supply also contributed to limiting margin declines, as US refinery throughput declined by 247 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 16.77 mb/d in October. USGC refining margins against WTI averaged $56.35/b, down $5.73/b, m-o-m, but up $37.89/b, y-o-y.

In Rotterdam, refining margins against Brent declined sharply in October, extending the losses registered in September, amid higher feedstock prices. Gasoline represented the largest source of weakness, followed by gasoil. Seasonal demand weakness and the transition to winter-grade gasoline weighed on light-end markets, while the prospect of improving diesel availability eased some of the supply concerns that had supported margins in previous months. Diesel arrivals and expectations of emergency stock releases from G7 countries weighed on gasoil markets, although persistent supply uncertainty limited the decline. Jet/kerosene remained comparatively firm, supported by low stocks at the ARA hub and reduced regional refinery output due to seasonal maintenance. At the bottom of the barrel, weaker low-sulphur fuel oil cracks added pressure to refining economics, while HSFO improved slightly.

According to preliminary data, refinery throughput in EU-14 plus Norway and the UK declined by 388 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 9.19 mb/d. Rotterdam refining margins against Brent averaged $27.02/b in October, down by $13.32/b, m-o-m, but up $13.29/b, y-o-y.

In Singapore, refining margins against Oman declined further in October and remained negative. This is despite improvements in most product crack spreads. HSFO registered the strongest increase, followed by naphtha and jet/kerosene, while gasoline also strengthened. Gasoil was the only product that recorded a monthly decline. Constrained regional availability and reduced arbitrage inflows supported HSFO and naphtha markets. Gasoline and jet/kerosene also benefited from supply uncertainty, although increased regional offers moderated market strength later in the month. According to preliminary data, refinery intake in Selected Asia declined by 339 tb/d, m-o-m, to average 25.98 mb/d. Singapore refining margins against Oman averaged negative $3.33/b in October, down $2.45/b, m-o-m, and $9.96/b lower, y-o-y.

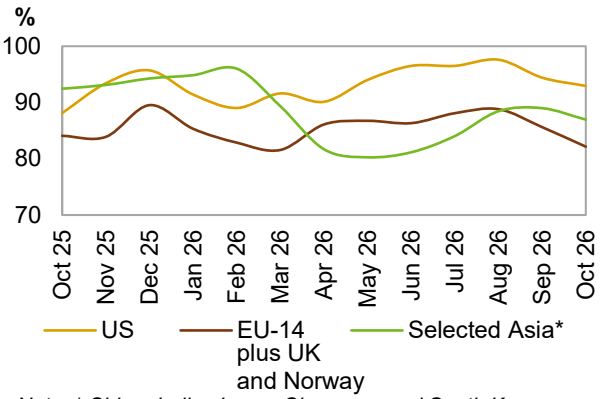
Refinery operations

Global refinery crude intake averaged 78.61 mb/d in October, down 1.23 mb/d from the previous month. Processing rates declined in the US, Europe and Selected Asia, despite a reduction in global offline refinery capacity.

US refinery utilization rates declined by 1.5 pp, m-o-m, to average 92.9% in October. This corresponded to refinery throughput of 16.77 mb/d, down 247 tb/d. Processing rates remained below September levels amid the autumn turnaround season.

In EU-14 plus Norway and the UK, refinery utilization rates fell by 3.5 pp to average 82.1%, corresponding to throughput of 9.19 mb/d. This represented a decline of 388 tb/d, m-o-m. Lower processing rates in France, the UK, Italy and Germany contributed to the decline. The decline was amid higher offline capacity in OECD Europe and the increased autumn maintenance.

Graph 6 - 2: Refinery utilization rates



*Note: * China, India, Japan, Singapore and South Korea.*
Sources: Argus, EIA, PAJ and OPEC.

In Selected Asia – China, India, Japan, and South Korea – refinery utilization rates declined by 2 pp to average 87%. Throughput fell by 339 tb/d, m-o-m, to 25.98 mb/d. China accounted for the largest reduction, with refinery intake declining by 268 tb/d to 13.78 mb/d. South Korean and Japanese throughput fell by 141 tb/d and 29 tb/d, respectively. These declines were partly offset by higher processing in India, where intake increased by 91 tb/d to average 5.69 mb/d.

Table 6 - 1: Refinery operations in selected OECD countries

	Refinery throughput, mb/d				*Refinery utilization, %*			
	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct/Sep	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct/Sep
US	**17.59**	**17.02**	**16.77**	**-0.25**	**97.60**	**94.40**	**92.93**	**-1.5 pp**
Euro-14, plus UK and Norway	**9.93**	**9.58**	**9.19**	**-0.39**	**88.79**	**85.60**	**82.13**	**-3.5 pp**
France	0.99	1.00	0.88	-0.12	86.11	86.60	76.41	-10.2 pp
Germany	1.49	1.68	1.64	-0.04	86.87	97.74	95.66	-2.1 pp
Italy	1.38	1.31	1.26	-0.05	75.94	72.22	69.26	-3.0 pp
UK	0.91	0.86	0.79	-0.07	88.13	83.57	77.16	-6.4 pp
Selected Asia	**26.16**	**26.32**	**25.98**	**-0.34**	**88.45**	**88.99**	**86.96**	**-2.0 pp**
China	13.97	14.04	13.78	-0.27	82.64	83.08	80.08	-3.0 pp
India	5.45	5.60	5.69	0.09	101.77	104.51	106.20	1.7 pp
Japan	2.35	2.40	2.37	-0.03	75.55	77.86	76.94	-0.9 pp
South Korea	2.98	2.86	2.71	-0.14	98.77	94.75	90.05	-4.7 pp

Sources: Argus Media, EIA, NBS, PAJ and OPEC.

Table 6 - 2: Refinery crude throughput, mb/d

Refinery crude throughput	2023	2024	2025	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26
OECD Americas	**18.71**	**18.96**	**19.13**	**19.31**	**18.98**	**19.43**	**20.03**	**19.62**
of which US	*16.50*	*16.62*	*16.70*	*16.69*	*16.42*	*16.85*	*17.34*	*16.89*
OECD Europe	**11.38**	**11.28**	**11.28**	**11.24**	**10.87**	**11.34**	**11.75**	**11.38**
of which:								
France	*0.93*	*0.92*	*0.96*	*1.04*	*0.97*	*0.89*	*0.98*	*0.95*
Germany	*1.62*	*1.76*	*1.69*	*1.71*	*1.65*	*1.65*	*1.61*	*1.56*
Italy	*1.30*	*1.21*	*1.22*	*1.13*	*1.10*	*1.27*	*1.32*	*1.26*
UK	*0.97*	*0.98*	*0.93*	*0.89*	*0.88*	*0.86*	*0.88*	*0.83*
OECD Asia Pacific	**5.86**	**5.69**	**5.72**	**5.92**	**5.91**	**5.12**	**5.71**	**5.79**
of which Japan	*2.56*	*2.37*	*2.39*	*2.53*	*2.56*	*2.20*	*2.39*	*2.45*
Total OECD	**35.95**	**35.93**	**36.12**	**36.47**	**35.76**	**35.89**	**37.49**	**36.79**
Latin America	**3.54**	**3.69**	**3.68**	**3.64**	**3.57**	**3.63**	**3.53**	**3.60**
Middle East	**7.53**	**7.95**	**8.06**	**7.97**	**7.68**	**6.39**	**6.81**	**7.27**
Africa	**1.74**	**1.89**	**2.19**	**2.27**	**2.11**	**2.28**	**2.36**	**2.39**
India	**5.18**	**5.30**	**5.44**	**5.44**	**5.61**	**5.27**	**5.55**	**5.64**
China	**14.77**	**14.25**	**14.80**	**14.88**	**15.03**	**12.86**	**13.52**	**13.92**
Other Asia	**5.19**	**5.22**	**5.08**	**5.19**	**4.98**	**4.39**	**5.00**	**5.32**
Russia	**5.50**	**5.35**	**5.21**	**5.16**	**5.18**	**4.34**	**3.86**	**4.11**
Other Eurasia	**1.03**	**1.04**	**1.07**	**1.08**	**1.09**	**0.91**	**0.84**	**0.91**
Other Europe	**0.48**	**0.51**	**0.48**	**0.44**	**0.40**	**0.53**	**0.45**	**0.43**
Total Non-OECD	**44.95**	**45.19**	**46.02**	**46.06**	**45.65**	**40.61**	**41.93**	**43.58**
Total world	**80.91**	**81.12**	**82.14**	**82.52**	**81.41**	**76.50**	**79.41**	**80.37**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

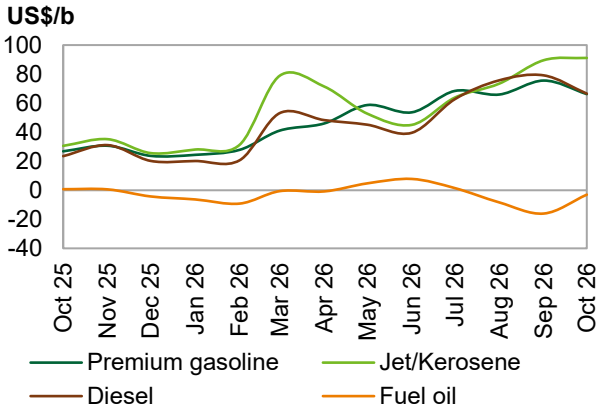
Sources: AFREC, APEC, EIA, IEA, PAJ, Ministry data, including Ministry of Energy of the Russian Federation, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas of India, OPEC and JODI.

Product markets

US market

The USGC gasoline crack spread declined in October, pressured by seasonally weaker domestic consumption and the transition to winter-grade specifications. Continued export demand and relatively low inventories provided some support, although they were insufficient to prevent a monthly loss. The USGC gasoline crack spread against WTI averaged $66.32/b, down $9.33/b, m-o-m, but up $39.46/b, y-o-y.

Graph 6 - 3: US Gulf crack spread vs. WTI



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

The jet/kerosene crack spread strengthened slightly, supported by firm domestic consumption and export requirements. Tight global market conditions and a decline in US jet/kerosene stocks in October also supported regional prices, although relatively comfortable US national stock levels limited the supply pressure. The USGC jet/kerosene crack spread against WTI averaged $91.09/b, up $1.56/b, m-o-m, and $60.46/b, y-o-y.

The gasoil crack spread declined from the elevated levels registered in September. Expectations of additional diesel availability, including announced emergency stock releases, weighed on market sentiment. However, low distillate stocks in some regions in the US and continued export requirements provided support. The USGC gasoil crack spread against WTI averaged $66.59/b, down $12.57/b, m-o-m, but up $43.01/b, y-o-y.

At the bottom of the barrel, the fuel oil crack spread recovered sharply on a monthly average basis, although it remained negative. The improvement partly offset losses in gasoline and gasoil. However, further increases in US residual fuel oil stock levels in October and restricted arbitrage opportunities to Asia limited market

strength. The USGC HSFO crack spread against WTI averaged negative $2.97/b, up $13.04/b, m-o-m, but down $3.76/b, y-o-y.

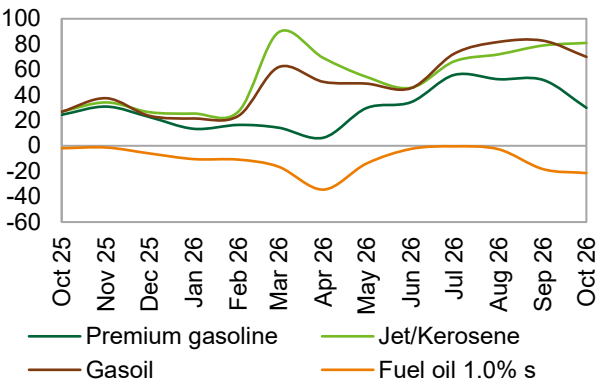
European market

The gasoline crack spread in Rotterdam declined in October, recording the largest loss across the barrel. Seasonal demand softness, winter-grade production and lower export requirements weighed on the market. Although low ARA gasoline inventories provided some support, they were insufficient to offset the downward pressures. The Rotterdam gasoline crack spread against Brent averaged $30.03/b, down $21.88/b, m-o-m, but up $5.49/b, y-o-y.

The jet/kerosene crack spread increased, supported by low ARA stocks and constrained regional availability during refinery maintenance. Jet/kerosene strengthened while gasoil weakened, widening the difference between the two product cracks. However, import arrivals and the seasonal slowdown in aviation demand moderated market strength towards the end of the month. The Rotterdam jet/kerosene crack spread against Brent averaged $80.96/b, up $1.98/b, m-o-m, and $53.90/b, y-o-y.

The gasoil crack spread declined sharply, as stronger imports and announced emergency stock releases eased supply concerns. Increased arrivals from India helped improve regional availability. Nevertheless, continued uncertainty over supplies from Eastern Europe and the Middle East, along with lower regional refinery throughput, provided some support. The Rotterdam gasoil crack spread against Brent averaged $69.97/b, down $12.71/b, m-o-m, but up $43.27/b, y-o-y.

Graph 6 - 4: Rotterdam crack spreads vs. Brent



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

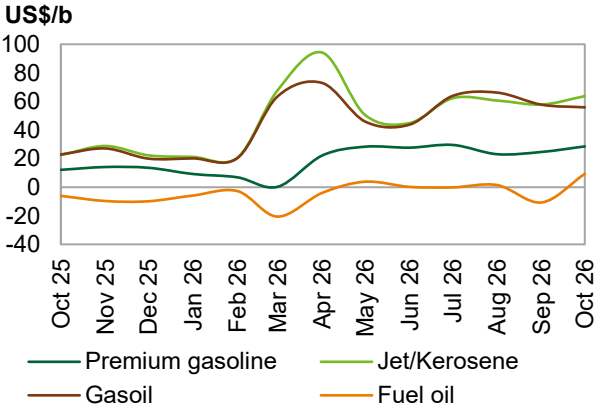
Fuel oil performance was mixed. HSFO cracks improved marginally, although restricted eastbound arbitrage opportunities and ample supplies in Western markets limited gains. Low-sulphur fuel oil weakened alongside softer diesel and vacuum gasoil markets. The Rotterdam HSFO crack spread against Brent averaged negative $29.64/b, up $0.76/b, m-o-m, but down $26.39/b, y-o-y. The fuel oil 1% sulphur crack spread averaged negative $21.35/b, down $3.06/b, m-o-m, and $19.53/b, y-o-y.

Asian market

The Singapore gasoline crack spread strengthened on a monthly average basis in October, although the market softened later in the month. Uncertainty surrounding Chinese export availability, buying interest from Indonesia and constrained Middle Eastern supplies supported prices in the first half of the month. Increased regional offers subsequently eased prompt supply concerns later in the month. The Singapore gasoline crack spread against Dubai averaged $28.61/b, up $3.86/b, m-o-m, and $16.35/b, y-o-y.

The jet/kerosene crack spread strengthened, supported by regional refinery outages and kerosene buying ahead of the winter heating season. Precautionary stock building and supply constraints provided additional support to prompt requirements. However, comfortable stock levels in parts of Northeast Asia and increased export availability limited gains towards the end of the month. The Singapore jet/kerosene crack spread against Dubai averaged $63.77/b, up $5.87, m-o-m, and $41.19/b, y-o-y.

Graph 6 - 5: Singapore crack spreads vs. Dubai



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

The gasoil crack spread declined as increased regional offers and limited arbitrage opportunities weighed on the market. High freight costs restricted shipments to the Atlantic Basin, limiting an outlet for Asian supplies. Nevertheless, uncertainty over export availability East of Suez provided some support. The Singapore gasoil crack spread against Dubai averaged $55.97/b, down $1.83, m-o-m, but up $32.98/b, y-o-y.

Table 6 - 3: Short-term prospects for product markets and refinery operations

Event	Time frame	Observations	Asia	Europe	US
Autumn refinery maintenance season	Nov 26	Refinery product output is expected to decline amid refinery turnarounds. This could lead to a contraction in product balances.	↑ Support for product crack spreads	↑ Support for product crack spreads	↑ Support for product crack spreads
Diesel releases from G7 countries	Nov 26–Jan 27	The release of a large volume of diesel from strategic reserves would weigh on middle distillate prices, specifically in Europe.	↓ Pressure on gasoline cracks	↓ Pressure on gasoline cracks	↓ Pressure on gasoline cracks
Refinery outages in Eastern Europe	4Q26	Ongoing unplanned refinery outages in Eastern Europe are expected to keep the product markets tight, specifically for middle distillates.	↑ Upward pressure on product crack spreads	↑ Upward pressure on product crack spreads	↑ Upward pressure on product crack spreads
Impact of the 2025 and 2026 refinery closures	2026	Approximately 1.1 mb/d of global refining capacity closures in 2025 and 138 tb/d of US refinery closures in 2026 are contributing to reduced product balances, especially during the maintenance season in late 3Q26 and 4Q26.	↑ Support for product markets	↑ Support for product markets	↑ Support for product markets
Impact of the 2025 and 2026 refinery capacity expansions	2026–2027	New product volumes entering international markets amid refinery capacity additions (1.2 mb/d in 2025 and 830 tb/d in 2026) are expected to enhance product balances, especially in 4Q26 and 2027.	↓ Pressure on product markets	↓ Pressure on product markets	↓ Pressure on product markets
Impact of increases in feedstock freight costs	4Q26	High tanker freight rates are expected to increase delivered feedstock costs, putting downward pressure on refining margins, particularly for import-dependent refiners in Asia and Europe.	↓ Pressure on product markets	↓ Pressure on product markets	↓ Pressure on product markets
China's fourth batch of refined products export quotas	Nov 26–Dec 26	4th Chinese export quotas could increase gasoline, diesel and jet fuel availability, weighing on Asian crack spreads and easing supply tightness elsewhere.	↓ Pressure on product markets	↓ Pressure on product markets	↓ Pressure on product markets

Source: OPEC.

Table 6 - 4: Refined product prices, US$/b

		Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct/Sep	Annual avg. 2025	Year-to-date 2026
US Gulf (Cargoes FOB)						
Naphtha*		99.03	99.03	0.00	63.91	88.36
Premium gasoline	(unleaded 93)	172.03	164.00	-8.03	93.01	138.00
Regular gasoline	(unleaded 87)	152.18	137.93	-14.25	84.97	123.62
Jet/Kerosene		185.91	188.77	2.86	89.46	147.70
Gasoil	(0.2% S)	175.54	164.27	-11.27	84.74	136.32
Fuel oil	(3.0% S)	77.70	84.24	6.54	62.27	74.19
Rotterdam (Barges FOB)						
Naphtha		93.65	102.65	9.00	62.64	85.48
Premium gasoline	(unleaded 98)	168.80	154.97	-13.83	90.08	127.86
Jet/Kerosene		195.87	205.90	10.03	91.34	158.25
Gasoil/Diesel	(10 ppm)	199.57	194.91	-4.66	91.98	153.11
Fuel oil	(1.0% S)	98.60	103.59	4.99	68.85	84.22
Fuel oil	(3.5% S)	86.49	95.30	8.81	63.54	80.45
Mediterranean (Cargoes FOB)						
Naphtha		91.48	96.75	5.27	60.81	81.79
Premium gasoline**		160.24	146.59	-13.65	84.16	122.51
Jet/Kerosene		192.44	196.10	3.66	88.32	154.01
Diesel		200.99	192.75	-8.24	90.87	152.84
Fuel oil	(1.0% S)	104.27	110.13	5.86	72.66	90.17
Fuel oil	(3.5% S)	85.17	93.98	8.81	61.75	79.45
Singapore (Cargoes FOB)						
Naphtha		97.49	106.00	8.51	64.73	92.41
Premium gasoline	(unleaded 95)	140.98	142.52	1.54	80.73	117.03
Regular gasoline	(unleaded 92)	136.15	139.40	3.25	78.83	113.38
Jet/Kerosene		169.30	174.56	5.26	86.48	147.69
Gasoil/Diesel	(50 ppm)	177.06	172.20	-4.86	87.38	148.05
Fuel oil	(180 cst)	163.35	161.66	-1.69	86.03	139.74
Fuel oil	(380 cst 3.5% S)	100.83	120.24	19.41	64.21	90.44

*Note: * Barges. ** Cost, insurance and freight (CIF).*

Sources: Argus and OPEC.

Tanker Market

Dirty tanker spot freight rates surged in October, with record VLCC rates driving Suezmax and Aframax rates higher. The return of disrupted volumes, ongoing trade dislocations, export inefficiencies and longer voyages kept tanker availability constrained. VLCC rates stood at more than ten-times year-ago levels. On the Middle East-to-East route, VLCC spot freight rates rose 26%, m-o-m, in October, while rates on the West Africa-to-East route increased 56%, m-o-m, building on sharply higher gains the month before.

Suezmax spot freight rates experienced the largest increase, m-o-m, of the three major vessel classes. On the USGC-to-Europe route, Suezmax rates rose 139%, m-o-m. Compared to the same period last year, spot freight rates were seven times higher. Aframax rates rose further in October, although to a lesser degree than the larger classes. On the Cross-Med route, Aframax spot freight rates gained 67%, m-o-m, more than four times higher compared to year ago levels.

The clean tanker market began to see some pressure from the high rates on the crude transport side. On average, clean rates rose 51%, m-o-m, with West of Suez rates catching to the gains seen last month in the East of Suez.

Dirty tanker freight rates

Very large crude carriers (VLCC)

VLCC spot freight rates were the key drive of the tanker market in October, with record high rates pressuring Suezmax, Aframax and even the clean tanker market. On average, VLCC spot freight rates increased 33%, m-o-m, and were up 920%, or more than ten times higher, y-o-y.

On the Middle East-to-East route, spot freight rates averaged WS1,213 in October. This represents a m-o-m increase of 26% and more than thirteen times higher than the same month last year. On the Middle East-to-West route, spot freight rates averaged WS550. This represents an increase of 25%, m-o-m, while y-o-y rates were almost ten times higher, y-o-y.

Rates on the West Africa-to-East route saw the biggest jump among VLCC routes in October, with an increase of 56% over the previous month to reach WS656. Compared to the previous year, rates were more than seven times higher.

Table 7 - 1: Dirty VLCC spot tanker freight rates, Worldscale (WS)

VLCC	Size *1,000 DWT*	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	*Change* Oct 26/Sep 26
Middle East/East	230-280	512	962	1213	251
Middle East/West	270-285	235	440	550	110
West Africa/East	260	174	421	656	235

Sources: Argus and OPEC.

Suezmax

Suezmax rates experienced the largest increase in October, as record high VLCC rates made switching to smaller vessels economically attractive. On average, Suez spot freight rates increased 132%, m-o-m. Compared with the same month last year, Suezmax rates were about seven times higher.

Table 7 - 2: Dirty Suezmax spot tanker freight rates, WS

Suezmax	Size *1,000 DWT*	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	*Change* Oct 26/Sep 26
West Africa/US Gulf Coast	130-135	243	373	845	472
US Gulf Coast/Europe	150	205	313	749	436

Sources: Argus and OPEC.

On the West Africa-to-USGC route, spot freight rates averaged WS845 in October, representing an increase of 127%, m-o-m. Compared with year-ago levels, rates were more than seven time higher. Rates on the USGC-to-Europe route averaged WS749, reflecting a 139% increase over the previous month. Y-o-y, rates were seven times higher.

Aframax

Aframax spot freight rates were less pressure than the higher vessel classes. Rates in October were just off record levels seen earlier this year. On average, rates increased 91%, m-o-m. Compared with the same month in 2025, Aframax rates were more than four times higher.

Spot freight rates on the Indonesia-to-East route increased by 141%, m-o-m, to average WS740. Y-o-y, rates on the route were five times higher. Rates on the Caribbean-to-US East Coast (USEC) route increased by 94%, m-o-m, to average W808. Compared with the same month last year, rates were up by over 400%.

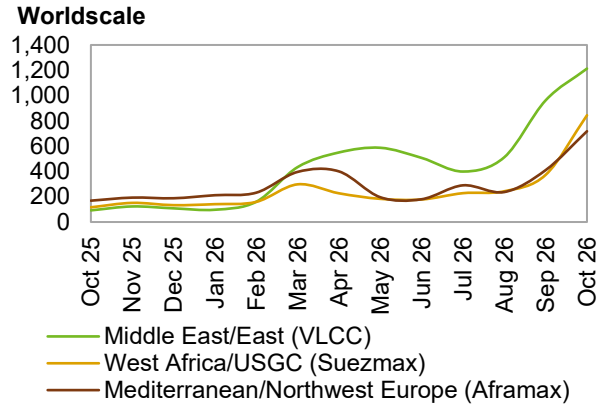
Table 7 - 3: Dirty Aframax spot tanker freight rates, WS

Aframax	Size *1,000 DWT*	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	*Change* Oct 26/Sep 26
Indonesia/East	80-85	189	307	740	433
Caribbean/US East Coast	80-85	334	416	808	392
Mediterranean/Mediterranean	80-85	242	452	756	304
Mediterranean/Northwest Europe	80-85	238	411	718	307

Sources: Argus and OPEC.

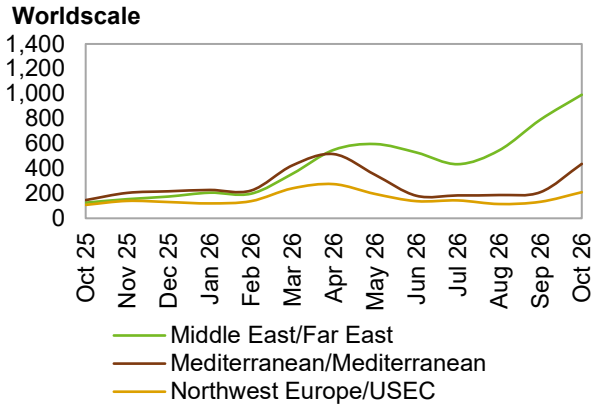
Cross-Med rates increased 67%, m-o-m, to average WS756 in October. Rates on the Med-to-Northwest Europe (NWE) route increased by 75%, m-o-m, to average WS718. Compared with the same month in 2025, rates were over four times higher on both routes.

Graph 7 - 1: Crude oil spot tanker freight rates, monthly average



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

Graph 7 - 2: Products spot tanker freight rates, monthly average



Sources: Argus and OPEC.

Clean tanker freight rates

The clean tanker market began to see some pressure from the exceptionally high rates in the dirty market in October. Availability was reduced as some product tankers moved over to the crude market due to the higher rates. Product trade has yet to see a return of disrupted Middle East volumes similar to that on the crude side. In October, West of Suez spot freight rates increased 95%, m-o-m, on average, and were up 168% compared to the same month last year. East of Suez spot rates rose 30%, m-o-m, building on the sharp increase seen in the previous month and were six-times higher, y-o-y.

Rates on the Middle East-to-East route were assessed at WS991, representing a gain of 25%, m-o-m. Compared with October 2025, rates were almost eight times higher. Clean spot freight rates on the Singapore-to-East route increased 40%, m-o-m, to average WS550. Y-o-y, rates on the route were about four times higher.

Rates on the NWE-to-USEC route increased 58%, m-o-m, to average WS208. This represents a 94% gain from the same month last year. Rates on the Cross-Med and Med-to-NWE routes doubled, m-o-m, to average WS434 and WS444, respectively. Y-o-y, spot freight rates on both routes more than tripled compared to the same month last year.

Table 7 - 4: Clean spot tanker freight rates, WS

East of Suez	Size *1,000 DWT*	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	*Change* Oct 26/Sep 26
Middle East/East	30-35	545	792	991	199
Singapore/East	30-35	223	392	550	158
West of Suez					
Northwest Europe/US East Coast	33-37	114	132	208	76
Mediterranean/Mediterranean	30-35	186	209	434	225
Mediterranean/Northwest Europe	30-35	196	219	444	225

Sources: Argus and OPEC.

Crude and Refined Products Trade

US crude imports followed seasonal patterns, declining in October to average 6.1 mb/d. US crude exports began to pick up, averaging 4.3 mb/d, supported by higher flows to Japan. Product exports declined from high levels as distillate fuel oil outflows fell.

Preliminary estimates for September show crude imports into OECD Europe returned to the five-year range due to decreased flows via the Suez Canal, while crude exports held steady. Product imports remained well below the five-year range, despite a strong jump in diesel inflows.

Japan's crude imports fell sharply in September amid renewed disruptions to trade flows, averaging 1.9 mb/d compared with 2.5 mb/d the month before. Product exports declined despite a jump in gasoil exports, but were still close to the five-year average.

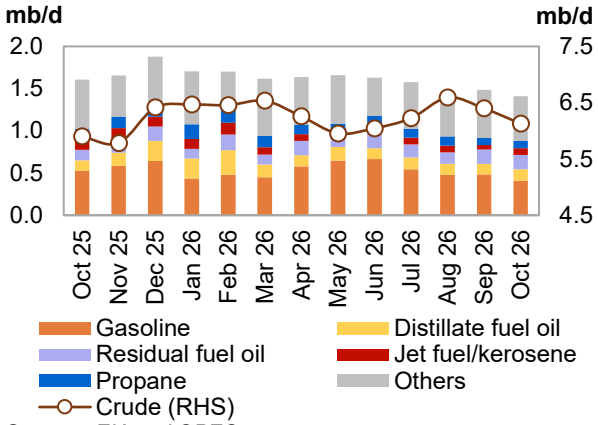
In China, crude imports averaged 9.1 mb/d in September, slightly higher m-o-m. Product exports surged, boosted by strong diesel and fuel oil exports. Regional tightness in both products and fresh export quotas supported higher outflows.

Crude imports into India reached a record 5.4 mb/d in September as refiners saw strong domestic and international demand for their products. Product exports increased, with higher outflows of diesel and other products driving the gains.

US

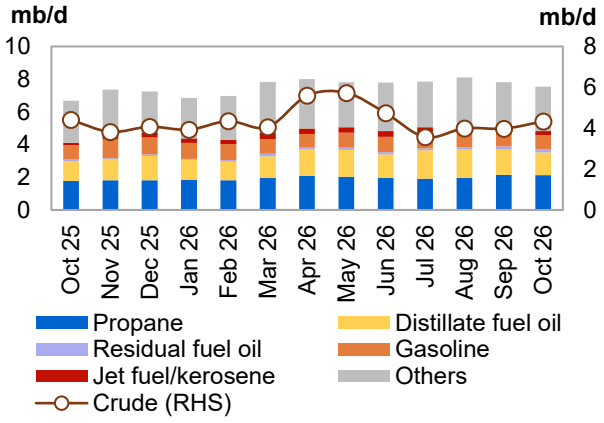
US crude imports declined for the second month in a row in October, according to preliminary weekly EIA data. Lower volumes from Brazil and Venezuela drove the decline, partly offset by higher inflows from Canada. Compared with the previous month, US crude imports fell by 269 tb/d, or 4%, m-o-m, but increased by. On a 230 tb/d, or almost 4%, y-o-y.

Graph 8 - 1: US imports of crude and products



Sources: EIA and OPEC.

Graph 8 - 2: US exports of crude and products



Sources: EIA and OPEC.

US crude exports picked up in October, averaging 4.3 mb/d. Gains were driven by higher flows to Japan and eastern Canada. Compared with the same month last year, US crude oil exports were down about 71 tb/d, or around 2%.

As a result, US net crude imports in October averaged around 1.8 mb/d, compared with 2.4 mb/d the month before and 1.5 mb/d in October 2025.

In the oil products trade, US imports remained soft in October, averaging 1.4 mb/d. M-o-m, product inflows fell by 75 tb/d, or about 5%. Distillate fuel oil and jet fuel inflows edged up, m-o-m, but these gains were more than offset by a larger decline in gasoline imports. Compared with the same month a year earlier, product inflows were 195 tb/d, or 12%, lower.

Product exports remained at elevated levels in October, despite a decline of 286 tb/d, m-o-m. On average, product outflows averaged 7.5 mb/d for the month. The m-o-m decline reflected lower distillate fuel oil exports. Compared with October 2025, product exports were still 863 tb/d, or almost 13%, higher.

As a result, net product exports averaged close to 6.1 mb/d in October, compared with 6.3 mb/d in September. A year earlier, net product exports averaged 5 mb/d. Combined net crude and product exports averaged almost 4.3 mb/d in October, compared with 3.9 mb/d the month before. In the same month last year, net crude and product exports averaged 3.6 mb/d.

Table 8 - 1: US crude and product net imports, mb/d

US	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct 26/Sep 26
Crude oil	2.60	2.42	1.80	-0.62
Total products	-6.67	-6.34	-6.13	0.21
Total crude and products	**-4.06**	**-3.92**	**-4.33**	**-0.41**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.
Sources: EIA and OPEC.

OECD Europe

Estimates based on tanker-tracking data for September indicate that crude imports into OECD Europe returned to the five-year range due to decreased flows via the Suez Canal, while crude exports held steady. Product imports remained well below the five-year range, despite a strong jump in diesel inflows. Product exports rose, m-o-m, as shipments of feedstocks to the US and naphtha to South Korea increased.

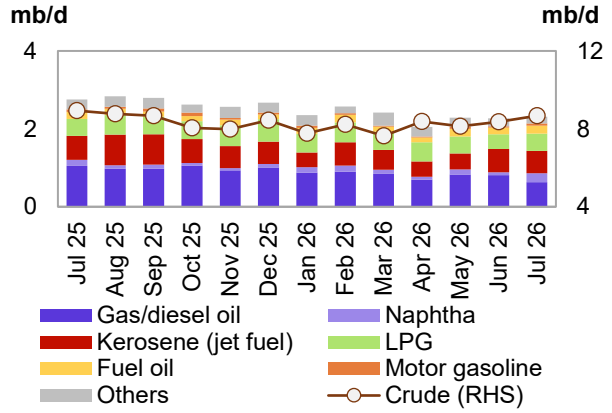
The latest available official data for OECD Europe shows that crude imports into the region in July averaged 8.6 mb/d. This represented an increase of 299 tb/d, or almost 4%, m-o-m. However, crude imports were down by 445 tb/d, or 16%, compared with the same month last year.

The US was the top crude supplier from outside the region, providing around 1.5 mb/d in July, down from 2.2 mb/d the month before. Kazakhstan was second with 1.2 mb/d.

Crude exports from OECD Europe averaged 28 tb/d in July, compared with 22 tb/d the month before and 97 tb/d in July 2025.

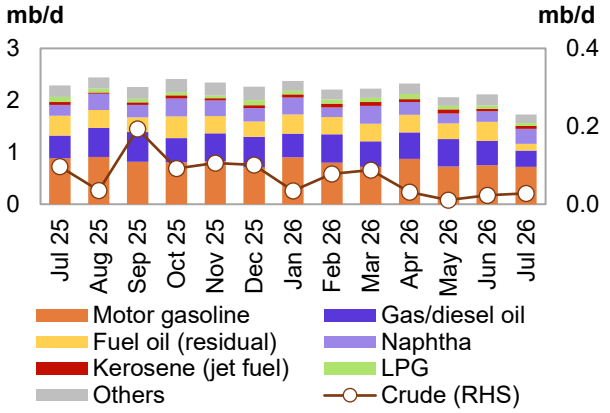
Net crude imports averaged 8.6 mb/d in July, compared with 8.4 mb/d a month earlier and 8.8 mb/d in July 2025.

Graph 8 - 3: OECD Europe's imports of crude and products



Sources: IEA and OPEC.

Graph 8 - 4: OECD Europe's exports of crude and products



Sources: IEA and OPEC.

Product imports averaged 2.3 mb/d in July, representing a marginal increase of 37 tb/d, or less than 2%, m-o-m. Y-o-y, product inflows fell by 445 tb/d, or 16%.

Product exports fell by 386 tb/d, or around 18%, m-o-m, in July to average 1.7 mb/d. Compared with July 2025, product exports were down by 558 tb/d, or 24%.

As a result, net product imports stood at 583 tb/d in July, compared with 160 tb/d a month earlier and 470 tb/d in July 2025. Combined net crude and product imports averaged 9.2 mb/d in July 2026, compared with 8.5 mb/d a month earlier and 9.3 mb/d a year ago.

Table 8 - 2: OECD Europe's crude and product net imports, mb/d

OECD Europe	May 26	Jun 26	Jul 26	Change Jul 26/Jun 26
Crude oil	8.13	8.35	8.64	0.29
Total products	0.23	0.16	0.58	0.42
Total crude and products	**8.36**	**8.51**	**9.23**	**0.72**

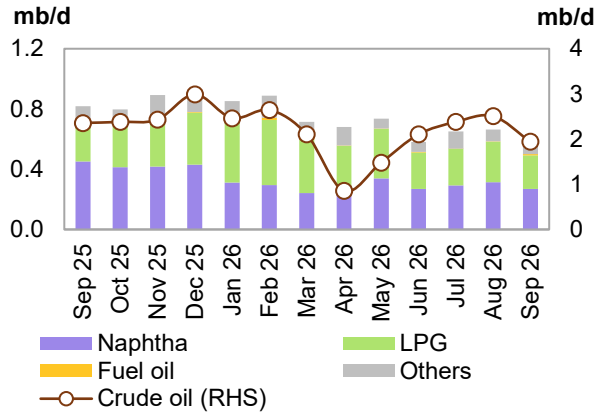
Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

Sources: IEA and OPEC.

Japan

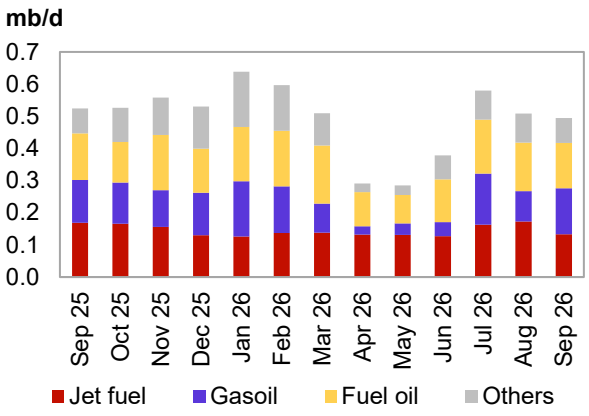
Japan's crude imports fell sharply in September amid renewed disruptions to trade flows. Inflows averaged 1.9 mb/d, representing a decline of 568 tb/d, or about 23%, m-o-m. The UAE regained its position as the top supplier in September with a share of 49%, compared with 25% the previous month. The US was second with 28%, followed by Saudi Arabia with 14%. Y-o-y, crude imports were down by 416 tb/d, or almost 18%.

Graph 8 - 5: Japan's imports of crude and products



Sources: METI and OPEC.

Graph 8 - 6: Japan's exports of products



Sources: METI and OPEC.

Japan's product imports fell by 57 tb/d, or about 9%, m-o-m, om September to average 607 tb/d. Lower inflows of LPG and naphtha outweighed higher gasoline imports. Compared with September 2025, product imports fell by 211 tb/d, or about 26%.

Product exports, including LPG, slipped for the second month in a row. Outflows averaged 494 tb/d. Lower outflows of jet fuel and gasoline more than offset the recovery in gasoil exports. M-o-m, product outflows edged down by 14 tb/d, or 3%. Compared with September 2025, product exports were 32 tb/d, or 6%, lower.

As a result, Japan's net product imports, including LPG, averaged 112 tb/d in September, compared with 156 tb/d in the previous month and 293 tb/d a year earlier.

Table 8 - 3: Japan's crude and product net imports, mb/d

Japan	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	Change Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	2.38	2.51	1.94	-0.57
Total products	0.07	0.16	0.11	-0.04
Total crude and products	**2.45**	**2.66**	**2.05**	**-0.61**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

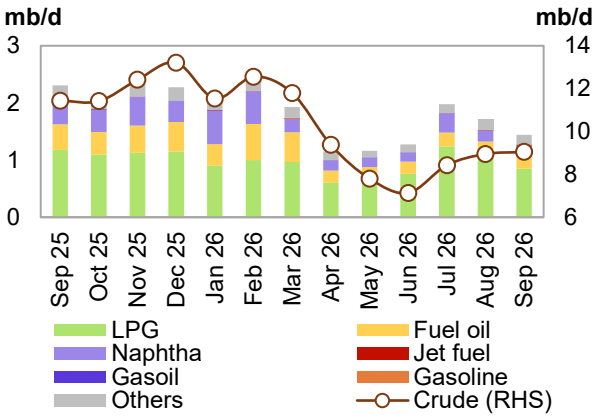
Sources: METI and OPEC.

China

China's crude imports increased further in September as refinery runs held steady and inventories fell. Inflows edged up by 95 tb/d, or just over 1%, m-o-m, to average 9.1 mb/d. Russia remained the top crude supplier with a 28% share, down from almost 30% the month before, followed by Brazil with 14% and Iraq with 13%. Compared with the same month in 2025, China's crude imports were still down by 2.4 mb/d, or about 21%.

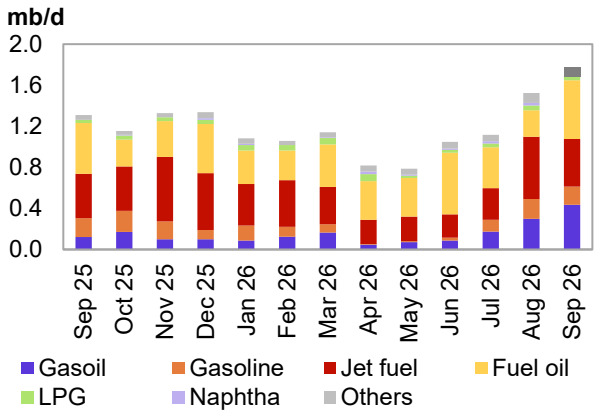
Product imports, including LPG, averaged 1.4 mb/d in September, reflecting a m-o-m decline of 277 tb/d, or almost 16%. LPG and naphtha imports led the decline, falling below year-ago levels. Y-o-y, product imports were down by 870 tb/d, or almost 40%.

Graph 8 - 7: China's imports of crude and total products



Sources: GACC and OPEC.

Graph 8 - 8: China's exports of total products



Sources: GACC and OPEC.

China's product exports, including LPG, averaged 1.8 mb/d in September. This represented an increase of 257 tb/d, or around 17%, m-o-m. Diesel exports surged amid tight supplies in the global market and fresh export quotas. Fuel oil exports also increased amid regional tightness. Compared with the same month last year, product outflows were 471 tb/d, or 36%, higher.

Table 8 - 4: China's crude and product net imports, mb/d

China	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	*Change* Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	8.38	8.89	9.04	0.15
Total products	0.86	0.19	-0.34	-0.53
Total crude and products	**9.24**	**9.09**	**8.70**	**-0.38**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

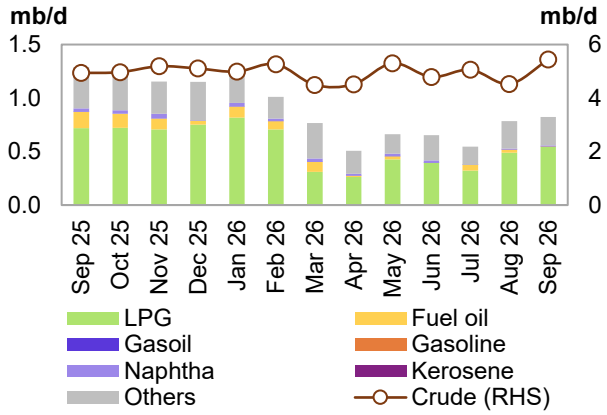
Sources: GACC and OPEC.

India

India crude imports surged to a record in September, supported by continued strength in refinery runs. Crude imports averaged 5.4 mb/d for the month, representing a 912 tb/d, or 20%, jump in inflows, m-o-m. Russia was the top crude supplier with a share of 35% in September, down from 45% the month before, followed by Iraq and Saudi Arabia with 10% each.

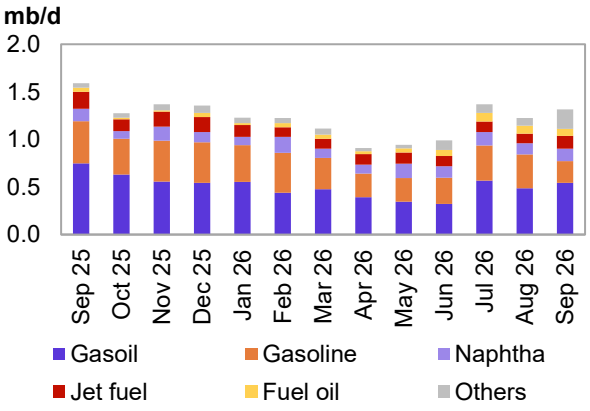
Compared with the same month last year, crude imports were 596 tb/d, or about 13% higher.

Graph 8 - 9: India's imports of crude and products



Sources: PPAC and OPEC.

Graph 8 - 10: India's exports of products



Sources: PPAC and OPEC.

India's product imports remained low in September, despite an increase of 38 tb/d, or about 5%, m-o-m. Product imports averaged 823 tb/d for the month. Higher LPG inflows more than offset a decline in fuel oil imports. Y-o-y, product imports were down by 466 tb/d, or 36%.

Product outflows rebounded to follow a more seasonal pattern in September. Exports averaged 1.3 mb/d for the month, representing a m-o-m increase of 91 tb/d, or around 7%. Y-o-y, India's product exports were still down by 277 tb/d, or 17%.

India's net product exports averaged 494 tb/d in September, compared with 442 tb/d in the previous month and 305 tb/d in the same month of 2025.

Table 8 - 5: India's crude and product net imports, mb/d

India	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	*Change* Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	5.05	4.52	5.43	0.91
Total products	-0.82	-0.44	-0.49	-0.05
Total crude and products	**4.23**	**4.08**	**4.94**	**0.86**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

India data table does not include information for crude import and product export by Reliance Industries.

Sources: PPAC and OPEC.

Eurasia

Total crude oil exports from Russia and Central Asia increased by 147 tb/d, or about 2%, m-o-m, to around 6.9 mb/d in September. Y-o-y, exports declined by 283 tb/d, or around 4%.

Flows through the Transneft system increased by 134 tb/d, or around 3%, m-o-m, in September, averaging 4.1 mb/d. Compared with the same month in 2025, crude outflows via the Transneft system were down by 144 tb/d, or over 3%. Flows from Transneft's Novorossiysk port on the Black Sea edged up by 17 tb/d, or around 4%, m-o-m. Outflows were down by 360 tb/d, or 44%, y-o-y. In the Baltic Sea, Transneft's crude flows showed stronger gains, up 112 tb/d, or more than 6%, m-o-m, to average close to close to 1.9 mb/d. Y-o-y, exports via the Baltic ports were 181 tb/d, or about 11%, higher. Within the Baltic, flows from Ust-Luga increased 60 tb/d, or 10%, to average 657 tb/d, up 102 tb/d, or 18%, from the same month in 2025. September exports from the port of Primorsk increased by 52 tb/d, or about 5%, m-o-m, to average 1.2 mb/d. This was 79 tb/d, or 7%, higher than in the same month last year.

Shipments via the Druzhba pipeline averaged 170 tb/d, up by 28 tb/d, m-o-m. This was 98 tb/d, or almost 37%, lower than in the same month last year.

Exports to inland China via the ESPO pipeline fell by 33 tb/d, or 5%, m-o-m, to average 589 tb/d. Flows on the pipeline were 36 tb/d, or about 7% higher, y-o-y. Exports from the Pacific port of Kozmino edged up by 10 tb/d, or 1%, m-o-m, to average 1 mb/d. Flows via the port were up 97 tb/d, or around 11%, from a year ago.

In the Lukoil system, exports via the Varandey offshore platform in the Barents Sea averaged 191 tb/d, representing an increase of 13 tb/d, or 22%, m-o-m, and a gain of 101 tb/d, compared with the same month last year.

In Russia's Far East, exports from Aniva Bay fell by 7 tb/d, or 12%, m-o-m, while flows via De Kastri edged down by 6 tb/d, or close to 3%, m-o-m. Combined, the two ports exported an average of 259 tb/d in September, a drop of 13 tb/d, or about 5%, y-o-y. Meanwhile, Central Asian exports averaged 231 tb/d for the month, around 6 tb/d, or 3%, lower, m-o-m, but marginally higher, y-o-y.

Crude flows via the CPC terminal at the port of Novorossiysk on the Black Sea rose in September, up 31 tb/d, or around 2%, m-o-m, to average 1.6 mb/d. This was 121 tb/d, or about 7%, lower, y-o-y.

Exports via the BTC pipeline fell 2 tb/d, or less than 1%, m-o-m, to average 540 tb/d. This was 37 tb/d, or about 7%, lower, y-o-y.

Total product exports from Russia and Central Asia fell 53 tb/d, or about 5%, m-o-m, to average around 1 mb/d. Lower exports of fuel oil and gasoil more than outweighed a 45 tb/d increase in naphtha exports. Y-o-y, total product exports were down around 1 mb/d, or about 49%, with declines in all major products, particularly gasoil.

Commercial Stock Movements

According to preliminary September 2026 data, OECD commercial oil inventories decreased by 14.6 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 2,811 mb. At this level, OECD commercial stocks were 57.3 mb lower, y-o-y, 4.5 mb above the latest five-year average, and 156.2 mb below the 2015–2019 average. Within the components, crude stocks increased by 0.1 mb, m-o-m, while product stocks decreased by 14.7 mb.

OECD commercial crude oil stocks stood at 1,353 mb in September. This is 23.8 mb higher, y-o-y, 29.7 mb above the latest five-year average and 82.1 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

OECD total product stocks stood at 1,458 mb in September. This is 81.1 mb lower, y-o-y, 25.2 mb below the latest five-year average and 74.1 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

In terms of days of forward cover, OECD commercial stocks decreased by 0.3 days, m-o-m, in September, to 60.3 days. This is 1.4 days lower, y-o-y, 0.2 days below the latest five-year average and 2.1 days below the 2015–2019 average.

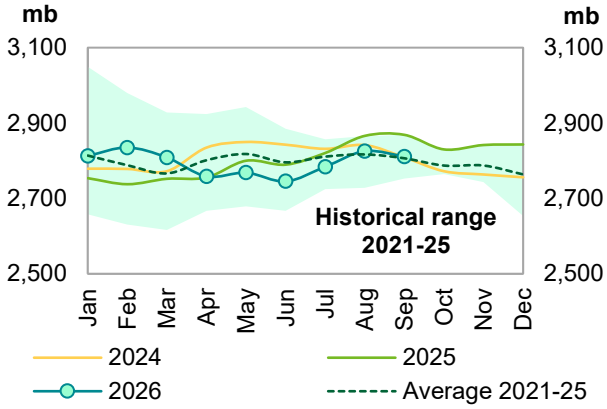
OECD

Preliminary September 2026 data show OECD commercial inventories decreased by 14.6 mb, m-o-m, to 2,811 mb. At this level, stocks were 57.3 mb below the same month last year, 4.5 mb above the latest five-year average and 156.2 mb below the 2015–2019 average. By component, crude stocks increased by 0.1 mb, while product stocks decreased by 14.7 mb, m-o-m.

Within the OECD regions, OECD Europe, OECD Americas and OECD Asia Pacific recorded stock draws in September, m-o-m.

Commercial crude stocks in OECD countries increased by 0.1 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 1,353.3 mb. This is 23.8 mb higher than a year earlier, 29.7 mb above the latest five-year average and 82.1 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Graph 9 - 1: OECD commercial oil stocks



Sources: EIA, IEA, METI, OilX and OPEC.

Within the OECD regions, crude stocks in OECD Americas and OECD Europe increased by 10.9 mb and 2.3 mb, m-o-m, respectively, while OECD Asia Pacific recorded a stock draw of 13.1 mb, m-o-m.

Total OECD product stocks decreased by 14.7 mb, m-o-m, to 1,458 mb. This is 81.1 mb lower than the same time a year ago, 25.2 mb below the latest five-year average and 74.1 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Within the OECD regions, product stocks in OECD Americas and OECD Europe decreased by 11.3 mb and 3.5 mb, m-o-m, respectively, while OECD Asia Pacific recorded a stock build of 0.1 mb, m-o-m.

Table 9 - 1: OECD commercial stocks, mb

OECD stocks	Sep 25	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	*Change* Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	1,330	1,338	1,353	1,353	*0.1*
Products	1,539	1,447	1,472	1,458	*-14.7*
Total	**2,868**	**2,784**	**2,826**	**2,811**	***-14.6***
Days of forward cover	**61.7**	**59.8**	**60.6**	**60.3**	***-0.3***

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

Sources: EIA, IEA, METI, OilX and OPEC.

In terms of days of forward cover, OECD commercial stocks decreased by 0.3 days, m-o-m, in September, to 60.3 days. This is 1.4 days lower than the same month in 2025, 0.2 days below the latest five-year average and 2.1 days below the 2015–2019 average.

Regionally, OECD Americas was 2.2 days below the latest five-year average, at 58.1 days. OECD Europe was 1.3 days above the latest five-year average, at 69.3 days. OECD Asia Pacific was 3.4 days above the latest five-year average, at 51.5 days.

OECD Americas

Total commercial stocks in OECD Americas decreased by 0.4 mb, m-o-m, in September, to settle at 1,514 mb. This is 47.1 mb lower than the same month in 2025, 12.8 mb below the latest five-year average and 52.2 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Commercial crude oil stocks in the OECD Americas increased by 10.9 mb, m-o-m, in September, to 749 mb. This is 7 mb higher than in September 2025, 7.9 mb above the latest five-year average and 23.9 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Total product stocks in OECD Americas decreased by 11.3 mb, m-o-m, to 765 mb in September. This is 54.1 mb lower than a year earlier, 20.7 mb below the latest five-year average and 28.3 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

OECD Europe

Total commercial stocks in OECD Europe decreased by 1.3 mb, m-o-m, in September, to settle at 930 mb. This is 19.6 mb lower than the same month in 2025, 8.9 mb above the latest five-year average and 47.3 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

OECD Europe's commercial crude stocks increased by 2.3 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 406 mb. This is 8.3 mb lower than one year earlier, 4 mb above the latest five-year average and 15.6 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Total product stocks in OECD Europe decreased by 3.5 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 524 mb. This is 11.3 mb lower than at the same time a year earlier, 4.9 mb above the latest five-year average and 31.7 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

OECD Asia Pacific

Total commercial oil stocks in OECD Pacific decreased by 13 mb, m-o-m, in September, to stand at 367 mb. This is 9.5 mb higher than at the same time a year earlier, 8.4 mb above the latest five-year average and 56.8 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Crude stocks in OECD Asia Pacific decreased by 13.1 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 198 mb. This is 25.1 mb higher than in the same month a year earlier, 17.8 mb above the latest five-year average and 42.6 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

Product stocks in OECD Asia Pacific increased by 0.1 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 169 mb. This is 15.6 mb lower than one year earlier, 9.4 mb below the latest five-year average and 14.2 mb below the 2015–2019 average.

US

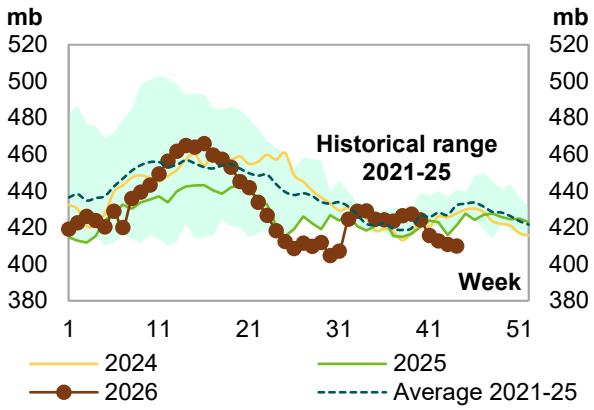
Preliminary data for October 2026 show that total US commercial oil stocks decreased by 39.9 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 1,204 mb. This is 69.6 mb, or 5.5%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 49.6 mb, or 4%, below the latest five-year average. Crude stocks decreased by 17.6 mb, m-o-m, while product stocks decreased by 22.4 mb, m-o-m.

Commercial crude stocks in the US in October stood at 410 mb. This is 11.2 mb, or 2.7%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 19.6 mb, or 4.6%, below the latest five-year average. The monthly draw in crude oil stocks was driven by an increase in exports despite a slowdown in refinery activity.

Total product stocks decreased by 22.4 mb in October, m-o-m, to 795 mb. This is 58.3 mb, or 6.8%, lower than at the same time last year and 30 mb, or 3.6%, below the latest five-year average.

Gasoline stocks increased in October by 4.6 mb, m-o-m, to settle at 209 mb. This is 0.5 mb, or 0.2%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 4.6 mb, or 2.2%, below the latest five-year average.

Graph 9 - 2: US weekly commercial crude oil inventories



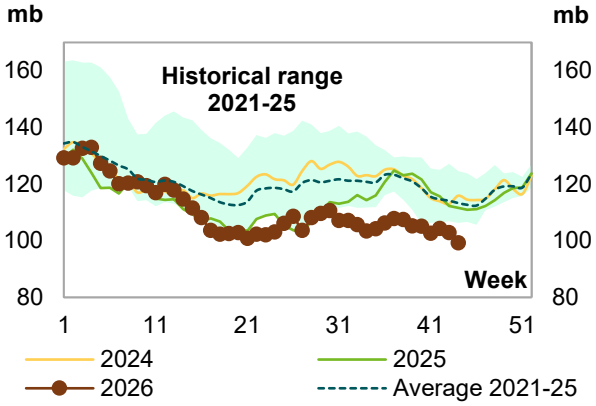
Sources: EIA and OPEC.

Distillate stocks decreased by 5.9 mb, m-o-m, to 99 mb. This is 13 mb, or 11.5%, lower than the same month a year earlier and 17.2 mb, or 14.8%, below the latest five-year average.

Residual fuel oil stocks increased by 1 mb, m-o-m. At 24 mb, they were 2.7 mb, or 12.3%, higher than last year's level, but 1.9 mb, or 7.4%, below the latest five-year average.

Jet fuel stocks decreased by 1.8 mb, m-o-m, ending October at 42 mb. This is 0.1 mb, or 0.2%, higher than the same month in 2025 and 1.5 mb, or 3.6%, above the latest five-year average.

Graph 9 - 3: US weekly distillate inventories



Sources: EIA and OPEC.

Table 9 - 2: US commercial petroleum stocks, mb

US stocks	Oct 25	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	*Change* Oct 26/Sep 26
Crude oil	**421.0**	**416.4**	**427.3**	**409.8**	***-17.6***
Gasoline	209.4	209.3	204.4	209.0	*4.6*
Distillate fuel	112.2	106.4	105.2	99.3	*-5.9*
Residual fuel oil	21.8	22.3	23.4	24.4	*1.0*
Jet fuel	41.7	46.7	43.6	41.8	*-1.8*
Total products	**852.9**	**828.3**	**817.0**	**794.6**	***-22.4***
Total	**1,273.9**	**1,244.7**	**1,244.3**	**1,204.4**	***-39.9***
SPR	**409.6**	**285.6**	**283.8**	**282.2**	***-1.6***

Sources: EIA and OPEC.

Japan

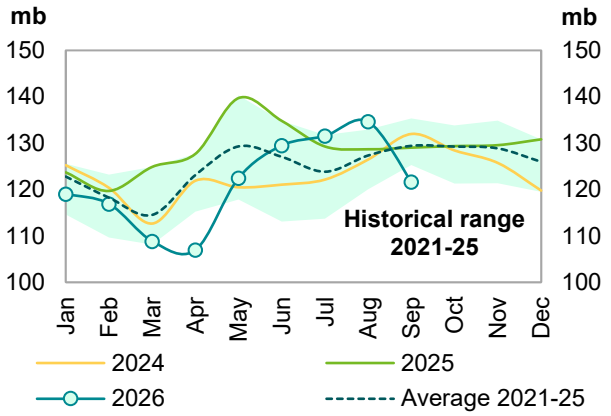
In Japan, total commercial oil stocks in September 2026 decreased by 13 mb, m-o-m, to 122 mb. This is 7.4 mb, or 5.8%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 7.8 mb, or 6.1%, below the latest five-year average. Crude stocks decreased by 13.1 mb, while product stocks increased by 0.1 mb, m-o-m.

Japanese commercial crude oil stocks decreased by 13.1 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 64.7 mb. This is 1.8 mb, or 2.7%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 2.9 mb, or 4.4%, below the latest five-year average.

Total Japanese product stocks increased by 0.1 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 57 mb. This is 5.6 mb, or 9%, below the same month in 2025, and 4.9 mb, or 7.9%, below the latest five-year average.

Gasoline stocks increased in September by 1 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 10 mb. This is unchanged from the level recorded a year earlier and 0.2 mb, or 2.1%, above the latest five-year average. The build in gasoline stocks was driven by an increase in imports.

Graph 9 - 4: Japan's commercial oil stocks



Sources: METI and OPEC.

Middle distillate stocks remained broadly unchanged, m-o-m, at 27 mb in September. This is 4.4 mb, or 13.7%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 2.8 mb, or 9.2%, below the latest five-year average. Among distillate components, jet fuel oil stocks increased by 8.2%, kerosene stocks increased by 7.7%, and gasoil stocks decreased by 15.6%, m-o-m.

Total residual fuel oil stocks decreased by 0.2 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 11.3 mb. At this level, they were 0.3 mb, or 2.3%, lower than the same month a year ago and 0.9 mb, or 7.7%, below the latest five-year average. Within the components, fuel oil A stocks were down by 6% while fuel oil B.C stocks were up by 1.3%, m-o-m.

Table 9 - 3: Japan's commercial oil stocks*, mb

Japan's stocks	Sep 25	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	*Change* Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	**66.5**	**72.2**	**77.8**	**64.7**	***-13.1***
Gasoline	10.3	10.8	9.3	10.3	*1.0*
Naphtha	8.9	9.4	8.5	7.9	*-0.6*
Middle distillates	31.8	27.2	27.5	27.4	*0.0*
Residual fuel oil	11.6	11.9	11.5	11.3	*-0.2*
Total products	**62.5**	**59.3**	**56.8**	**56.9**	***0.1***
Total**	**129.0**	**131.5**	**134.6**	**121.6**	***-13.0***

*Note: * At the end of the month. ** Includes crude oil and main products only.*

Sources: METI and OPEC.

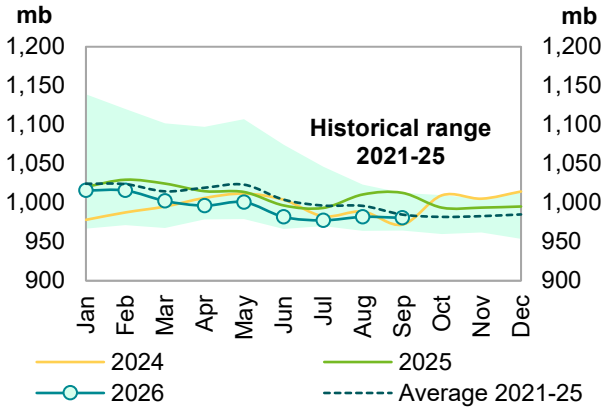
EU-14 plus the UK and Norway

Preliminary data for September 2026 show that total European oil stocks decreased by 1.3 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 981 mb. At this level, they were 32 mb, or 3.2%, lower than the same month in 2025, and 4.1 mb, or 0.4%, below the latest five-year average. Crude stocks increased by 2.3 mb, m-o-m, while product stocks decreased by 3.5 mb, m-o-m.

European crude stocks stood at 423 mb in September. This is 11 mb, or 2.5%, lower than the same month in 2025, and 21.4 mb, or 5.3%, above the latest five-year average. The increase in crude oil stocks aligned with a 0.4 mb/d decrease in refinery throughput.

Total European product stocks decreased by 3.5 mb, m-o-m, to end September at 557 mb. This is 21 mb, or 3.6%, lower than the same month in 2025, and 25.6 mb, or 4.4%, below the latest five-year average.

Graph 9 - 5: EU-14 plus the UK and Norway total oil stocks



Sources: OilX and OPEC.

Gasoline stocks increased in September by 0.6 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 105 mb. This is 1.3 mb, or 1.2%, lower than at the same time in 2025 and 0.6 mb, or 0.6%, above the latest five-year average.

Middle distillate stocks decreased in September by 2.2 mb, m-o-m, to 372 mb. This is 8.8 mb, or 2.3%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 17.6 mb, or 4.5%, below the latest five-year average.

Residual fuel stocks decreased by 0.6 mb, m-o-m, in September, to 52 mb. This is 10.1 mb, or 16.3%, lower than the same month in 2025, and 7.4 mb, or 12.5%, below the latest five-year average.

Naphtha stocks decreased by 1.4 mb, m-o-m, in September, ending the month at 28 mb. This is 0.9 mb, or 3%, lower than the same month in 2025, and 1.1 mb, or 3.9%, below the latest five-year average.

Table 9 - 4: EU-14 plus UK and Norway's total oil stocks, mb

EU stocks	Sep 25	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	*Change* Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	**434.4**	**425.6**	**421.1**	**423.4**	***2.3***
Gasoline	106.5	103.9	104.6	105.2	*0.6*
Naphtha	28.7	29.1	29.2	27.9	*-1.4*
Middle distillates	380.9	367.6	374.3	372.1	*-2.2*
Fuel oils	62.1	51.2	52.6	52.0	*-0.6*
Total products	**578.2**	**551.8**	**560.7**	**557.2**	***-3.5***
Total	**1,012.5**	**977.4**	**981.8**	**980.6**	***-1.3***

Sources: OilX and OPEC.

Singapore, Amsterdam-Rotterdam-Antwerp (ARA) and Fujairah

Singapore

In September, total product stocks in Singapore decreased by 1.1 mb, m-o-m, to 38 mb. This is 9.6 mb, or 20.2%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 5.7 mb, or 13.1%, below the latest five-year average.

Light distillate stocks decreased by 0.4 mb, m-o-m, in September, to 11 mb. This is 3.1 mb, or 22.5%, lower than the same month a year earlier and 3.3 mb, or 24%, below the latest five-year average.

Middle distillate stocks increased by 0.7 mb, m-o-m, in September, to 9 mb. This is 1 mb, or 9.8%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 0.8 mb, or 7.9%, below the latest five-year average.

Fuel oil stocks decreased by 1.4 mb, m-o-m, ending September at 19 mb. This is 5.6 mb, or 23.1%, lower than a year ago and 1.7 mb, or 8.2%, below the latest five-year average.

ARA

Total product stocks in ARA in September increased by 0.9 mb, m-o-m. At 33 mb, they were 12.9 mb, or 28%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 9.6 mb, or 22.4%, below the latest five-year average.

Gasoline stocks increased by 0.7 mb, m-o-m, ending September at 8 mb. This is 2.6 mb, or 25.1%, lower than in the same month in 2025 and 1.8 mb, or 18.7%, below the latest five-year average.

Fuel oil stocks increased by 0.7 mb, m-o-m, in September, to 6 mb. This is 0.1 mb, or 1.1%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 1.1 mb, or 15.9%, below the latest five-year average.

Gasoil stocks increased by 1.1 mb, m-o-m, in September, to 13 mb. This is 3.1 mb, or 18.7%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 2.2 mb, or 14.2%, below the latest five-year average.

Jet oil stocks decreased by 0.6 mb, m-o-m, to stand at 4 mb in September. This is 5.3 mb, or 59.9%, lower than the same month in 2025 and 3.7 mb, or 50.9%, below the latest five-year average.

Fujairah

During the week ending 2 November 2026, total oil product stocks in Fujairah increased by 2.50 mb, w-o-w, to stand at 11.41 mb, according to data from FEDCom and S&P Global Commodity Insights. At this level, total oil stocks were 7.19 mb lower than at the same time in 2025.

Light distillate stocks increased by 1.39 mb, w-o-w, to stand at 3.34 mb, 3.38 mb lower, y-o-y. Middle distillate stocks remained unchanged, w-o-w, at 2.26 mb, 0.98 mb lower, y-o-y, while heavy distillate stocks increased by 1.11 mb, w-o-w, to stand at 5.82 mb, 2.84 mb below year-earlier levels.

Balance of Supply and Demand

The demand for DoC crude in 2026 (i.e., crude from countries participating in the DoC) remains unchanged from last month's assessment at 42.1 mb/d, 0.6 mb/d lower, y-o-y.

The demand for DoC crude in 2027 also remains unchanged from last month's assessment at 43.9 mb/d, which is about 1.8 mb/d higher, y-o-y.

Balance of supply and demand in 2026

Demand for DoC crude

The demand for DoC crude in 2026 (i.e., crude from countries participating in the DoC) remains unchanged from last month's assessment at 42.1 mb/d, 0.6 mb/d lower, y-o-y.

Table 10 - 1: DoC production/demand balance for 2026*, mb/d

	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026	Change 2026/25
(a) World oil demand	**105.5**	**106.3**	**102.6**	**106.0**	**108.0**	**105.7**	***0.2***
Non-DoC liquids production	54.2	54.7	54.3	54.8	55.6	54.8	*0.6*
DoC NGL and non-conventionals	8.6	8.7	8.7	8.7	8.9	8.7	*0.1*
(b) Total non-DoC liquids production and DoC NGLs	**62.8**	**63.4**	**63.0**	**63.5**	**64.4**	**63.6**	***0.7***
Difference (a-b)	**42.7**	**42.9**	**39.6**	**42.5**	**43.6**	**42.1**	***-0.6***
DoC crude oil production	**42.0**	**39.9**	**34.3**	**38.3**			
Balance	**-0.7**	**-3.0**	**-5.3**	**-4.2**			

*Note: * 2026 = Forecast. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.*

Source: OPEC.

Balance of supply and demand in 2027

Demand for DoC crude

The demand for DoC crude in 2027 also remains unchanged from last month's assessment at 43.9 mb/d, which is about 1.8 mb/d higher, y-o-y.

Table 10 - 2: DoC production/demand balance for 2027*, mb/d

	2026	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27	2027	Change 2027/26
(a) World oil demand	**105.7**	**108.1**	**106.1**	**108.8**	**110.1**	**108.3**	***2.6***
Non-DoC liquids production	54.8	55.2	55.2	55.4	56.0	55.5	*0.6*
DoC NGL and non-conventionals	8.7	8.9	8.9	8.9	8.9	8.9	*0.1*
(b) Total non-DoC liquids production and DoC NGLs	**63.6**	**64.1**	**64.0**	**64.3**	**64.8**	**64.3**	***0.7***
Difference (a-b)	**42.1**	**44.0**	**42.0**	**44.5**	**45.2**	**43.9**	***1.8***

*Note: * 2026 and 2027 = Forecast. Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.*

Source: OPEC.

Appendix

Table 11 - 1: World oil demand and production balance, mb/d

World oil demand and production balance	2023	2024	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27	2027
World demand													
Americas	25.1	25.4	25.7	25.7	25.6	26.4	26.1	25.9	25.8	25.7	26.6	26.1	26.1
of which US	*20.4*	*20.6*	*20.9*	*20.8*	*20.8*	*21.4*	*21.1*	*21.0*	*20.9*	*20.9*	*21.6*	*21.1*	*21.2*
Europe	13.4	13.6	13.5	13.0	13.3	13.6	13.4	13.3	13.1	13.6	13.8	13.6	13.5
Asia Pacific	7.2	7.2	7.1	7.3	6.3	6.7	7.1	6.9	7.4	6.6	6.8	7.3	7.0
Total OECD	**45.8**	**46.2**	**46.3**	**46.0**	**45.1**	**46.6**	**46.6**	**46.1**	**46.3**	**45.9**	**47.3**	**47.0**	**46.6**
China	16.4	16.7	16.9	17.2	15.9	16.9	17.2	16.8	17.4	16.5	17.6	17.6	17.3
India	5.3	5.6	5.7	5.9	5.3	5.4	6.2	5.7	6.1	6.0	5.8	6.4	6.1
Other Asia	9.2	9.5	9.9	10.2	10.0	9.8	9.9	10.0	10.5	10.5	10.2	10.2	10.4
Latin America	6.7	6.8	6.9	6.9	7.1	7.2	7.1	7.1	7.1	7.3	7.3	7.2	7.2
Middle East	8.5	8.7	8.8	8.6	8.4	8.9	9.1	8.8	9.0	8.8	9.3	9.4	9.1
Africa	4.7	4.7	4.9	5.1	4.7	5.0	5.4	5.0	5.2	4.9	5.2	5.5	5.2
Russia	3.8	3.9	4.0	4.1	3.9	4.1	4.2	4.1	4.1	3.9	4.1	4.3	4.1
Other Eurasia	1.2	1.3	1.3	1.5	1.3	1.2	1.4	1.3	1.5	1.4	1.2	1.4	1.4
Other Europe	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.9	0.9	0.8	0.9	0.8	0.9	0.9
Total Non-OECD	**56.7**	**58.0**	**59.2**	**60.3**	**57.5**	**59.3**	**61.4**	**59.6**	**61.8**	**60.1**	**61.5**	**63.0**	**61.6**
(a) Total world demand	**102.4**	**104.1**	**105.5**	**106.3**	**102.6**	**106.0**	**108.0**	**105.7**	**108.1**	**106.1**	**108.8**	**110.1**	**108.3**
Y-o-y change	***2.6***	***1.7***	***1.4***	***1.6***	***-2.1***	***0.1***	***1.2***	***0.2***	***1.8***	***3.5***	***2.9***	***2.1***	***2.6***
Non-DoC liquids production													
Americas	26.7	27.7	28.3	28.3	28.9	29.2	29.3	28.9	28.9	28.9	29.2	29.4	29.1
of which US	*21.0*	*21.8*	*22.2*	*22.2*	*22.8*	*22.9*	*22.9*	*22.7*	*22.5*	*22.8*	*22.8*	*22.8*	*22.7*
Europe	3.6	3.5	3.6	3.8	3.6	3.4	3.7	3.6	3.6	3.5	3.4	3.6	3.5
Asia Pacific	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4
Total OECD	**30.7**	**31.7**	**32.3**	**32.5**	**32.8**	**33.0**	**33.3**	**32.9**	**32.8**	**32.8**	**33.0**	**33.3**	**33.0**
China	4.5	4.6	4.6	4.7	4.7	4.6	4.6	4.7	4.7	4.7	4.6	4.6	4.6
India	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8
Other Asia	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.7	1.7	1.7	1.6	1.7	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6
Latin America	7.0	7.2	7.5	8.2	8.4	8.4	8.5	8.4	8.6	8.6	8.7	8.9	8.7
Middle East	2.0	2.0	2.0	1.5	0.6	1.0	1.4	1.1	1.3	1.3	1.4	1.4	1.4
Africa	2.2	2.3	2.3	2.2	2.2	2.2	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.3
Other Eurasia	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4
Other Europe	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Total Non-OECD	**18.6**	**19.0**	**19.3**	**19.6**	**18.9**	**19.2**	**19.7**	**19.3**	**19.8**	**19.8**	**19.8**	**20.1**	**19.9**
Total Non-DoC production	49.4	50.7	51.7	52.1	51.7	52.2	53.0	52.3	52.6	52.6	52.8	53.4	52.9
Processing gains	2.5	2.5	2.5	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6
Total Non-DoC liquids production	**51.9**	**53.2**	**54.2**	**54.7**	**54.3**	**54.8**	**55.6**	**54.8**	**55.2**	**55.2**	**55.4**	**56.0**	**55.5**
DoC NGLs	8.4	8.5	8.6	8.7	8.7	8.7	8.9	8.7	8.9	8.9	8.9	8.9	8.9
(b) Total Non-DoC liquids production and DoC NGLs	**60.2**	**61.7**	**62.8**	**63.4**	**63.0**	**63.5**	**64.4**	**63.6**	**64.1**	**64.0**	**64.3**	**64.8**	**64.3**
Y-o-y change	***2.8***	***1.5***	***1.1***	***1.0***	***0.2***	***-0.1***	***1.9***	***0.7***	***0.8***	***1.0***	***0.8***	***0.4***	***0.7***
OPEC crude oil production (secondary sources)	27.1	26.6	27.6	25.9	20.0	24.4							
Non-OPEC DoC crude production	15.0	14.3	14.3	14.0	14.3	14.0							
DoC crude oil production	**42.1**	**40.9**	**42.0**	**39.9**	**34.3**	**38.3**							
Total liquids production	**102.3**	**102.6**	**104.8**	**103.3**	**97.3**	**101.8**							
Balance (stock change and miscellaneous)	*-0.1*	*-1.5*	*-0.7*	*-3.0*	*-5.3*	*-4.2*							
OECD closing stock levels, *mb*													
Commercial	2,780	2,756	2,843	2,809	2,746	2,811							
SPR	1,207	1,245	1,249	1,240	1,064	1,028							
Total	**3,987**	**4,001**	**4,092**	**4,049**	**3,809**	**3,839**							
Oil-on-water	1,391	1,310	1,546	1,257	1,461	1,515							
Days of forward consumption in OECD, *days*													
Commercial onland stocks	60	59	62	62	59	60							
SPR	26	27	27	27	23	22							
Total	**86**	**86**	**89**	**90**	**82**	**82**							
Memo items													
(a) - (b)	**42.2**	**42.4**	**42.7**	**42.9**	**39.6**	**42.5**	**43.6**	**42.1**	**44.0**	**42.0**	**44.5**	**45.2**	**43.9**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.
Source: OPEC.

Table 11 - 2: World oil demand and production balance: changes from last month's table*, mb/d

World oil demand and production balance	2023	2024	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27	2027
World demand													
Americas	-	-	-	-	-	-0.1	0.1	-	-	-	-0.1	-	-
of which US	-	-	-	-	-	*-0.1*	*0.1*	-	-	-	-	*0.1*	-
Europe	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Asia Pacific	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total OECD	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.1**	**0.1**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.1**	**0.1**	**-**
China	-	-	-	-	-	-0.1	0.1	-	-	-	-0.1	-	-
India	-	-	-	-	-	-0.1	0.1	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other Asia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Latin America	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Middle East	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Russia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other Eurasia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other Europe	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total Non-OECD	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.1**	**0.1**	**-**	**-**	**0.1**	**-**	**-**	**-**
(a) Total world demand	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.3**	**0.3**	**-**	**-**	**0.1**	**-0.1**	**0.1**	**-**
Y-o-y change	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-0.3***	***0.2***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***0.2***	***-0.2***	***-***
Non-DoC liquids production													
Americas	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
of which US	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Europe	-	-	-	-	-	-0.1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Asia Pacific	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total OECD	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.1**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
China	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
India	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other Asia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Latin America	-	-	-	-	-	0.1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Middle East	-	-	-	-	-	-0.1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other Eurasia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other Europe	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total Non-OECD	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
Total Non-DoC production	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Processing gains	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total Non-DoC liquids production	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
DoC NGLs	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
(b) Total Non-DoC liquids production and DoC NGLs	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.1**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
Y-o-y change	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-0.1***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***-***	***0.1***	***-***	***-***
OPEC crude oil production (secondary sources)	-	-	-	-	-	-							
Non-OPEC DoC crude production	-	-	-	-	-	-0.1							
DoC crude oil production	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.1**							
Total liquids production	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.2**							
Balance (stock change and miscellaneous)	-	-	-	-	-	0.1							
OECD closing stock levels, *mb*													
Commercial	-	-	1	-	5								
SPR	-	-	-	-	-								
Total	**-**	**-**	**1**	**-**	**5**								
Oil-on-water	-	-	-	-	-								
Days of forward consumption in OECD, *days*													
Commercial onland stocks	-	-	-	-	-								
SPR	-	-	-	-	-								
Total	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**								
Memo items													
(a) - (b)	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-0.2**	**0.2**	**-**	**-**	**0.1**	**-0.1**	**0.1**	**-**

*Note: * This compares Table 11 - 1 in this issue of the MOMR with Table 11 - 1 in the October 2026 issue.*

This table shows only where changes have occurred.

Source: OPEC.

Table 11 - 3: OECD oil stocks and oil on the water at the end of the period

OECD oil stocks and oil on water	2023	2024	2025	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26
Closing stock levels, mb											
OECD onland commercial	**2,780**	**2,756**	**2,843**	**2,756**	**2,752**	**2,789**	**2,868**	**2,843**	**2,809**	**2,746**	**2,811**
Americas	1,520	1,497	1,552	1,497	1,462	1,504	1,561	1,552	1,543	1,475	1,514
Europe	907	925	925	925	941	920	950	925	939	917	930
Asia Pacific	353	334	366	334	349	365	358	366	328	353	367
OECD SPR	**1,207**	**1,245**	**1,249**	**1,245**	**1,244**	**1,241**	**1,238**	**1,249**	**1,240**	**1,064**	**1,028**
Americas	357	395	414	395	398	404	408	414	416	323	286
Europe	466	466	454	466	461	457	453	454	446	446	441
Asia Pacific	384	384	380	384	386	380	377	380	379	295	301
OECD total	**3,987**	**4,001**	**4,092**	**4,001**	**3,996**	**4,030**	**4,106**	**4,092**	**4,049**	**3,809**	**3,839**
Oil-on-water	**1,391**	**1,310**	**1,546**	**1,310**	**1,364**	**1,383**	**1,461**	**1,546**	**1,257**	**1,461**	**1,515**
Days of forward consumption in OECD, days											
OECD onland commercial	**60**	**59**	**62**	**60**	**60**	**59**	**62**	**62**	**62**	**59**	**60**
Americas	60	58	60	59	57	57	60	60	60	56	58
Europe	67	68	69	71	68	67	70	71	71	68	69
Asia Pacific	49	47	53	45	51	53	50	50	52	53	52
OECD SPR	**26**	**27**	**27**	**27**	**27**	**26**	**27**	**27**	**27**	**23**	**22**
Americas	14	15	16	16	16	15	16	16	16	12	11
Europe	34	34	34	36	33	33	34	35	34	33	33
Asia Pacific	53	54	55	52	56	55	52	52	60	44	42
OECD total	**86**	**86**	**89**	**88**	**87**	**86**	**88**	**89**	**90**	**82**	**82**

Sources: Argus, EIA, IEA, JODI, METI, OilX and OPEC.

Table 11 - 4: Non-DoC liquids production and DoC natural gas liquids, mb/d*

Non-DoC liquids production and DoC NGLs	2025	Change 25/24	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026	Change 26/25	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27	2027	Change 27/26
US	22.2	0.5	22.2	22.8	22.9	22.9	22.7	0.5	22.5	22.8	22.8	22.8	22.7	0.0
Canada	6.1	0.1	6.2	6.0	6.3	6.3	6.2	0.1	6.3	6.1	6.3	6.5	6.3	0.1
Chile	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
OECD Americas	**28.3**	**0.6**	**28.3**	**28.9**	**29.2**	**29.3**	**28.9**	**0.6**	**28.9**	**28.9**	**29.2**	**29.4**	**29.1**	**0.2**
Norway	2.0	0.0	2.2	2.0	2.0	2.0	2.1	0.0	2.0	1.9	2.0	2.0	2.0	-0.1
UK	0.7	0.0	0.7	0.7	0.6	0.7	0.7	-0.1	0.7	0.7	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.0
Denmark	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0
Other OECD Europe	0.8	0.0	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.0	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.0
OECD Europe	**3.6**	**0.1**	**3.8**	**3.6**	**3.4**	**3.7**	**3.6**	**0.0**	**3.6**	**3.5**	**3.4**	**3.6**	**3.5**	**-0.1**
Australia	0.3	0.0	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.0	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.0
Other OECD Asia Pacific	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0
OECD Asia Pacific	**0.4**	**0.0**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.0**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.0**
Total OECD	**32.3**	**0.6**	**32.5**	**32.8**	**33.0**	**33.3**	**32.9**	**0.6**	**32.8**	**32.8**	**33.0**	**33.3**	**33.0**	**0.1**
China	**4.6**	**0.1**	**4.7**	**4.7**	**4.6**	**4.6**	**4.7**	**0.0**	**4.7**	**4.7**	**4.6**	**4.6**	**4.6**	**0.0**
India	**0.8**	**0.0**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.0**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.8**	**0.0**
Indonesia	0.9	0.0	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.9	0.8	0.0	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.0
Thailand	0.4	0.0	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.0	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.0
Vietnam	0.2	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.0
Asia others	0.2	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.0
Other Asia	**1.6**	**0.0**	**1.7**	**1.7**	**1.7**	**1.6**	**1.7**	**0.0**	**1.6**	**1.6**	**1.6**	**1.6**	**1.6**	**0.0**
Argentina	1.0	0.1	1.0	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	0.1	1.1	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.2	0.1
Brazil	4.4	0.2	4.8	5.0	5.0	4.9	4.9	0.5	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.0	0.1
Colombia	0.8	0.0	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.8	0.8	0.0	0.8	0.7	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.0
Ecuador	0.4	-0.1	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.0	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.0
Latin America others	1.0	0.1	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.3	1.2	0.2	1.3	1.3	1.3	1.4	1.4	0.2
Latin America	**7.5**	**0.3**	**8.2**	**8.4**	**8.4**	**8.5**	**8.4**	**0.8**	**8.6**	**8.6**	**8.7**	**8.9**	**8.7**	**0.4**
Qatar	1.9	0.0	1.4	0.5	0.9	1.2	1.0	-0.9	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.3	1.2	0.2
Middle East others	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0
Middle East	**2.0**	**0.0**	**1.5**	**0.6**	**1.0**	**1.4**	**1.1**	**-0.9**	**1.3**	**1.3**	**1.4**	**1.4**	**1.4**	**0.2**
Angola	**1.1**	**-0.1**	**1.1**	**1.1**	**1.0**	**1.0**	**1.1**	**0.0**	**1.0**	**1.0**	**1.0**	**1.0**	**1.0**	**0.0**
Chad	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0
Egypt	0.5	0.0	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.0	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.0
Ghana	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0
South Africa	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0
Africa others	0.3	0.1	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.0	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.1
Africa	**2.3**	**-0.1**	**2.2**	**2.2**	**2.2**	**2.3**	**2.3**	**0.0**	**2.3**	**2.3**	**2.3**	**2.3**	**2.3**	**0.0**
Other Eurasia	**0.4**	**0.0**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.0**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.0**
Other Europe	**0.1**	**0.0**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.0**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.0**
Total Non-OECD	**19.3**	**0.3**	**19.6**	**18.9**	**19.2**	**19.7**	**19.3**	**0.0**	**19.8**	**19.8**	**19.8**	**20.1**	**19.9**	**0.5**
Non-DoC production	51.7	1.0	52.1	51.7	52.2	53.0	52.3	0.6	52.6	52.6	52.8	53.4	52.9	0.6
Processing gains	2.5	0.0	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	0.0	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	0.0
Non-DoC liquids production	**54.2**	**1.0**	**54.7**	**54.3**	**54.8**	**55.6**	**54.8**	**0.6**	**55.2**	**55.2**	**55.4**	**56.0**	**55.5**	**0.6**
DoC NGLs	**8.6**	**0.1**	**8.7**	**8.7**	**8.7**	**8.9**	**8.7**	**0.1**	**8.9**	**8.9**	**8.9**	**8.9**	**8.9**	**0.1**
Non-DoC liquids production and DoC NGLs	**62.8**	**1.1**	**63.4**	**63.0**	**63.5**	**64.4**	**63.6**	**0.7**	**64.1**	**64.0**	**64.3**	**64.8**	**64.3**	**0.7**

Note: Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

Source: OPEC.

Table 11 - 5: World rig count, units

World rig count	2023	2024	2025	Change 2025/24	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Change Oct/Sep
US	688	599	562	-37	548	555	589	593	602	9
Canada	177	188	177	-11	201	151	206	204	220	16
Mexico	55	50	25	-25	31	26	30	33	30	-3
OECD Americas	**921**	**839**	**765**	**-74**	**780**	**732**	**825**	**832**	**854**	**22**
Norway	17	13	16	3	16	14	15	15	14	-1
UK	12	8	8	0	6	8	9	10	8	-2
OECD Europe	**66**	**64**	**66**	**2**	**66**	**67**	**84**	**88**	**82**	**-6**
OECD Asia Pacific	**25**	**25**	**18**	**-7**	**19**	**20**	**20**	**19**	**19**	**0**
Total OECD	**1,012**	**927**	**849**	**-78**	**865**	**819**	**929**	**939**	**955**	**16**
Other Asia*	204	212	201	-11	195	194	199	201	196	-5
Latin America	120	104	107	3	105	109	108	108	111	3
Middle East	61	62	62	0	61	58	64	67	65	-2
Africa	67	52	44	-8	42	48	47	49	45	-4
Other Europe	11	9	11	2	11	9	9	9	9	0
Total Non-OECD	**463**	**439**	**425**	**-14**	**414**	**418**	**427**	**434**	**426**	**-8**
Non-OPEC rig count	**1,475**	**1,367**	**1,274**	**-93**	**1,279**	**1,237**	**1,356**	**1,373**	**1,381**	**8**
Algeria	36	42	43	1	40	42	42	42	47	5
Congo	1	1	1	0	2	2	2	2	2	0
Equatorial Guinea**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Gabon	3	4	3	-1	5	5	3	3	3	0
Iran**	117	117	117	0	117	117	117	117	117	0
Iraq	61	62	62	0	59	14	17	24	25	1
Kuwait	24	31	34	3	42	39	39	40	42	2
Libya	14	18	18	0	18	22	28	29	29	0
Nigeria	14	15	13	-2	16	16	19	20	19	-1
Saudi Arabia***	83	295	248	-47	252	266	270	262	254	-8
UAE	57	66	74	8	72	72	75	76	78	2
Venezuela	2	2	1	-1	2	2	2	2	7	5
OPEC rig count	**412**	**653**	**615**	**-38**	**625**	**597**	**614**	**617**	**623**	**6**
World rig count**	**1,887**	**2,019**	**1,890**	**-129**	**1,904**	**1,834**	**1,970**	**1,990**	**2,004**	**14**
of which:										
Oil	1,498	1,559	1,425	-134	1,413	1,353	1,456	1,469	1,498	29
Gas	357	413	409	-4	433	427	449	455	442	-13
Others	32	47	56	9	58	54	65	67	65	-3

*Note: * Other Asia includes India and offshore rigs for China.*

*** Estimated data when Baker Hughes Incorporated did not reported the data.*

**** Since January 2024, Baker Hughes counts all operating rigs in Saudi Arabia; other countries reflect only active rigs.*

***** Data excludes onshore China, as well as Russia and other Eurasian countries.*

Totals may not add up due to independent rounding.

Sources: Baker Hughes Incorporated and OPEC.

Glossary of Terms

Abbreviations

b	barrels
b/d	barrels per day
bp	basis points
bb	billion barrels
bcf	billion cubic feet
cu m	cubic metres
mb	million barrels
mb/d	million barrels per day
mmbtu	million British thermal units
mn	million
m-o-m	month-on-month
mt	metric tonnes
q-o-q	quarter-on-quarter
pp	percentage points
tb/d	thousand barrels per day
tcf	trillion cubic feet
y-o-y	year-on-year
y-t-d	year-to-date

Acronyms

ARA	Amsterdam-Rotterdam-Antwerp
BoE	Bank of England
BoJ	Bank of Japan
BOP	Balance of payments
BRIC	Brazil, Russia, India and China
CAPEX	capital expenditures
CCI	Consumer Confidence Index
CFTC	Commodity Futures Trading Commission
CIF	cost, insurance and freight
CPI	consumer price index
DoC	Declaration of Cooperation
DCs	developing countries
DUC	drilled, but uncompleted (oil well)
ECB	European Central Bank
EIA	US Energy Information Administration
Emirates NBD	Emirates National Bank of Dubai
EMs	emerging markets
EV	electric vehicle

FAI	fixed asset investment
FCC	fluid catalytic cracking
FDI	foreign direct investment
Fed	US Federal Reserve
FID	final investment decision
FOB	free on board
FPSO	floating production storage and offloading
FSU	Former Soviet Union
FX	Foreign Exchange
FY	fiscal year
GDP	gross domestic product
GFCF	gross fixed capital formation
GoM	Gulf of Mexico
GTLs	gas-to-liquids
HH	Henry Hub
HSFO	high-sulphur fuel oil
ICE	Intercontinental Exchange
IEA	International Energy Agency
IMF	International Monetary Fund
IOCs	international oil companies
IP	industrial production
ISM	Institute of Supply Management
JODI	Joint Organisations Data Initiative
LIBOR	London inter-bank offered rate
LLS	Light Louisiana Sweet
LNG	liquefied natural gas
LPG	liquefied petroleum gas
LR	long-range (vessel)
LSFO	low-sulphur fuel oil
MCs	(OPEC) Member Countries
MED	Mediterranean
MENA	Middle East/North Africa
MOMR	(OPEC) Monthly Oil Market Report
MPV	multi-purpose vehicle
MR	medium-range or mid-range (vessel)
NBS	National Bureau of Statistics
NGLs	natural gas liquids
NPC	National People's Congress (China)
NWE	Northwest Europe
NYMEX	New York Mercantile Exchange
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
OPEX	operational expenditures
OIV	total open interest volume
ORB	OPEC Reference Basket
OSP	Official Selling Price
PADD	Petroleum Administration for Defense Districts
PBoC	People's Bank of China
PMI	purchasing managers' index
PPI	producer price index
PPP	purchasing power parity

RBI	Reserve Bank of India
REER	real effective exchange rate
ROI	return on investment
SAAR	seasonally-adjusted annualised rate
SIAM	Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers
SRFO	straight-run fuel oil
SUV	sports utility vehicle
ULCC	ultra-large crude carrier
ULSD	ultra-low sulphur diesel
USEC	US East Coast
USGC	US Gulf Coast
USWC	US West Coast
VGO	vacuum gasoil
VLCC	very large crude carriers
WPI	wholesale price index
WS	Worldscale
WTI	West Texas Intermediate
WTS	West Texas Sour

OPEC Basket average price

US$/b

Up 1.53 in October

October 2026	112.12
September 2026	110.59
Year-to-date	**95.44**

October OPEC crude production

mb/d, according to secondary sources

Up 1.97 in October

October 2026	27.16
September 2026	25.20

October Non-OPEC DoC crude production

mb/d, according to secondary sources

Up 0.07 in October

October 2026	14.07
September 2026	14.00

Economic growth rate

per cent

	World	US	Eurozone	Japan	China	India	Brazil	Russia
2026	3.1	2.3	1.0	0.8	4.6	7.3	2.0	1.0
2027	3.2	2.1	1.1	0.8	4.5	6.8	2.1	1.5

Supply and demand

mb/d

2026		**26/25**	**2027**		**27/26**
World demand	105.7	0.2	World demand	108.3	2.6
Non-DoC liquids production	54.8	0.6	Non-DoC liquids production	55.5	0.6
DoC NGLs	8.7	0.1	DoC NGLs	8.9	0.1
Difference	**42.1**	**-0.6**	**Difference**	**43.9**	**1.8**

OECD commercial stocks

mb

	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	Sep 26/Aug 26
Crude oil	1,338	1,353	1,353	0.1
Products	1,447	1,472	1,458	-14.7
Total	**2,784**	**2,826**	**2,811**	**-14.6**
Days of forward cover	59.8	60.6	60.3	-0.3

Next report to be issued on 14 December 2026.